

SEVEN OPEN UNIT EQUILATERAL TRIANGLES DO NOT COVER A REGULAR UNIT HEXAGON

JINEON BAEK, JEEWON KIM

ABSTRACT. We prove that the regular hexagon of side length one cannot be covered by seven open equilateral triangles of side length one. Seven distinguished points force one center role and six vertex roles. A finite classification then routes every hypothetical cover to one of four geometric mechanisms: trace deficit, monotone transfer, area loss, or a nine-point support obstruction. The reader-facing proof states the exact geometric interfaces, the resulting inequalities, and the exhaustive routing argument. Support-line derivations, polynomial reductions, monotonicity calculations, and exact certificates are isolated in technical appendices. The two final mixed cap overlaps are verified by a formally incorporated exact symbolic certificate using integer, rational, and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ arithmetic.

CONTENTS

1. Proof Architecture	2
2. Geometric Interfaces Used by the Proof	4
3. Strategy 1: Trace Budgets	12
4. Strategy 2: Propagating Boundary Demand	14
5. Strategy 3: Area Loss	19
6. Strategy 4: Direct Nine-Point Forcing	21
7. Exhaustive Assembly	24
Appendix A. Technical Verification Roadmap	26
Appendix B. Structural Reduction to Finite Cases	27
Appendix C. Universal Enclosure and Transfer Calculus	35
Appendix D. Derivation of the Local Admissible Set	40
Appendix E. Signed CE1/CE2 Reductions	43
Appendix F. Trace Budgets and Length Contradictions	51
Appendix G. Short Local Profiles and Exact Vd Placements	61
Appendix H. Strategy 2 Geometry–Parameter Bridges	68
Appendix I. Strategy 2 as Real-Variable Optimization	72
Appendix J. Universal Strategy 2 Optimization Theorems	82
Appendix K. Exact Strategy 2 Source Provenance	87
Appendix L. Registered Strategy 2 Applications	87
Appendix M. Exact Local Demand Calculus	89
Appendix N. Cyclic Propagation in the All-Vd0 Cases	93
Appendix O. Nonsupercritical, T3-like, and Vd1/Vd2 Demand Branches	98
Appendix P. Exact Endpoint and Replacement Verification	113

2020 *Mathematics Subject Classification.* 52C15, 52A40, 51M04.

Key words and phrases. equilateral triangles, geometric covering, regular hexagon, boundary propagation, area loss, exact computer-assisted certificate.

Appendix Q.	Authoritative CE2 One-Vd Placement Assembly	116
Appendix R.	Area-Loss Obstructions	117
Appendix S.	The Direct Nine-Point Obstruction	122
Appendix T.	Exact Computer-Assisted Certificate for the Mixed Cap Overlaps	133
Appendix U.	Nonstandard Symbols	137

1.1. The theorem and the seven forced roles. Let

where indices lie in $\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z}$. Write

$$e_{i,i+1} = [V_i, V_{i+1}], \quad r_i = [O, V_i], \quad M_i = \frac{1}{2}V_i,$$

and put

$$D = \bigcup_{i=0}^5 r_i, \quad S = \partial H \cup D.$$

Then $\mathcal{H}^1(\partial H) = \mathcal{H}^1(D) = 6$ and $\mathcal{H}^1(S) = 12$.

Theorem 1.1 (Main theorem). *The hexagon H cannot be covered by seven open equilateral triangles of side length one.*

Corollary 1.2 (Soifer’s Hexagon Problem). *For every $L > 1$, the regular hexagon $H_L = LH$ cannot be covered by seven closed unit equilateral triangles.*

The seven points $O, V_0, \dots, V_5$ are pairwise at distance at least one. Consequently a hypothetical open cover has seven distinct roles: an open triangle U_C containing O and open triangles U_i containing V_i . Their closures are denoted by T_C, T_i .

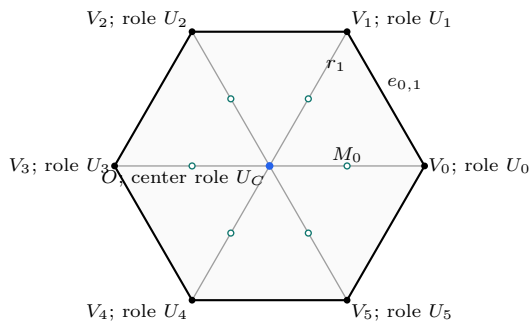


FIGURE 1. Important points

1.2. The finite dictionary. The center type is the number of boundary edges on which T_C has a positive-length trace. The only possibilities are 0, 1, 2, denoted by CE0, CE1, CE2.

For a vertex triangle, let o be the number of its triangle vertices outside H and let n be the number of adjacent radial arms met in positive length. The exhaustive types are

type	(o, n)
Vd0	$(1, 0), (2, 0), (3, 0)$
Vd1	$(1, 1)$
Vd2	$(1, 2)$
T3-like	$(2, 1)$.

For an original vertex role, let A_i, B_i, C_i be its actual maximal incoming boundary, outgoing boundary, and own-radial reaches. The V triangle is *supercritical* when $A_i + B_i > 1$, and

$$N_+ = |\{i : A_i + B_i > 1\}|.$$

Lowercase (a_i, b_i, c_i) always denotes selected lower demands and never the actual maxima defining N_+ .

On $e_{i,i+1}$, parametrized from V_i to V_{i+1} , the two incident open traces have the form $[0, B_i)$ and $(1 - A_{i+1}, 1]$. Their complement

$$[B_i, 1 - A_{i+1}]$$

is a boundary gap; equality gives a singleton gap, which is still uncovered. For CE1/CE2, let gr be the number of positive center traces containing such a gap.

Call a vertex role *short* if it is supercritical or has positive-length trace on an adjacent arm. Let m count the roles of type Vd1, Vd2, T3-like, and let q count short roles. The structural calculus gives

$$q = N_+ + m.$$

1.3. The exhaustive routing table. Table 1 is read from top to bottom in the CE1/CE2 part. The first applicable entry is the unique route for the hypothetical cover. The structural proof is summarized in Proposition 2.1 and given in full in Appendix B.

center count	and	V-triangle	exhaustive refinement	route
CE0, $N_+ = 0$			all vertex types	1
CE0, $N_+ = 1$			all six roles Vd0	4
CE0, $N_+ = 1$			a Vd1 or Vd2 role	1
CE0, $N_+ = 1$			no Vd1/Vd2 role and a T3-like role	3
CE0, $N_+ \geq 2$			all vertex types	3
CE1/CE2			$q \geq 3$	1
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$			all six roles Vd0	2
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$			a Vd1 or Vd2 role	1
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$			no Vd1/Vd2 role and a T3-like role	2
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 1$			all Vd0, zero gaps	4
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 1$			all Vd0, a nonempty gap	2
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 1$			exactly one T3-like, no Vd1/Vd2	2
CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 1$			exactly one Vd1/Vd2, no T3-like	1 / 1+2

TABLE 1. The complete terminal routing. Route j means Strategy j . In the last entry, the first alternative is for CE1 and the second for CE2.

For the two all-Vd0 CE1/CE2, the same six cells are organized by

	gr = 0	gr = 1	gr = 2
$N_+ = 0$	strict identity cycle	one-side endpoint chain	paired endpoint chain
$N_+ = 1$	nine-point support	five-V-triangle chain	paired endpoint chain.

The last column is CE2-only.

1.4. Four mechanisms. Strategy 1 bounds one-dimensional traces on ∂H or S . Strategy 2 propagates lower reaches with monotone maps obtained from one local admissible set. Strategy 3 sums forced area losses. Strategy 4 forces nine points into the center role and applies an equilateral enclosure obstruction. Sections 3–6 contain these arguments; Section 7 performs the final audit.

2. GEOMETRIC INTERFACES USED BY THE PROOF

2.1. Structural reduction.

Proposition 2.1 (Reader structural reduction). *Every hypothetical cover has the seven distinct roles described in Section 1. The center has exactly one of the types CE0, CE1, CE2, every vertex role has exactly one of the types Vd0, Vd1, Vd2, T3-like, and the actual reaches determine exactly one entry of Table 1. In the CE1/CE2 case the center contains exactly one radial midpoint and*

$$q = N_+ + m.$$

If the vertex roles alone cover the boundary, strict handoffs can be selected while preserving whether the actual supercritical pattern has none, exactly one, or at least two indices.

Proof. Distinctness is Lemma B.2; the center and vertex classifications are Propositions B.3 and B.5; the unique midpoint is Proposition B.11; the short-role identity is Lemma F.16; strict selection is Proposition B.9; and the disjoint routing assertion is Proposition B.13. Their geometric proofs are collected in Appendix B. $\square$

2.2. The local admissible set.

Definition 2.2 (Actual and selected skeleton-V-triangle reach coordinates). All indices lie in $\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z}$. For a tagged open or closed V_i -triangle, the distinguished vertex V_i is part of the role data and the reach functions are given by the following three suprema. At the closed vertex role T_i , define

$$\begin{aligned} A(T_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(V_{i-1} - V_i) \in T_i}} t, \\ B(T_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(V_{i+1} - V_i) \in T_i}} t, \\ C(T_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(O - V_i) \in T_i}} t. \end{aligned}$$

The functions give the incoming reach toward V_{i-1} , the outgoing reach toward V_{i+1} , and the own-radial reach toward O , respectively. Since $T_i = \overline{U}_i$, they satisfy

$$A(U_i) = A(T_i), \quad B(U_i) = B(T_i), \quad C(U_i) = C(T_i).$$

For compact indexed formulas, put

$$(A_i, B_i, C_i) := (A(T_i), B(T_i), C(T_i)).$$

The triple $(A(T_i), B(T_i), C(T_i))$ is the *actual V-triangle reach data*. A *selected demand triple* is any $(a_i, b_i, c_i) \in [0, 1]^3$ satisfying

$$(a_i, b_i, c_i) \leq (A(T_i), B(T_i), C(T_i))$$

coordinatewise. Define

$$x_i = 1 - a_i, \quad y_i = b_i.$$

The actual V triangle is nonsupercritical, critical, or strictly supercritical according as

$$A(T_i) + B(T_i) < 1, \quad A(T_i) + B(T_i) = 1, \quad A(T_i) + B(T_i) > 1,$$

respectively. In particular,

$$N_+ = |\{i \in \mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z} : A(T_i) + B(T_i) > 1\}|$$

is defined from actual data, never from a selected triple.

Definition 2.3 (Local demand hull and admissible set). Let

$$u = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right), \quad v = \left(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right).$$

For $(a, b, c) \in [0, 1]^3$, define

$$\begin{aligned} K(a, b, c) &= \text{conv}\{0, au, bv, c(u+v)\} \\ q_\theta &= (\cos \theta, \sin \theta), \quad r_\theta = \left(\cos\left(\theta + \frac{\pi}{3}\right), \sin\left(\theta + \frac{\pi}{3}\right)\right), \\ \mathfrak{E}_1 &= \left\{\text{conv}\{z, z + q_\theta, z + r_\theta\} : z \in \mathbb{R}^2, 0 \leq \theta < 2\pi\right\}. \end{aligned}$$

Define

$$\mathcal{A} = \{(a, b, c) \in [0, 1]^3 : \exists \Delta \in \mathfrak{E}_1, \quad K(a, b, c) \subseteq \Delta\}.$$

Thus a closed vertex role with actual V-triangle reach data (A, B, C) realizes every $(a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}$ satisfying

$$0 \leq a \leq A, \quad 0 \leq b \leq B, \quad 0 \leq c \leq C.$$

Local demand data inside the regular-hexagon skeleton

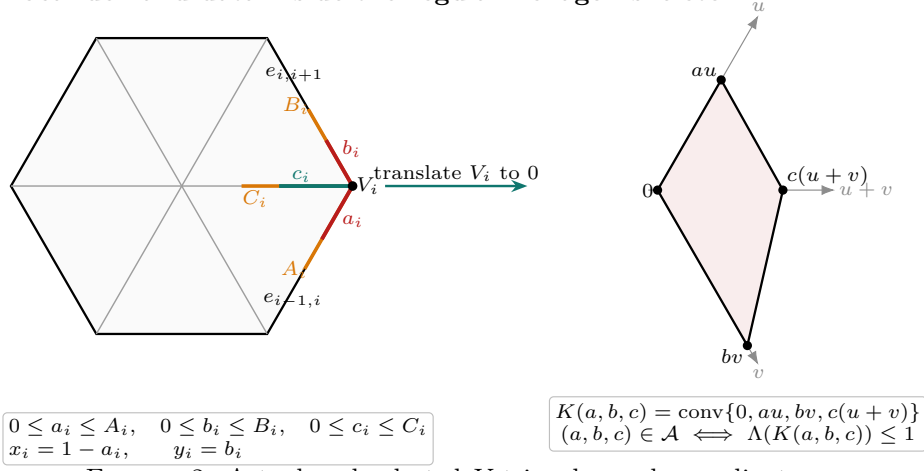


FIGURE 2. Actual and selected V-triangle reach coordinates on the full hexagon skeleton, together with the rigid local demand hull. The least equilateral enclosure side of that hull is the scalar controlling both Strategy 2 transfers and Strategy 4 witnesses.

The oriented unit-triangle family and admissible local hulls

a representative member is placed on the full hexagon skeleton

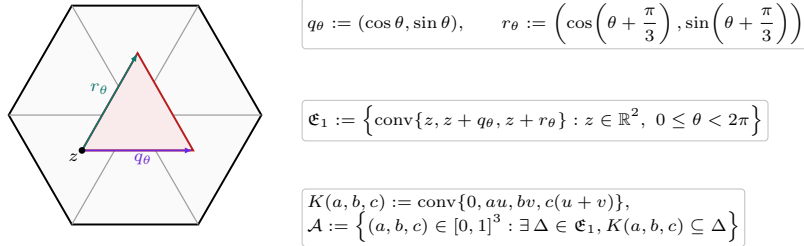


FIGURE 3. The oriented unit-triangle family $\mathfrak{E}_1$ and the formal containment definition of the local admissible set $\mathcal{A}$.

Definition 2.4 (Equilateral enclosure gauge). Define

$$R : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2, \quad R = \begin{pmatrix} -1/2 & -\sqrt{3}/2 \\ \sqrt{3}/2 & -1/2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

For every nonempty compact $K \subset \mathbb{R}^2$, define

$$h_K : \mathbb{S}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad h_K(n) := \max_{z \in K} \langle z, n \rangle,$$

$$\Lambda(K) := \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \min_{\|n\|=1} \sum_{j=0}^2 h_K(R^j n).$$

Proposition C.1 says that $\Lambda(K)$ is the least side length of an enclosing closed equilateral triangle.

Proposition 2.5 (Geometric structure of the admissible set). *The local admissible set $\mathcal{A}$ has the following properties.*

- (1) *It is compact, coordinatewise downward closed, and invariant under interchanging the two boundary coordinates a and b .*

(2)

$$(a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A} \iff \Lambda(K(a, b, c)) \leq 1.$$

- (3) *For (b, c) , (a, c) , and (a, b) in the corresponding two-coordinate projections of $\mathcal{A}$, respectively, define the one-coordinate fibers*

$$\mathcal{A}_{b,c}^{(1)} = \{a \geq 0 : (a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}\},$$

$$\mathcal{A}_{a,c}^{(2)} = \{b \geq 0 : (a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}\},$$

$$\mathcal{A}_{a,b}^{(3)} = \{c \geq 0 : (a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}.$$

Each of these fibers is a nonempty compact initial interval. In particular, each maximum used to define a transfer map below is attained.

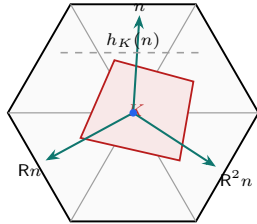
The exact support expressions, their cell conditions, and the resulting piecewise equations for $\mathcal{A}$ are stated and proved in Appendix D.

Proof. Compactness and downward closure follow directly from the containment definition and compactness of the oriented unit-triangle family modulo translation. Reflection in the radial axis exchanges a and b . The gauge equivalence is Proposition C.1. For each fixed pair in the corresponding projection, compactness and coordinatewise downward closure give a nonempty compact initial-interval fiber. Moreover, $K(a, 0, c) \subseteq \text{conv}\{0, u, u + v\}$ for $a, c \in [0, 1]$, so the fibers used to define the transfer maps below are nonempty. The exact cell formulas used in the plan above are proved in Appendix D. $\square$

Our plan is to split (a, b, c) -space into finitely many regions, use one explicit formula on each region, compare the finitely many candidate enclosing triangles, and declare (a, b, c) admissible exactly when the smallest candidate has side at most 1.

Equilateral enclosure gauge on the hexagon skeleton

schematic support directions; formulas and signatures are exact



$$\mathbf{R} : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2, \quad \mathbf{R} = \begin{pmatrix} -1/2 & -\sqrt{3}/2 \\ \sqrt{3}/2 & -1/2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{For nonempty compact } K \subset \mathbb{R}^2, \\ h_K : \mathbb{S}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad h_K(n) := \max_{z \in K} \langle z, n \rangle.$$

$$\Lambda(K) := \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \min_{\|n\|=1} \sum_{j=0}^2 h_K(\mathbf{R}^j n)$$

$\Lambda(K)$ = least side length of a closed equilateral triangle containing K .

$$(a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A} \iff \Lambda(K(a, b, c)) \leq 1.$$

FIGURE 4. The support-function definition of the equilateral enclosure gauge, placed in the full skeleton containing the local demand hull. This figure is a geometric sketch; the exact caliper equations are in Appendix D.

2.3. The transfer alphabet and its inequality interface.

Definition 2.6 (Raw, capped, and complement-dual transfers). For each $c \in [0, 1]$, define $g_c, \widehat{g}_c : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ by

$$g_c(x) = \max \{y \in [0, 1] : (1 - x, y, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}, \quad \widehat{g}_c(x) = \min \{g_c(x), x\}.$$

For every map $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$, define its complement dual $f^\vee : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ by

$$f^\vee(a) = 1 - f(1 - a).$$

Consequently,

$$g_c^\vee(a) = 1 - g_c(1 - a), \quad \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a) = 1 - \widehat{g}_c(1 - a).$$

The variable $x = 1 - a$ is an incoming boundary-defect coordinate, $g_c(x)$ is the extremal admissible outgoing demand, the hat imposes the nonsupercritical bound $y \leq x$, and $\vee$ returns the map to incoming-reach coordinates.

Definition 2.7 (Residual and center-assisted transfers). Let

$$\mathfrak{J} = \{\emptyset\} \cup \{[L, U] : 0 \leq L \leq U \leq 1\}.$$

For $J \in \mathfrak{J}$ and $p \in [0, 1]$, define

$$e_J(p) = \sup \{t \in [0, 1] : [0, t] \subseteq [0, p] \cup J\}, \quad \mathcal{R}_J(p) = 1 - e_J(p).$$

Equivalently,

$$\mathcal{R}_\emptyset(p) = 1 - p, \quad \mathcal{R}_{[L, U]}(p) = \begin{cases} 1 - p, & p < L, \\ 1 - \max\{p, U\}, & p \geq L. \end{cases}$$

For $a, c \in [0, 1]$ and $J \in \mathfrak{J}$, define

$$g_{c, J}^\vee(a) = \mathcal{R}_J(g_c(1 - a)), \quad \widehat{g}_{c, J}^\vee(a) = \mathcal{R}_J(\widehat{g}_c(1 - a)).$$

(a) raw transfer and complement dual on the skeleton

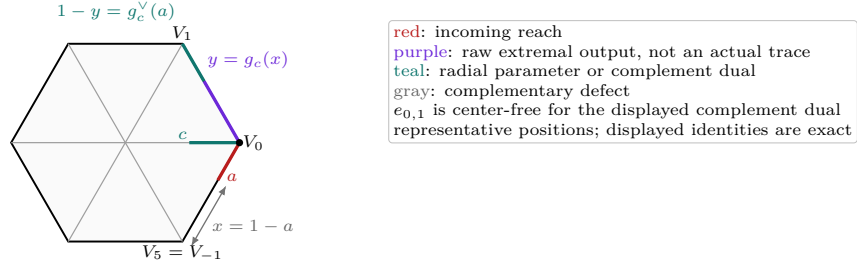
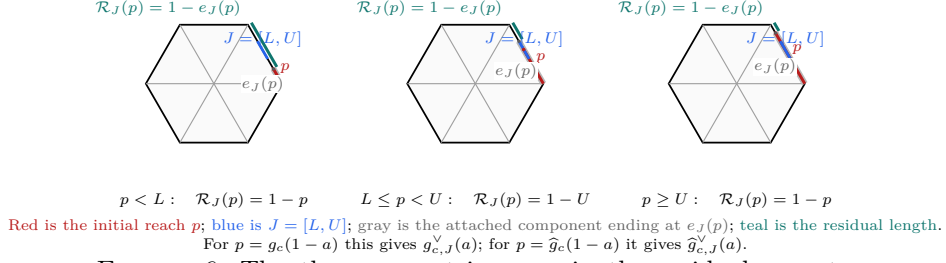


FIGURE 5. Incoming reach and defect, radial parameter, raw extremal output, and the center-free complement dual.

(b) the center-assisted residual on a skeleton edge

FIGURE 6. The three geometric cases in the residual operator $\mathcal{R}_{[L,U]}(p)$, drawn on a handoff edge.

Definition 2.8 (Free strict-supercritical envelope). For $0 \leq c < 1/2$, define

$$\mathcal{S}_c := \{x \in [0, 1] : g_c(x) > x\}.$$

Define the continuous envelope function on the closed parameter interval by

$$g_c^{\text{sc}} : [0, 1/2] \rightarrow [1/2, 1], \quad g_c^{\text{sc}} = \frac{c + \sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4}}{2}.$$

For $0 \leq c < 1/2$,

$$g_c^{\text{sc}} = \sup_{x \in \mathcal{S}_c} g_c(x),$$

whereas $g_{1/2}^{\text{sc}} = 1/2$ is the continuous endpoint value.

Definition 2.9 (Ordered composition and slotwise lower relaxation). Let $r \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 1}$ and, for $1 \leq j \leq r$, let $\Phi_j : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ be listed in geometric V-triangle order. Define

$$[\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r] : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1], \quad [\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r](x) := (\Phi_r \circ \cdots \circ \Phi_1)(x),$$

$$\mathbf{I} : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1], \quad \mathbf{I}(x) := x.$$

For maps $\Phi_j : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ with $1 \leq j \leq r$, if every Φ_j is nondecreasing and

$$\Phi_j(x) \leq \Phi_j(x) \quad (1 \leq j \leq r, x \in [0, 1]),$$

then $[\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r]$ is called a *slotwise lower relaxation* of $[\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r]$.

At zero radial demand,

$$g_0(x) > x \quad (0 < x < 1), \quad \widehat{g}_0(x) = x.$$

Thus the identity belongs to the hatted map, not the raw map. Figures 5–9 give a visual reading of this alphabet. In particular, x is a complementary coordinate, not necessarily a geometrically uncovered segment, and $g_c(x)$ is an extremal admissible output rather than the actual reach $B(T)$.

Proposition 2.10 (Transfer interface). *Fix $a, c \in [0, 1]$ and $J \in \mathfrak{J}$. Let T be an actual V triangle satisfying $A(T) \geq a$ and $C(T) \geq c$, and let T_{next} be the next incident actual V triangle. When a center trace assists the handoff, J is its scalar parameter interval on that edge.*

(1) *Always,*

$$B(T) \leq g_c(1 - a).$$

If the outgoing edge is center-free, then

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq g_c^\vee(a).$$

If T is nonsupercritical, then

$$B(T) \leq \widehat{g}_c(1 - a),$$

and on a center-free outgoing edge

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a) \geq a.$$

(2) *With a center interval J on the handoff edge,*

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq g_{c,J}^\vee(a),$$

and, when T is nonsupercritical,

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq \widehat{g}_{c,J}^\vee(a).$$

(3) *If T is strictly supercritical, then necessarily $0 \leq c < 1/2$, and*

$$B(T) < g_c^{\text{sc}}.$$

Only when its outgoing edge is center-free may this be complemented to

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) > 1 - g_c^{\text{sc}}.$$

(4) *If nondecreasing maps Φ_j are pointwise lower bounds for the exact V triangle transfers Φ_j , then replacing any slots in a composition by Φ_j preserves a valid lower bound for the returned demand.*

Proof. Items 1 and 2 are Lemmas C.2 and C.4. Item 3 is (27), with the additional center-free hypothesis used only in (28). Item 4 is Lemma C.5. $\square$

2.4. One signed CE1/CE2 interface.

Definition 2.11 (Positive part and center-boundary contribution). For $t \in \mathbb{R}$, define

$$[t]_+ = \max\{t, 0\}.$$

For a closed center role T_C , define

$$L_{\partial H}(T_C) = \mathcal{H}^1(T_C \cap \partial H).$$

Definition 2.12 (Geometric signed CE1/CE2 center data). Normalize one positive-length center trace to $e_{0,1}$. The signed affine normal form of Appendix E assigns to the normalized center triangle a parameter triple (R, α, δ) in its exact signed domain $\mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}}$; write the resulting closed center triangle as $T_C(R, \alpha, \delta)$.

Let $\mathcal{I}_R = T_C \cap e_{0,1}$ be the normalized active trace, and let $\mathcal{I}_L = T_C \cap e_{5,0}$ be the possible companion trace. Denote their lengths by ℓ_R and ℓ_L . The signed companion coordinate Δ_L is the affine quantity defined in Appendix E; its sign records whether the companion trace has positive length.

For each $i \in \mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z}$, let d_i^C denote the farthest parameter reached by T_C on the radial arm r_i , measured from O toward V_i , and put $c_i^C = 1 - d_i^C$. Thus d_i^C is the center-side radial exit and c_i^C is the complementary radial demand imposed on the V triangle T_i .

Proposition 2.13 (Signed center interface). *For the normalization of Definition 2.12, the active trace $\mathcal{I}_R$ has positive length. The center type is read from the companion trace:*

$$T_C \text{ is CE1} \iff \ell_L = 0, \quad T_C \text{ is CE2} \iff \ell_L > 0.$$

Equivalently, CE2 is characterized by $\Delta_L > 0$, while CE1 has $\Delta_L \leq 0$; the equality case is a single companion contact point. Moreover,

$$L_{\partial H}(T_C) = \ell_R + \ell_L,$$

and the six exits d_i^C and complementary demands c_i^C are continuous piecewise-algebraic functions of the signed parameters. The bounds needed in the reader-facing proof are

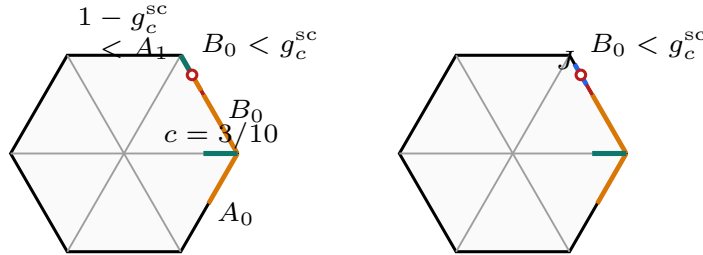
$$L_{\partial H}(T_C) \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4} \quad \text{in CE1}, \quad L_{\partial H}(T_C) < \frac{1}{2} \quad \text{in CE2}.$$

All exact affine side equations, trace endpoints, exit formulas, and sign-cell conditions are collected in Appendix E.

Proof. This is Proposition E.1 and Corollary E.3. Their exact calculation is kept in Appendix E; only the geometric classification and the two boundary bounds are used in the body. $\square$

2.5. Hexagon-skeleton atlas for the two interfaces. Panels (a)–(b) appear immediately after Definition 2.7. The remaining figures below place the reader-facing transfer and signed-center objects on the regular hexagon skeleton. Dashed extremal segments are not actual traces, and panels marked schematic record incidence and order rather than metric placement. Exact admissible-set and signed-center equations are intentionally kept in Appendices D and E.

(c) strict-supercritical envelope on the skeleton

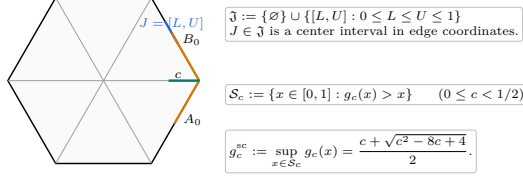


$$U_C \cap e_{0,1} = \emptyset \quad J \neq \emptyset : \quad B_0 < g_c^{\text{sc}} \not\Leftarrow A_1 > 1 - g_c^{\text{sc}}$$

FIGURE 7. A representative strict-supercritical envelope configuration. Its outgoing bound is unconditional; only a center-free edge permits the complementary next-V-triangle bound.

The interval and strict-supercritical transfer domains

schematic locations; set definitions are exact



$A_0 + B_0 > 1$: strict-supercritical V triangle $S_{1/2}$ is an input-coordinate set; its supremal output is not attained by a strict-supercritical V triangle. $g_{1/2}^{sc} := 1/2$ is the continuous endpoint value, not a supremum over a nonempty $S_{1/2}$.

FIGURE 8. The interval family $\mathfrak{J}$, strict-supercritical input set, and its supremal output, shown on the skeleton.

(d) slotwise lower relaxation along skeleton V triangles

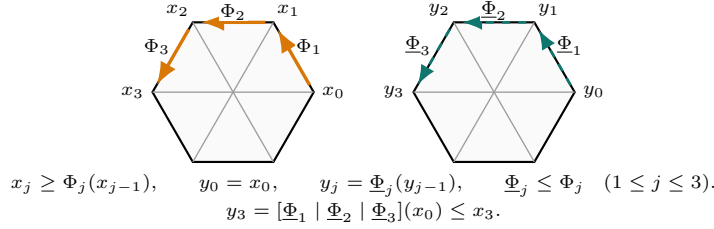
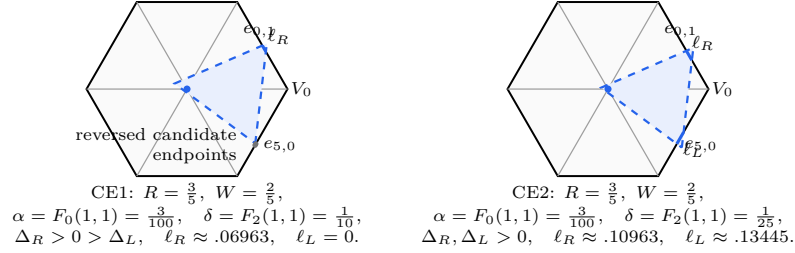


FIGURE 9. Exact and lower-relaxed iterates placed on successive V triangles.

(g) two exact signed-center examples on the full skeleton



α, δ are affine side-slack values at O , not drawn lengths; the blue boundary segments are the metric traces.

FIGURE 10. Representative CE1 and CE2 center triangles on the full skeleton. The blue segments are the geometric boundary traces; exact parameter equations are in Appendix E.

3. STRATEGY 1: TRACE BUDGETS

For a closed triangle T and a rectifiable target E , write

$$L_E(T) = \mathcal{H}^1(T \cap E).$$

If the seven open roles cover E , closure and subadditivity give

$$\mathcal{H}^1(E) \leq L_E(T_C) + \sum_{i=0}^5 L_E(T_i).$$

Strategy 1 contradicts this inequality on either ∂H or the full skeleton S .



∂H : length 6



S : length 12

the full-skeleton estimate is used only under its stated branch hypotheses

FIGURE 11. The perimeter and the conditional full-skeleton target.

The proof uses only the numerical trace caps stated below.

Proposition 3.1 (Trace-cap register). *For every classified V triangle T_i , the boundary trace is supported on its two incident boundary edges, and therefore*

$$L_{\partial H}(T_i) = A_i + B_i.$$

Under the hypotheses indicated in each table entry, the following unified trace bounds hold.

triangle role and target	upper bound
CE1/CE2 center on S	$L_S(T_C) < 3/2$
supercritical vertex role on S	$L_S(T_i) < 3/2$
vertex role with positive adjacent-arm support on S	$L_S(T_i) < 3/2$
nonsupercritical role with no adjacent-arm support on S	$L_S(T_i) \leq 2$
CE1 center on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_C) \leq \sqrt{3}/2 - 3/4$
CE2 center on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_C) < 1/2$
supercritical Vd0 V triangle on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_i) \leq 2/\sqrt{3}$
Vd1 or Vd2 V triangle on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_i) < 1/2$
nonsupercritical Vd0 V triangle on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_i) \leq 1$
T3-like V triangle on ∂H	$L_{\partial H}(T_i) < 1$

Proof. The four skeleton bounds are Lemmas F.1, F.4, F.2, and F.3. The boundary bounds are the signed center formula and the vertex trace atlas in Appendix F. $\square$

Two abstract sums explain every Strategy 1 route. First, if there are $q \geq 3$ short roles, Proposition 3.1 gives

$$L_S(T_C) + \sum_i L_S(T_i) < \frac{3}{2} + q\frac{3}{2} + (6-q)2 = \frac{27-q}{2} \leq 12,$$

contradicting $\mathcal{H}^1(S) = 12$.

Second, put

$$\theta = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} - 1.$$

Suppose a perimeter branch has:

- center contribution L_C ;
- n supercritical Vd0 V triangles, each with contribution at most $2/\sqrt{3}$;
- $r \geq 1$ distinguished nonsupercritical V triangles with strict caps $q_1, \dots, q_r < 1$;
- every remaining V triangle with contribution at most 1.

If

$$L_C + n\theta \leq \sum_{j=1}^r (1 - q_j),$$

then the total perimeter contribution is strictly below six. This is the master perimeter deficit. The fourth hypothesis is part of the statement; it is supplied in every application by the vertex classification and the actual supercritical count.

Proposition 3.2 (Branches closed by Strategy 1). *Strategy 1 closes:*

- (1) CE0, $N_+ = 0$;
- (2) CE0, $N_+ = 1$, with a Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (3) CE1/CE2 with $q = N_+ + m \geq 3$;
- (4) CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$, with a Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (5) CE1, $N_+ = 1$, with exactly one Vd1/Vd2 role and no T3-like role;
- (6) the Vd2 neighboring-midpoint subcase of the CE2 hybrid routing entry.

Proof. The first branch is closed by the cyclic boundary sum. The third branch is closed by the skeleton sum above. The remaining branches substitute the center and distinguished vertex caps into the master perimeter deficit, with all unlisted V triangles bounded by one. The exact substitutions and strictness are Proposition F.11 and Corollary F.17. $\square$

4. STRATEGY 2: PROPAGATING BOUNDARY DEMAND

Strategy 2 is the only part of the proof in which local information is propagated through several consecutive vertex roles. Its geometric content is simple. A V triangle that must reach far on its incoming boundary edge and on its own radial arm has a bounded outgoing reach. If the next boundary edge is covered, that outgoing upper bound becomes a lower bound for the next incoming reach. Repeating this implication either creates a strict cycle, exhausts the two endpoint capacities of a center-free path, returns more demand than the unique supercritical V triangle can supply, or separates two radial traces.

The body deliberately suppresses the formulas producing the numerical parameters. Geometry is used here only to select a certificate type and to produce its parameter record. Appendix I then states each calculation as a real-variable optimization problem, and Appendix L verifies the required inequalities. Thus the reader need not carry the signed center coordinates, contact labels, radical roots, and relaxation coefficients through the geometric argument.

4.1. One chain interface.

Definition 4.1 (Certified transfer chain). A *certified transfer chain* consists of consecutive V triangles $T_{i_0}, \dots, T_{i_m}$, lower bounds $x_0, \dots, x_m$ for their incoming boundary reaches, and one justified handoff at each intermediate edge. Each handoff is one of the following.

- (1) An exact center-free or center-assisted transfer supplied by Proposition 2.10.
- (2) The identity relaxation $x_{j+1} \geq x_j$. This relaxation is permitted only when T_{i_j} is nonsupercritical, the handoff edge is center-free, and every nonincident role has zero-length trace on that edge.
- (3) A branch-specific affine, threshold, quarter-radial, or Vd-corner lower bound whose domain and pointwise validity are stated in Appendix I.

The order of the chain is geometric: the first recorded handoff acts first. Writing an identity slot asserts only the individual inequality $x_{j+1} \geq x_j$; it does not assert a separate pointwise comparison between two formal compositions.

(d) slotwise lower relaxation along skeleton V triangles

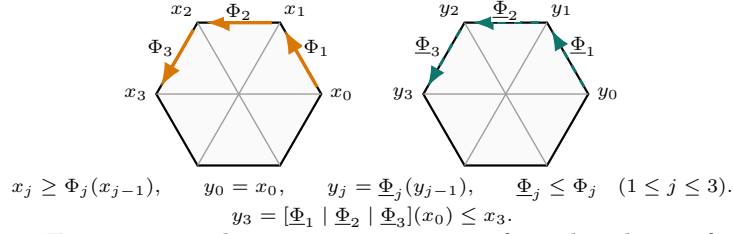


FIGURE 12. The geometric content of a relaxed transfer chain. Endpoint center traces are first absorbed into residual demands. Only the verified center-free internal handoffs may then be weakened to identity propagation.

Definition 4.2 (Center-free ordinary boundary path). A consecutive boundary path is *center-free ordinary* when, on every internal edge, the center role has empty trace and every role other than the two incident path roles has zero-length trace. Endpoint contributions from roles outside the path must be incorporated into the two endpoint residuals before the path is used.

Proposition 4.3 (Four possible endings of a transfer chain). *Every Strategy 2 certificate has one of the following endings.*

- (1) Strict cycle: *six center-free nonsupercritical handoffs force $A_0 < A_1 < \dots < A_5 < A_0$.*
- (2) Endpoint deficit: *after all external endpoint contributions are absorbed, the two endpoint capacities have sum strictly below one; the center-free path budget is then impossible.*
- (3) Returned-demand excess: *a five-V-triangle chain returns a lower bound Z while the remaining role has the strict upper bound $A_0 < 1 - H$, and the analytic certificate gives $Z > 1 - H$.*
- (4) Radial separation: *the analytic endpoint bounds leave a nonempty interval between the vertex-side and center-side radial traces.*

Proof. The handoff induction is Proposition 2.10. The endpoint conclusion is Lemma C.6. The strict upper bound in the returned-demand case is the exact one-gap actual-V-triangle interface. The radial cases use the branch-specific terminal statements in Proposition 4.17. $\square$

4.2. The all-Vd0 kernel.

Definition 4.4 (V-gaps and active-gap rank). On the boundary edge $e_{i,i+1}$, let Γ_i be the closed set left uncovered by the two incident open vertex roles. Equivalently, with the standard edge parameter,

$$\Gamma_i = \begin{cases} [B_i, 1 - A_{i+1}], & B_i \leq 1 - A_{i+1}, \\ \emptyset, & B_i > 1 - A_{i+1}. \end{cases}$$

A nonempty Γ_i is a *V-gap*; equality gives a singleton V-gap. In a hypothetical cover every V-gap lies in a center trace. The *active-gap rank* gr is the number of positive center traces that contain a V-gap. Hence

$$\text{gr} \in \{0, 1, 2\}, \quad \text{gr} \leq 1 \quad \text{in CE1.}$$

The all-Vd0 cases are organized by one small table.

	$\text{gr} = 0$	$\text{gr} = 1$	$\text{gr} = 2$
$N_+ = 0$	strict cycle	one-gap endpoints	paired endpoints
$N_+ = 1$	nine-point obstruction	five-V-triangle return	paired endpoints.

The last column is CE2-only. Thus Strategy 2 does not need a different calculus for each cell: it uses one transfer interface with three terminal shapes.

For $N_+ = 0$ and $\text{gr} = 0$, the vertex traces alone cover every boundary edge. Proposition 2.10 gives

$$A_{i+1} > 1 - B_i \geq \widehat{g}_{C_i}^\vee(A_i) \geq A_i,$$

and the strict cycle is immediate. For $N_+ = 1$ and $\text{gr} = 0$, no transfer calculation is needed; this cell is owned by Strategy 4.

4.3. Endpoint certificates.

Definition 4.5 (Signed Strategy 2 domains). After normalizing one positive center trace, the signed-center lemma produces a record (R, α, δ) . The full CE1 and CE2 center cells correspond under

$$r = R, \quad a = \alpha, \quad d = \delta$$

to $\mathcal{D}_{C1}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{C2}$, respectively. In the oriented CE1 all-Vd0 one-gap branch the additional endpoint order gives the smaller cell $\mathcal{D}_1$; the CE2 cell is $\mathcal{D}_2 = \mathcal{D}_{C2}$.

Definition 4.6 (One-gap and paired-gap endpoint records). The signed-center geometry associates to a normalized one-gap state an endpoint record

$$\mathbf{e}_{\text{one}} = (a_-, a_+, c_-, c_+) \in [0, 1]^4.$$

In CE2 it associates to a two-gap state a second record $\mathbf{e}_{\text{two}} \in [0, 1]^4$. The entries are, respectively, the two incoming boundary demands and the two complementary radial demands at the ends of the intervening center-free path. Their explicit functions of (R, α, δ) are the data of Problems I.7 and I.8.

For an endpoint record $\mathbf{e} = (a_-, a_+, c_-, c_+)$, define its two-end capacity by

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}) := \widehat{g}_{c_-}(1 - a_-) + \widehat{g}_{c_+}(1 - a_+).$$

This is the only scalar output of the endpoint calculation used in the body.

Proposition 4.7 (All-Vd0 endpoint certificates). *The following strict inequalities hold.*

- (1) *For every normalized one-gap state in $\mathcal{D}_{\text{CE1}} \cup \mathcal{D}_{\text{CE2}}$,*

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{\text{one}}) < 1.$$

- (2) *For every normalized two-gap state in $\mathcal{D}_{\text{CE2}}$,*

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{\text{two}}) < 1.$$

The three V triangles strictly between the endpoint roles form a center-free ordinary path. Singleton V-gaps are included.

Proof. The two inequalities are Problems I.7 and I.8, proved in Appendix M. The geometric extraction of the endpoint records is the one-side and paired-endpoint interface. Applying Lemma C.6 to the three internal nonsupercritical roles gives the contradiction. $\square$

Definition 4.8 (Support-isolated T3-like endpoint record). In the $N_+ = 0$ branch with no Vd1 or Vd2 role, choose a T3-like role after the support-isolating translation and reflection. The exact geometric bridge in Appendix O produces one endpoint record

$$\mathbf{e}_{T3} = (a_5^*, a_1^*, c_5^*, c_1^*).$$

All center intervals are absorbed into a_5^*, a_1^* before the three interior V triangles are declared center-free. The four possible contact labels belong to

$$\{\text{Full}, L, T_-, T_+^{\text{hi}}\}.$$

Proposition 4.9 (T3-like endpoint certificate). *Every support-isolated T3-like endpoint record satisfies*

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{T3}) < 1.$$

The exact proof audits all feasible pairs of the four contact labels. No single unproved common envelope is substituted for that audit.

Proof. This is Theorem P.1. The endpoint record is formed before Lemma C.6 is applied, so every center and nonincident contribution is already accounted for. $\square$

4.4. The five-V-triangle return certificate.

Definition 4.10 (Decorated lower relaxations). A *decorated lower relaxation* is a nondecreasing function proved pointwise below one exact nonsupercritical transfer on an explicitly stated input interval. Strategy 2 uses only three forms: the identity, one affine chord on a selected T_+ branch, and one low-root threshold. Their formulas and validity domains are Definitions I.3 and I.4.

Definition 4.11 (Five-V-triangle analytic record). In the $N_+ = 1$, all-Vd0, one-gap branch, normalize the uniquely supercritical role as T_0 . The geometric bridge produces an initial demand X , a terminal cap H , and five radial parameters $\mathbf{c} = (c_1, \dots, c_5)$. Starting from X , apply the five exact nonsupercritical transfers in geometric order and call the returned lower bound Z . The exact functions of (R, α, δ) are recorded in Problems I.9 and I.10.

Definition 4.12 (Certified CE1 affine region). The set $\mathcal{D}_{\text{aff}} \subset \mathcal{D}_{\text{CE1}}$ is the part of the CE1 parameter domain on which two selected- T_+ affine chords and the final threshold are simultaneously licensed. Its exact inequalities belong to the branch decomposition of Problem I.9; they are not geometric assumptions.

Proposition 4.13 (Five-V-triangle one-gap certificate). *For every geometric state represented by the five-V-triangle analytic record, the actual reaches satisfy*

$$A_0 \geq Z, \quad A_0 < 1 - H.$$

Moreover,

$$Z > 1 - H.$$

In CE1 the proof uses two affine selected- T_+ relaxations followed by one threshold after the exact contact-label branches have been removed. In CE2 at least one of two threshold locations is available; both may be available, and no uniqueness is asserted.

Proof. The inequalities connecting A_0, Z, H are the exact actual-V-triangle interface. Problems I.9 and I.10 prove the complement-dual three-map inequalities. Extensivity of the first and fifth exact transfers then gives $Z > 1 - H$. Their verification is given in Appendix N. $\square$

The exact five-V-triangle one-gap chain on the hexagon; arrows record transfer order

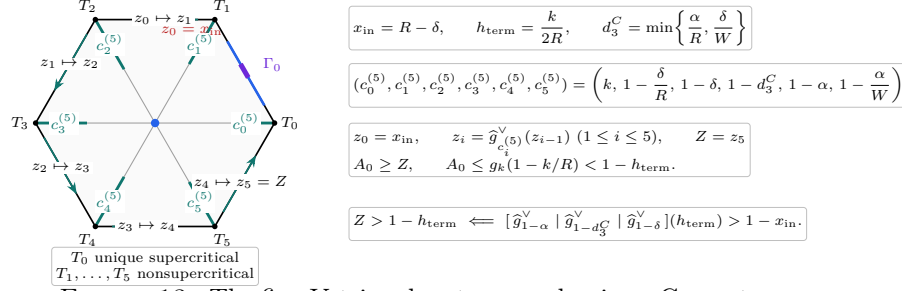


FIGURE 13. The five-V-triangle return mechanism. Geometry supplies the initial demand, five radial parameters, and the terminal cap; the appendix proves the single returned-demand inequality.

4.5. Special-role terminals.

Definition 4.14 (Adjacent-rescuer record). An adjacent T3-like or Vd1 rescuer is reduced to a boundary contribution, an adjacent-radial entry, and an uncovered radial tail. The non-symmetry translation used for the T3-like trace is eliminated in Definition I.14; the Vd1 corner record is eliminated in Definition I.15. After the bridge, no placement or translated-role predicate remains.

Definition 4.15 (CE2 Vd residual record). For a CE2 state with exactly one Vd1 or Vd2 role, the placement audit produces two center-assisted boundary residuals and one adjacent or nonadjacent radial record. The interval components are the explicit three-cell functions $\mathbf{E}$, $\mathbf{R}$, and the radial endpoints are the exact corner graph values in Problem S2-VD. No supremum remains in the analytic record.

Definition 4.16 (Vd1-supercritical replacement data). The remaining adjacent Vd1-supercritical placement uses two separate local vertex charts. The strict placement margins determine two open, nonsupercritical Vd0 replacements preserving full skeleton coverage. This is a geometric reduction, not a function-optimization problem.

Proposition 4.17 (Adjacent rescuer and Vd terminal certificates). *The special-role branches terminate as follows.*

- (1) Problem S2-SC gives the common strict-supercritical envelope mismatch for an adjacent T3-like or Vd1 rescuer.
- (2) Problem S2-VD-adjacent proves that every possible radial bridge ends strictly before the CE2 center trace begins.
- (3) Problem S2-VD-nonadjacent proves strict separation of the Vd and center radial intervals.
- (4) The remaining adjacent Vd1-supercritical placement reduces by the two-chart replacement to the already excluded all-Vd0 skeleton state.

Proof. Items 1–3 are Problems I.16, I.18, and I.20, connected to the geometric records by Appendix H. Their calculations are Lemmas G.2, G.3, G.6, and G.7. Item 4 is Proposition P.2. $\square$

geometric branch	reader-visible ending	analytic record
$N_+ = 0$, all Vd0, gr = 0	strict cyclic ascent	no optimization
$N_+ = 0$, all Vd0, gr = 1	two-end capacity < 1	Problem I.7
CE2, gr = 2	paired two-end capacity < 1	Problem I.8
$N_+ = 0$, T3-like, no Vd1/Vd2	finite four-label capacity < 1	Problem I.13
CE1, $N_+ = 1$, all Vd0, one gap	returned demand exceeds cap	Problem I.9
CE2, $N_+ = 1$, all Vd0, one gap	inclusive threshold disjunction	Problem I.10
one T3-like or adjacent Vd1 rescuer	supercritical envelope mismatch	Problem I.16
adjacent Vd1/Vd2	two explicit radial graph signs	Problem I.18
nonadjacent Vd1/Vd2	four explicit separation signs	Problem I.20
Vd1-supercritical adjacent pair	two-chart all-Vd0 reduction	geometric proposition

TABLE 2. Strategy 2 after separating geometry, parameter extraction, and optimization.

4.6. Certificate register.

Proposition 4.18 (Branches closed by Strategy 2). *Strategy 2 closes:*

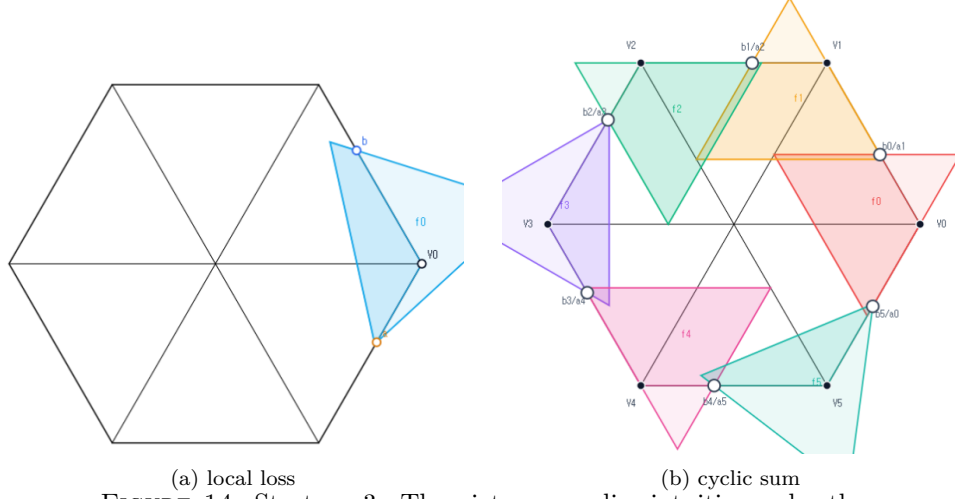
- (1) the $N_+ = 0$ all-Vd0 and T3-like-without-Vd1/Vd2 branches for CE1 and CE2;
- (2) every nonempty-gap $N_+ = 1$ all-Vd0 state;
- (3) the exactly-one-T3-like $N_+ = 1$ state with no Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (4) the complementary transfer placements in the CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 branch.

Singleton V-gaps are included.

Proof. Use Propositions 4.7, 4.13, 4.9, and 4.17. The complete CE2 one-Vd placement assembly is Proposition Q.1. The zero-gap $N_+ = 1$ all-Vd0 cell remains the Strategy 4 nine-point obstruction. $\square$

5. STRATEGY 3: AREA LOSS

Normalize the area of a unit equilateral triangle to one. Then H has area six. For a vertex role with selected adjacent boundary reaches a, b , let $\mathcal{L}(a, b)$ be the least normalized area forced outside the local hexagonal wedge.



(a) local loss (b) cyclic sum
FIGURE 14. Strategy 3. The picture supplies intuition only; the proof uses the three inequalities in Proposition 5.1.

Proposition 5.1 (Area-loss register). *For every feasible selected pair,*

$$\mathcal{L}(a, b) \geq \min\{a, b\}^2.$$

If $a + b > 1$, then

$$\mathcal{L}(a, b) \geq \max\{a, b\}^2.$$

For a T3-like role, $a + b \leq 1$, and for $0 \leq m \leq 1/2$,

$$a, b \geq m \implies \mathcal{L}(a, b) \geq 2m - 4m^2.$$

Proof. These are Theorems R.2 and R.3. Appendix R reduces every orientation to two affine normal forms and proves the inequalities there. The body uses only the three displayed losses. $\square$

Suppose strict boundary handoffs are selected and encoded by

$$(a_i, b_i) = (1 - x_{i-1}, x_i), \quad 0 < x_i < 1.$$

Put

$$\mu = \min_i x_i, \quad M = \max_i x_i.$$

Reflection and reversal replace x_i by $1 - x_{i-1}$, preserve every V triangle loss, and interchange μ with $1 - M$. Hence assume $\mu \leq 1 - M$; then every coordinate x_i and $1 - x_i$ is at least μ .

If at least two V triangles are supercritical, one ascent out of a minimum plateau contributes at least $(1 - \mu)^2$, a second ascent contributes strictly more than $1/4$, and the remaining four V triangles contribute at least μ^2 each. The total loss is strictly larger than

$$4\mu^2 + (1 - \mu)^2 + \frac{1}{4} = 5 \left(\mu - \frac{1}{5} \right)^2 + \frac{21}{20} > 1.$$

If there is exactly one supercritical V triangle, its unique ascent runs from the minimum to the maximum. A distinct T3-like V triangle then contributes at least

$2\mu - 4\mu^2$, the supercritical V triangle contributes at least $(1 - \mu)^2$, and the other four contribute at least μ^2 each. The sum is

$$(1 - \mu)^2 + (2\mu - 4\mu^2) + 4\mu^2 = 1 + \mu^2 > 1.$$

Thus the six vertex triangles have total inside area strictly below five; the center triangle adds at most one.

Proposition 5.2 (Branches closed by Strategy 3). *Strategy 3 closes:*

- (1) T_C is CE0 and $N_+ \geq 2$, with arbitrary vertex-role types;
- (2) T_C is CE0, $N_+ = 1$, no role is Vd1 or Vd2, and at least one role is T3-like.

Proof. In CE0 the six vertex roles cover the boundary, so Proposition 2.1 supplies strict selected handoffs preserving the actual supercritical pattern. The two cyclic sums above apply. This is Proposition R.5, whose local orientation calculations remain in Appendix R. $\square$

6. STRATEGY 4: DIRECT NINE-POINT FORCING

This section gives the geometric proof of the direct nine-point obstruction. The exact frontier calculations, moving-circle signs, Newton reduction, and adjacent cap overlaps are proved in Appendix S. The two mixed overlaps are completed by the formally incorporated exact certificate in Appendix T. The body uses those inputs only through the forcing lemmas and the four-overlap proposition below.

Assume throughout that all six vertex roles are Vd0, that they cover ∂H , and that exactly one actual boundary V triangle is supercritical. Rotate its index to 4. Lemma S.3 gives strict handoffs

$$(1) \quad x_3 < x_2 < x_1 < x_0 < x_5 < x_4,$$

and parameters

$$(2) \quad a = 1 - x_3, \quad b = x_4, \quad p = 1 - b, \quad q = 1 - a$$

with

$$(3) \quad 0 < a, b < 1, \quad a + b > 1, \quad a^2 + ab + b^2 < 1.$$

Every selected V triangle has incoming demand at least p and outgoing demand at least q .

6.1. Direct forcing of the disk and three frontier points. For $(x, y) \in [0, 1]^2$, write

$$c_{\max}(x, y) = \max\{c : (x, y, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}.$$

Let

$$c_* = c_{\max}(p, q), \quad h = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, \quad \eta = h(1 - c_*).$$

The six radial points

$$D_i = (1 - c_*)V_i, \quad 0 \leq i \leq 5,$$

are excluded from their matching roles by maximality, from the two adjacent roles by Vd0 locality, and from the other three roles by distance from their distinguished vertices. Lemma S.4 therefore gives

$$(4) \quad \mathcal{D}_\eta := \{X : \|X\| \leq \eta\} \subset U_C.$$

At the supercritical corner V_4 , the strict AB -frontier consists of two circle pieces and two line pieces. The two line pieces meet at Q_0 ; their first intersections with

the two actual adjacent-handoff unit circles are Q_- and Q_+ . The exact moving-circle signs in Lemma S.5 exclude all three points from the two adjacent roles. Direct vertex-distance inequalities exclude the remaining three nondistinguished roles, and exact frontier membership excludes the supercritical role. Lemma S.6 therefore gives

$$(5) \quad Q_-, Q_0, Q_+ \in U_C.$$

Consequently the center role contains the compact witness set

$$(6) \quad K_{\text{wit}} = \mathcal{D}_\eta \cup \{Q_-, Q_0, Q_+\}.$$

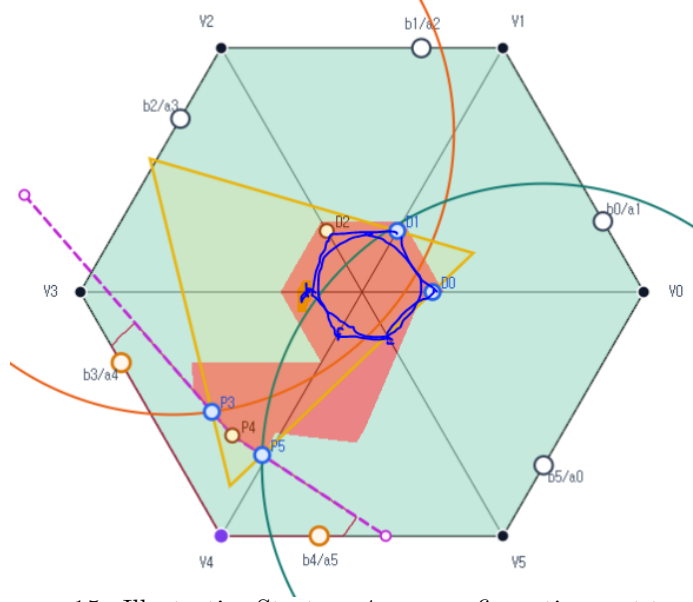


FIGURE 15. Illustrative Strategy 4 core configuration, not to scale. It is an example only; no exclusion, forcing, or enclosure inequality is inferred from the picture.

6.2. Newton inner points. The exact outer points Q_- and Q_+ contain two independent quadratic radicals. The construction in Lemma S.7 takes one Newton step inward on each frontier line. It gives points

$$A \in (Q_0, Q_-), \quad B = Q_0, \quad C \in (Q_0, Q_+)$$

whose coordinates are rational in a, b and the single radical

$$D = \sqrt{4(a^2 + ab + b^2) - 3}.$$

The same lemma gives

$$(7) \quad \widehat{K} := \text{conv}(\mathcal{D}_\eta \cup \{A, B, C\}) \subseteq \text{conv}(K_{\text{wit}}), \quad \Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}) \geq \Lambda(\widehat{K}).$$

6.3. The cap-chain lemma. Use the enclosure gauge Λ from Proposition C.1, and let R denote rotation through $2\pi/3$. For a disk $\mathbb{D}(X, r)$ define its level- h cap

$$I(X, r) = \{n \in S^1 : \langle X, n \rangle + r \geq h\}.$$

Lemma 6.1 (Cyclic cap chain). *Let K be compact and put*

$$S = K + RK + R^2K.$$

Suppose S contains the full R -orbits of

$$\mathbb{D}(A, 2\eta), \quad \mathbb{D}(B, 2\eta), \quad \mathbb{D}(C, 2\eta), \quad \mathbb{D}(W, \eta), \quad W = C + RA.$$

Assume that the rays

$$A, B, C, W, RA$$

occur in this cyclic order, each corresponding cap is a connected arc of half-width less than $\pi/2$, and the four consecutive pairs

$$\begin{aligned} I(A, 2\eta) &\leftrightarrow I(B, 2\eta), & I(B, 2\eta) &\leftrightarrow I(C, 2\eta), \\ I(C, 2\eta) &\leftrightarrow I(W, \eta), & I(W, \eta) &\leftrightarrow I(RA, 2\eta) \end{aligned}$$

overlap across their intervening short sectors. Then $\Lambda(K) \geq 1$.

Proof. The four overlaps and the cyclic ray order make the five caps cover the sector from the ray of A to the ray of RA . Their R -orbits cover the unit circle. For every unit normal n , one of the displayed disks therefore has support at least h in direction n . Since all those disks lie in S ,

$$h_S(n) \geq h.$$

On the other hand,

$$h_S(n) = \sum_{j=0}^2 h_K(R^j n).$$

Proposition C.1 now gives $\Lambda(K) \geq 1$. $\square$

6.4. The four verified overlaps. For $K = \widehat{K}$, the Minkowski sum in the cap-chain lemma contains the four required disk orbits: one witness point and two copies of the centered disk give the three radius- 2η orbits, while $C + RA$ and one disk copy give the radius- η orbit.

Proposition 6.2 (Four-overlap certificate). *Assume (3) and $c_* > 2/3$. The Newton points above satisfy*

$$\|A\|, \|C\| > \eta,$$

the rays A, B, C, W, RA occur in that cyclic order, and all four consecutive cap overlaps in Lemma 6.1 hold.

Proof. The ray order, radius bounds, and the two equal-radius adjacent overlaps are proved analytically in Proposition S.8. The remaining two mixed overlaps are Theorem T.3; its proof derives the exact Gram residuals, verifies the eight reduced integer polynomials by global positive-basis certificates, and then converts the residual signs back into common tangent support inequalities. These two parts supply precisely the four consecutive overlaps stated here. $\square$

6.5. Enclosure and the center-independent contradiction.

Theorem 6.3 (Reader-facing witness enclosure). *For every pair (a, b) satisfying (3),*

$$\Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}(a, b)) \geq 1.$$

Proof. The disk alone gives

$$\Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}) \geq \frac{3\eta}{h} = 3(1 - c_*),$$

so the result is immediate when $c_* \leq 2/3$. Assume $c_* > 2/3$. The Newton reduction (7), Proposition 6.2, and Lemma 6.1 give

$$\Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}) \geq \Lambda(\hat{K}) \geq 1.$$

□

Theorem 6.4 (Center-independent direct obstruction). *There is no cover of H by open unit equilateral triangles $U_C, U_0, \dots, U_5$ such that every U_i is a Vd0 role, the six vertex roles cover ∂H , and exactly one actual boundary V triangle is supercritical.*

Proof. Direct forcing gives the compact containment $K_{\text{wit}} \subset U_C$, whereas Theorem 6.3 gives $\Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}) \geq 1$. A compact subset of an open unit equilateral triangle has positive clearance from all three sides and is therefore contained in a closed equilateral triangle of side strictly below one. This would give $\Lambda(K_{\text{wit}}) < 1$, a contradiction. □

Proposition 6.5 (Branches closed by Strategy 4). *Theorem 6.4 closes*

- (1) *the CE0, $N_+ = 1$, all-Vd0 branch;*
- (2) *the zero-gap CE1 and CE2, $N_+ = 1$, all-Vd0 branches.*

Proof. In the CE0 branch, a boundary point missed by the six vertex roles would belong to the open center role and create a positive center trace, contrary to CE0. Thus the vertex roles cover ∂H . In the CE1 and CE2 branches, zero gaps mean exactly that the adjacent vertex traces cover every boundary edge. The exact-one hypothesis supplies the unique supercritical V triangle in all three cases, so Theorem 6.4 applies. □

7. EXHAUSTIVE ASSEMBLY

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Assume that seven open unit equilateral triangles cover H . Proposition 2.1 assigns the cover to exactly one entry of Table 1, with N_+ computed from actual maximal reaches and, in the CE1/CE2 branch, $q = N_+ + m$.

The Strategy 1 V triangles contradict Proposition 3.2. The Strategy 3 V triangles contradict Proposition 5.2. The all-Vd0, T3-like, and ordinary transfer V triangles contradict Proposition 4.18; their certificate types and analytic problem identifiers are recorded in Table 2. The complete CE2 exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 V triangle, including the neighboring-midpoint length subcase and every complementary placement, contradicts Proposition Q.1. The zero-gap all-Vd0 V triangles contradict Proposition 6.5; its two mixed cap overlaps are Theorem T.3.

No routing entry is omitted. Singleton gaps remain gaps, every center-assisted handoff is treated by a residual map, every identity path has center-free internal edges, and no actual criticality classification is inferred from a selected demand pair. Hence every entry of Table 1 is impossible, a contradiction. □

Corollary 1.2 follows from Proposition B.1.

APPENDIX A. TECHNICAL VERIFICATION ROADMAP

The body gives the complete geometric routing and identifies the terminal certificate used in every branch. The appendices then separate three tasks that must not be conflated:

- (1) *geometric extraction*: prove that a routed configuration produces a real parameter record in a named domain;
- (2) *optimization statement*: define only the real variables, branch domains, recurrences, and objective sign;
- (3) *verification*: prove that objective sign, branch by branch.

The proof is the body together with these verification modules and the formally incorporated electronic supplements. The body alone is not asserted to prove the calculation lemmas.

module	principal data	output used later
structural reduction	finite incidence and trace data	role types, strict handoffs, exhaustive routing
local enclosure	$a, b, c \in [0, 1]$	explicit admissible set, polynomial cells, radial envelope
signed center bridge	R, α, δ	CE sign, traces, exits, and the geometry-to-parameter map
trace budgets	one- and two-variable caps	perimeter and skeleton deficits
transfer interface	actual reaches, residual intervals	valid handoffs, center-free path budget, relaxed composition
Strategy 2 optimization registry	pure variables (r, a, d) , explicit piecewise F , branch domains	endpoint and returned-demand objective inequalities, with formalization status
Strategy 2 universal theorems	the explicit real domains and objectives	universal signs on every registered cell
Strategy 2 verification	branchwise radical and polynomial calculations	the algebraic lemmas used by the universal theorems
special-role bridges	T3, rescuer, and Vd real records	four-label endpoint, supercritical-envelope, and radial-separation targets
area loss	$a, b, t \in [0, 1]$	local square losses and cyclic sums
nine-point geometry	a, b on the strict frontier	forced witnesses, Newton placement, cap chain, adjacent overlaps
mixed-overlap certificate	U, z, D and exact sparse polynomials	two mixed cap intersections by exact symbolic verification

TABLE 3. Verification modules supporting the reader-facing proof.

Appendix I is the normative formalization interface for the scalar Strategy 2 calculations. Every registered domain is an explicit finite union of real cells, including the T3, adjacent-rescuer, and Vd cases. Section J proves the objective sign with the universal quantifier stated in each problem. Appendix H then proves only domain membership and objective identities for geometric configurations.

Polynomial expansions, root selection, rational parametrizations, monotonicity checks, Gram reductions, and Bernstein identities occur only in the verification appendices or in the exact electronic supplements identified by repository path, Git blob, and authenticated transcript. A machine verifier is used as part of the proof only where its exact input and algorithm are formally incorporated; a bare script invocation or claimed output is not treated as a proof.

Strategy 2 module boundary. Appendix H is the sole mixed geometry–analysis dictionary. Appendix I contains the geometry-free problem registry, including the explicit T3, rescuer, and Vd cells. Section J is the universal proof owner. The file `04_strategy2_verification.tex` is an input-only wrapper; its numbered `04e_strategy2_verification_*` modules separately own the registered applications and the preserved exact calculation sections.

APPENDIX B. STRUCTURAL REDUCTION TO FINITE CASES

Throughout, indices are taken in $\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z}$. Put

$$O = (0, 0), \quad V_i = \left(\cos \frac{i\pi}{3}, \sin \frac{i\pi}{3} \right), \quad H = \text{conv}\{V_0, \dots, V_5\}.$$

Thus H is the regular hexagon of side length one. We use the notation

$$e_{i,i+1} = [V_i, V_{i+1}], \quad r_i = [O, V_i], \quad M_i = \frac{1}{2}V_i,$$

and, when needed,

$$D = \bigcup_{i=0}^5 r_i, \quad S = \partial H \cup D, \quad S_{1/2} = \partial H \cup \{O, M_0, \dots, M_5\}.$$

The arms r_i meet only at O , up to sets of one-dimensional measure zero, and consequently

$$(8) \quad \mathcal{H}^1(\partial H) = 6, \quad \mathcal{H}^1(D) = 6, \quad \mathcal{H}^1(S) = 12.$$

For $L > 0$, $H_L := LH$ denotes the concentric regular hexagon of side length L . All symmetries used below belong to the dihedral group D_6 ; applying a symmetry always transports the indices, orientations, and incoming and outgoing labels together.

B.1. Open, closed, and scaled formulations.

Proposition B.1 (Compactness and scaling equivalence). *The following assertions are equivalent.*

- (1) *The set H is covered by seven open equilateral triangles of side length 1.*
- (2) *For some $\varepsilon > 0$, the set H is covered by seven closed equilateral triangles of side length $1 - \varepsilon$.*
- (3) *For some $L > 1$, the set H_L is covered by seven closed equilateral triangles of side length 1.*

Proof. Suppose that open unit triangles $U_1, \dots, U_7$ cover H . Define

$$m_j(p) = \text{dist}(p, \mathbb{R}^2 \setminus U_j), \quad m(p) = \max_{1 \leq j \leq 7} m_j(p).$$

The continuous function m is positive on the compact set H , so $\eta := \min_{p \in H} m(p) > 0$. Choose

$$0 < \rho < \min \left\{ \eta, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{6} \right\}.$$

Moving each side of U_j inward through distance ρ gives a closed equilateral triangle K_j of side $1 - 2\sqrt{3}\rho$. Every $p \in H$ has $m_j(p) \geq \eta > \rho$ for some j , and hence belongs to K_j . This proves (1) $\Rightarrow$ (2), with $\varepsilon = 2\sqrt{3}\rho$.

Conversely, enlarging a closed triangle of side $1 - \varepsilon$ about its incenter to an open triangle of side 1 preserves containment, proving (2) $\Rightarrow$ (1). Finally, dilation by $(1 - \varepsilon)^{-1}$ identifies (2) with (3), with

$$L = (1 - \varepsilon)^{-1} > 1.$$

□

We conduct the geometric argument in the open side-one model. Denote the original open triangles by U_C and U_i for $0 \leq i \leq 5$, and put

$$T_C = \overline{U_C}, \quad T_i = \overline{U_i}.$$

The distinction between U_i and T_i will be maintained: closure may add endpoints or tangencies, although it does not change area or one-dimensional trace measure.

Lemma B.2 (Distinct roles). *The seven triangles can be labelled so that*

$$O \in U_C, \quad V_i \in U_i \quad (0 \leq i \leq 5),$$

and these seven roles are distinct. Consequently

$$O \in \text{int}(T_C), \quad V_i \in \text{int}(T_i).$$

Proof. The seven distinguished points $O, V_0, \dots, V_5$ are pairwise at distance at least 1. Any two points of an open unit equilateral triangle are at distance strictly less than its diameter 1. Thus one open triangle contains at most one distinguished point. Selecting a covering triangle for each of the seven points gives an injection from seven points to seven triangles, hence a bijection and the asserted labelling. □

B.2. The center classification. For a closed center role define

$$N_E(T_C) = |\{i : T_C \cap e_{i,i+1} \text{ contains a positive-length interval}\}|.$$

Point contacts, endpoint contacts, and tangencies do not contribute. We say that T_C has type CE0, CE1, or CE2 according as $N_E(T_C)$ is 0, 1, or 2.

Proposition B.3 (Exhaustive center types). *Every center role has exactly one of the types CE0, CE1, and CE2. Equivalently,*

$$N_E(T_C) \leq 2.$$

Proof. Among any three edges of the six-cycle ∂H , two have no common endpoint. It is therefore enough to show that relative-interior points of two nonadjacent edges are more than unit distance apart. Up to symmetry there are two cases. For $0 < t, s < 1$, put

$$x = (1 - t)V_0 + tV_1.$$

If $y = (1 - s)V_2 + sV_3$, direct calculation gives

$$\|x - y\|^2 - 1 = (1 - t)(2 - t) + s(s + t) > 0.$$

If instead $y = (1 - s)V_3 + sV_4$ and $u = t + s$, then

$$\|x - y\|^2 - 1 = (u - 1)^2 + 2 > 0.$$

A unit equilateral triangle has diameter 1. It therefore cannot contain relative-interior points on two nonadjacent hexagon edges. Three positive-length edge traces would supply such a pair, a contradiction. $\square$

B.3. Vertex types and the T3-like normalization. For an original vertex role T_i , let

$$o(T_i) = |\{\text{vertices of } T_i \text{ outside } H\}|$$

and let $n(T_i)$ be the number of adjacent arms r_{i-1}, r_{i+1} having positive-length intersection with T_i . We use the names

type	(o, n)
Vd0	$(1, 0), (2, 0), (3, 0)$
Vd1	$(1, 1)$
Vd2	$(1, 2)$
T3-like	$(2, 1)$.

Lemma B.4 (Local wedge). *Every original vertex role has $1 \leq o \leq 3$. If it has positive-length intersection with one adjacent arm, at least one of its vertices belongs to H ; if it has positive-length intersection with both adjacent arms, at least two of its vertices belong to H .*

Proof. Normalize to $i = 0$ and write

$$X = V_0 + x(V_1 - V_0) + y(V_5 - V_0).$$

Then $V_0 = (0, 0)$,

$$\|(x, y)\|^2 = x^2 + y^2 - xy,$$

and, within the closed unit ball about V_0 , membership in H is equivalent to membership in the wedge

$$W = \{(x, y) : x \geq 0, y \geq 0\}.$$

Indeed,

$$x^2 + y^2 - xy = \left(y - \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 + \frac{3x^2}{4} = (x - y)^2 + xy$$

shows that $x, y \geq 0$ and norm at most one imply the remaining hexagon inequalities. The adjacent arms are

$$r_1 = \{(1, y) : 0 \leq y \leq 1\}, \quad r_5 = \{(x, 1) : 0 \leq x \leq 1\}.$$

Suppose $T_0 \cap r_1$ has positive length, and let m be the largest x -coordinate of a vertex of T_0 . If $m > 1$, a maximizing vertex (m, y) lies in the unit ball and hence satisfies $0 < y < 1$; it belongs to H . If $m = 1$, positive-length contact with the supporting line $x = 1$ forces a side of T_0 to lie there, and both endpoints satisfy $1 + y^2 - y \leq 1$, hence belong to H . The same argument applies to r_5 . If both arms are met but only one triangle vertex belonged to H , that vertex would have to have both $x > 1$ and $y > 1$. This is impossible because $(x - y)^2 + xy > 1$.

Finally, if all three triangle vertices belonged to the convex set H , then $T_0 \subset H$. This is incompatible with the extreme point V_0 lying in the interior of T_0 . Hence $o \geq 1$. $\square$

Proposition B.5 (Exhaustive vertex types). *Every original vertex role has exactly one of the four types Vd0, Vd1, Vd2, and T3-like.*

Proof. We have $n \in \{0, 1, 2\}$. Lemma B.4 gives $o \leq 2$ when $n \geq 1$, and $o \leq 1$ when $n = 2$. Together with $o \geq 1$, the possibilities are

n	possible o
0	1, 2, 3
1	1, 2
2	1,

which are precisely the four named classes. $\square$

The next normalization is useful for trace estimates, but its final warning is essential.

Proposition B.6 (T3-like closed-trace domination). *Let T be the closure of an original T3-like V_i -role. There is a translate $\hat{T}$ of T , with the same orientation and side length, such that*

$$V_i \in \text{relint}(a \text{ side of } \hat{T}), \quad T \cap H \subsetneq \hat{T} \cap H,$$

and $\hat{T}$ remains of type $(o, n) = (2, 1)$. Every old open interior point in $H \setminus \{V_i\}$ remains an interior point of $\hat{T}$. The point V_i itself becomes a boundary point, so $\hat{T}$ is a closed-trace majorant and is not a replacement open role.

Proof. Use the wedge coordinates of Lemma B.4. Set

$$D_t = 1 - t + t^2, \quad z = \sqrt{D_t}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$

After relabelling triangle vertices, every orientation belongs to one of the following two families:

	first side vector	second side vector
I	$z^{-1}(1, t)$	$z^{-1}(1 - t, 1)$
II	$z^{-1}(t, -(1 - t))$	$z^{-1}(1, t)$.

For Type I write

$$U = \alpha + y - tx, \quad V = \beta + x - (1 - t)y, \quad T = \{U \geq 0, V \geq 0, U + V \leq z\}.$$

Here $\alpha, \beta > 0$ and $\alpha + \beta < z$. Direct inversion shows that if exactly two triangle vertices are outside W , the sole wedge vertex has both coordinates strictly below 1: in the two possible cases its coordinates are bounded respectively by $(1 - t)/z$ and t/z , with the endpoint strictness supplied by $\alpha > 0$ or $\beta > 0$. The support argument in Lemma B.4 then excludes positive-length contact with either $x = 1$ or $y = 1$. Thus Type I cannot be T3-like.

For Type II write

$$U = \alpha + (1 - t)x + ty, \quad V = \beta + tx - y, \quad T = \{U \geq 0, V \geq 0, U + V \leq z\}.$$

Reflecting in $x = y$ if necessary, assume the supported adjacent arm is r_1 . The two outside vertices have respectively a negative x - and a negative y -coordinate, while the unique wedge vertex is

$$Q = \left(\frac{z - \alpha - t\beta}{D_t}, \frac{t(z - \alpha) + (1 - t)\beta}{D_t} \right).$$

The endpoint cases $t = 0, 1$ give no positive adjacent interval, so $0 < t < 1$. The exact axis reaches are

$$A = \beta, \quad B = z - \alpha - \beta,$$

and T3-like support is equivalent to

$$Q_x > 1, \quad Q_y \leq 1.$$

Define $\widehat{T}$ by replacing α with 0 and keeping t, β fixed. Since the linear map $(x, y) \mapsto (U, V)$ is nonsingular, this changes only the translation. At the origin, $\widehat{U} = 0$ and $0 < \widehat{V} = \beta < z$, so V_0 is in the relative interior of a side. For $(x, y) \in W$,

$$\widehat{U} = (1-t)x + ty \geq 0, \quad \widehat{V} = V, \quad \widehat{U} + \widehat{V} = U + V - \alpha.$$

Thus $T \cap W \subset \widehat{T} \cap W$. The old x -axis reach is B and the new one is $B + \alpha$; because $B < 1$ and $\alpha > 0$, the inclusion is strict inside H .

The two outside vertices remain outside, whereas V_0 and the new wedge vertex lie in H , so $o = 2$. Moreover $\widehat{Q}_x > Q_x > 1$. From $Q_x > 1$ one gets $t\beta < z - \alpha - D_t$, and hence

$$tD_t(1 - \widehat{Q}_y) > D_t(1 - z) + (1-t)\alpha > 0.$$

Thus $\widehat{Q}_y < 1$ and $n = 1$. Finally, for every nonzero point of W , $\widehat{U} > 0$; the displayed slack relations show that every old interior point other than the origin remains interior. $\square$

B.4. Reach coordinates, supercritical V triangles, and gaps. For the original vertex role U_i , define its actual maximal incoming, outgoing, and radial reaches by

$$\begin{aligned} A(U_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(V_{i-1} - V_i) \in U_i}} t, \\ B(U_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(V_{i+1} - V_i) \in U_i}} t, \\ C(U_i) &= \sup_{\substack{t \in [0,1] \\ V_i + t(O - V_i) \in U_i}} t. \end{aligned}$$

Closure does not change the suprema, so

$$A(U_i) = A(T_i), \quad B(U_i) = B(T_i), \quad C(U_i) = C(T_i).$$

For compact indexed formulas, put

$$A_i := A(U_i) = A(T_i), \quad B_i := B(U_i) = B(T_i), \quad C_i := C(U_i) = C(T_i).$$

The closure T_i contains the corresponding endpoints. We reserve lowercase (a_i, b_i, c_i) for selected or prescribed lower-bound demands whenever actual and selected values occur together. A realizing role then satisfies

$$A_i \geq a_i, \quad B_i \geq b_i, \quad C_i \geq c_i.$$

An actual V triangle is supercritical if $A_i + B_i > 1$, and

$$(9) \quad N_+ = |\{i : A_i + B_i > 1\}|.$$

This definition never counts a smaller demand pair in place of the actual V triangle.

Parametrize $e_{i,i+1}$ by

$$X_i(x) = V_i + x(V_{i+1} - V_i), \quad 0 \leq x \leq 1.$$

The two incident open traces are

$$U_i \cap e_{i,i+1} = [0, B_i), \quad U_{i+1} \cap e_{i,i+1} = (1 - A_{i+1}, 1]$$

in this coordinate. A *boundary gap* on this edge is the nonempty closed complement between these two traces,

$$[B_i, 1 - A_{i+1}] \quad \text{when } B_i \leq 1 - A_{i+1}.$$

In particular, equality gives a singleton gap. This convention records the actual open traces; a point missing from both open roles is not erased merely because both closures contain it.

Lemma B.7 (Exhaustiveness of the gap split). *On each edge the complement of the two incident vertex-role traces is either empty or one closed interval; a singleton interval counts as a gap. Every edge having a gap has positive-length intersection with the open center role. Consequently a CE0 center permits no gaps, a CE1 center permits at most one, and a CE2 center permits at most two.*

Proof. The two incident traces are intervals issuing from the two endpoints, so their complement is exactly the interval displayed above when nonempty. A nonincident vertex role cannot contain a relative-interior point of the edge: that point is more than unit distance from the role's distinguished vertex. Thus every point of a gap lies in U_C . Because U_C is open, its intersection with that edge contains a relative neighborhood and hence has positive length. Different gap edges therefore give different edges counted by $N_E(T_C)$. Proposition B.3 gives the three stated bounds, including singleton gaps. $\square$

Lemma B.8 (T3-like V triangles are nonsupercritical). *Every original T3-like V triangle satisfies*

$$(10) \quad A_i + B_i \leq 1.$$

In particular, it is not counted by N_+ .

Proof. The proof of Proposition B.6 showed that a T3-like role has Type II orientation with

$$A_i = \beta, \quad B_i = z - \alpha - \beta, \quad z = \sqrt{1 - t + t^2} \leq 1.$$

Thus $A_i + B_i = z - \alpha \leq 1$. The same conclusion holds after reflection. $\square$

We record the precise transfer from actual V triangles to strict handoff demands. Its hypothesis that the six vertex roles themselves cover the boundary is part of the statement.

Proposition B.9 (Strict boundary handoffs). *Assume that $U_0, \dots, U_5$ cover ∂H . On each edge choose*

$$x_i \in (1 - A_{i+1}, B_i)$$

and define

$$a_i = 1 - x_{i-1}, \quad b_i = x_i.$$

Then $0 < a_i < A_i$, $0 < b_i < B_i$, the two selected anchors lie in U_i , and

$$a_i^2 + a_i b_i + b_i^2 < 1.$$

Moreover:

- (1) *if exactly one actual V triangle, indexed by p , is supercritical, every strict selection has exactly one selected supercritical V triangle, also indexed by p ;*
- (2) *if at least two actual V triangles are supercritical, some simultaneous strict selection has at least two selected supercritical V triangles.*

Proof. Because V_i is interior to a diameter-one closed triangle,

$$0 < A_i < 1, \quad 0 < B_i < 1.$$

No nonincident vertex role contains a relative-interior point of $e_{i,i+1}$, since such a point is more than unit distance from its distinguished vertex. The two displayed incident traces therefore cover the edge and, being relatively open and nonempty, overlap. Hence each interval $(1 - A_{i+1}, B_i)$ is nonempty. The anchor and distance assertions follow from the choice and from the fact that two points of U_i are at distance strictly less than one.

Put $\ell_i = 1 - A_{i+1}$ and $u_i = B_i$. Then

$$(11) \quad A_i + B_i > 1 \iff \ell_{i-1} < u_i, \quad a_i + b_i > 1 \iff x_{i-1} < x_i.$$

If actual V triangle i is nonsupercritical, then

$$x_i < u_i \leq \ell_{i-1} < x_{i-1},$$

so every selected version of it is strictly subcritical. Also

$$(12) \quad \sum_{i=0}^5 (a_i + b_i) = \sum_{i=0}^5 (1 - x_{i-1} + x_i) = 6.$$

If p is the sole actual supercritical index, the other five selected sums are strictly below one; equation (12) forces the p th sum above one. This proves (1).

For (2), first take two nonadjacent supercritical indices p, q . For each $r \in \{p, q\}$ choose

$$\ell_{r-1} < z_r < u_r,$$

then choose

$$x_{r-1} \in (\ell_{r-1}, \min\{u_{r-1}, z_r\}), \quad x_r \in (\max\{\ell_r, z_r\}, u_r).$$

The two pairs of variables are disjoint and give ascents at p, q . Any set of at least three indices on a six-cycle contains two nonadjacent indices. It remains to consider exactly two adjacent supercritical indices $p, p+1$. For the other four nonsupercritical V triangles, successive inequalities $\ell_i < u_i \leq \ell_{i-1}$ give

$$\ell_{p-1} < \ell_{p+1}.$$

Together with supercriticality at $p, p+1$, this implies

$$\max\{\ell_{p-1}, \ell_p\} < \min\{u_p, u_{p+1}\}.$$

Choose x_p between these bounds and then choose $x_{p-1} < x_p < x_{p+1}$ in their respective overlap intervals. By (11), both adjacent V triangles are selected supercritical. $\square$

B.5. Midpoint forcing. We first need a local fact for vertex roles. Take unit vectors

$$u = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right), \quad v = \left(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right).$$

Lemma B.10 (Self-midpoint obstruction). *Let a closed unit triangle contain*

$$0, \quad au, \quad bv, \quad \frac{u+v}{2}.$$

Then $a + b \leq 1$. Consequently, for every vertex role,

$$M_i \in T_i \implies A_i + B_i \leq 1.$$

If the two demanded boundary points and the midpoint are contained with a positive margin, the conclusion is strict.

Proof. Suppose $a + b > 1$ and set

$$K = \text{conv} \left\{ 0, au, \frac{u+v}{2}, bv \right\}.$$

For outward unit normals n_0, n_1, n_2 separated by 120° , the least equilateral triangle with those normals and containing K has side length

$$\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \sum_{j=0}^2 h_K(n_j).$$

The finite-caliper theorem, Theorem S.1, reduces its minimum to an outward normal of one of the four edges of K .

For the edge from 0 to au , direct projection gives

$$S_{0A} = \max \left\{ \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}, \frac{\sqrt{3}a}{2} \right\} + \frac{\sqrt{3}b}{2} > \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2};$$

if $a \geq 1/2$ this is $(\sqrt{3}/2)(a+b)$, and if $a < 1/2$ then $b > 1/2$. The edge through bv is symmetric. For the edge from au to $(u+v)/2$, put $D_a = \sqrt{4a^2 - 2a + 1}$. Projection gives

$$S_{AM} = \begin{cases} \frac{\sqrt{3}(a+b)}{2D_a}, & a \leq \frac{1}{2}, \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}(2a^2+b)}{2D_a}, & a > \frac{1}{2}. \end{cases}$$

The first value is strictly above $\sqrt{3}/2$ because $D_a \leq 1$. In the second case, $b > 1 - a$ and

$$(2a^2 - a + 1)^2 - D_a^2 = a^2(2a - 1)^2 \geq 0,$$

so again $S_{AM} > \sqrt{3}/2$. The fourth edge is symmetric. Every enclosing equilateral triangle therefore has side greater than one, a contradiction.

If equality $a + b = 1$ occurred while all relevant points had positive margin, both boundary demands could be increased slightly; the closed conclusion would then be violated. $\square$

The corresponding center fact is exact and uses the interior condition at O .

Proposition B.11 (Unique center midpoint). *Let T_C be a closed unit equilateral triangle with $O \in \text{int}(T_C)$. If T_C has positive-length intersection with a boundary edge of H , then it contains exactly one of $M_0, \dots, M_5$.*

Proof. Normalize the positive trace by a dihedral symmetry. Proposition E.1 gives a single signed side-slack model for both CE1 and CE2 and proves directly that its midpoint set is $\{M_0\}$. Undoing the normalization proves the assertion. $\square$

Remark B.12. The hypothesis $O \in \text{int}(T_C)$ cannot be weakened to $O \in T_C$: the triangle $\text{conv}\{O, V_0, V_1\}$ has a boundary-edge overlap and contains both M_0 and M_1 .

Proposition B.13 (Exhaustive structural reduction). *Every hypothetical cover by seven open unit equilateral triangles admits the distinct center and vertex roles used in Table 1, and its actual reaches determine exactly one V triangle of that table.*

Proof. Lemma B.2 gives the seven roles. Propositions B.3 and B.5 give the exhaustive and mutually exclusive center and vertex types. The actual reaches determine exactly one of $N_+ = 0$, $N_+ = 1$, and $N_+ \geq 2$. For CE0 these data and the vertex classification give the five displayed V triangles.

Now suppose the center is CE1 or CE2. It contains exactly one radial midpoint by Proposition B.11. Lemma F.16 gives $q = N_+ + m$, and Lemma F.5, together with the disjoint count, shows that $N_+ \geq 2$ forces a third short role. Hence every such branch either enters the first CE1/CE2 V triangle or has $q \leq 2$ and $N_+ \leq 1$. If $N_+ = 0$, the vertex classification gives, in order, all Vd0, at least one Vd1/Vd2, or no such role and at least one T3-like. If $N_+ = 1$, then $q \leq 2$ implies $m \leq 1$: the roles are all Vd0, exactly one T3-like, or exactly one Vd1/Vd2. In the all-Vd0 case, Lemma B.7 supplies the exhaustive zero-gap/nonempty-gap split. These alternatives are disjoint, proving the claim. $\square$

APPENDIX C. UNIVERSAL ENCLOSURE AND TRANSFER CALCULUS

This section collects the geometry shared by the transfer and direct-witness arguments. The same equilateral enclosure functional governs the local admissible set of Strategy 2 and the forced witness set of Strategy 4. The transfer statements below distinguish three situations that must not be conflated: a center-free edge, an edge with a specified center interval, and a free strict-supercritical outgoing envelope.

C.1. The equilateral enclosure gauge. Let R denote counterclockwise rotation through $2\pi/3$. For a nonempty compact set $K \subset \mathbb{R}^2$, put

$$h_K(n) = \max_{x \in K} \langle x, n \rangle$$

and

$$(13) \quad \Lambda(K) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \min_{\|n\|=1} \sum_{j=0}^2 h_K(R^j n).$$

Proposition C.1 (Equilateral enclosure gauge). *The number $\Lambda(K)$ is the least side length of a closed equilateral triangle containing K . It is monotone under inclusion, translation invariant, and positively homogeneous. If K is a finite polygonal hull, a minimizing normal may be chosen perpendicular to one of its hull edges.*

Proof. For a fixed unit normal n , the three supporting half-planes with outward normals n, Rn, R^2n form an equilateral triangle. Its side is $2/\sqrt{3}$ times the sum of the three support numbers, proving (13). Monotonicity and homogeneity are immediate, while translation invariance follows from

$$n + Rn + R^2n = 0.$$

On an open normal-direction cell with three fixed support points, the support sum has the form $A \cos \theta + B \sin \theta$ and has second derivative equal to its negative. In the nondegenerate case an interior critical point is a maximum. Hence a minimum occurs at a cell boundary, where one support line contains a hull edge. $\square$

For the local demand hull

$$K(a, b, c) = \text{conv}\{0, au, bv, c(u+v)\},$$

where u and v are the two unit boundary directions meeting at 120° , the admissible set is

$$(14) \quad \mathcal{A} = \{(a, b, c) \in [0, 1]^3 : \Lambda(K(a, b, c)) \leq 1\}.$$

The complete support calculation is given in Appendix D.

C.2. One equilateral radical. For $0 \leq x \leq 1$, define

$$(15) \quad \omega(x) = \sqrt{1 - x + x^2}, \quad \sigma(x) = 1 - \omega(x).$$

Then

$$(16) \quad \omega(1 - x) = \omega(x), \quad \sigma(x) = \frac{x(1 - x)}{1 + \omega(x)},$$

and direct differentiation gives

$$(17) \quad \sigma''(x) = -\frac{3}{4\omega(x)^3} < 0.$$

Thus σ is strictly concave. In the signed center calculus,

$$E = \omega(R), \quad \eta = \sigma(R).$$

For $0 < x < 1$, put $z = \sigma(x)/x$. Eliminating the square root gives

$$(18) \quad x = \frac{1 - 2z}{1 - z^2}, \quad \sigma(x) = \frac{z(1 - 2z)}{1 - z^2}, \quad 0 < z < \frac{1}{2}.$$

C.3. One g -family. For $0 \leq x, c \leq 1$, define

$$(19) \quad g_c(x) = \max\{y \in [0, 1] : (1 - x, y, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}, \quad \widehat{g}_c(x) = \min\{g_c(x), x\}.$$

For any map $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$, put

$$(20) \quad f^\vee(a) = 1 - f(1 - a).$$

Hence

$$(21) \quad \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a) = 1 - \widehat{g}_c(1 - a) \geq a.$$

The exact appendix aliases are

$$(22) \quad B_c(a) = g_c(1 - a), \quad F_c(a) = \widehat{g}_c(1 - a), \quad G_c(a) = \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a).$$

Lemma C.2 (Raw and capped actual-V triangle transfer). *Let T be an actual V triangle satisfying $A(T) \geq a$ and $C(T) \geq c$, and let T_{next} be the next incident actual V triangle. Then*

$$B(T) \leq g_c(1 - a).$$

If no center interval intervenes on the next edge, then

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq g_c^\vee(a).$$

If T is nonsupercritical, then

$$B(T) \leq \widehat{g}_c(1 - a),$$

and, on a center-free next edge,

$$A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a) \geq a.$$

Proof. The closure of T realizes $(a, B(T), c)$, so the definition of g_c gives the outgoing bound. On a center-free edge, coverage gives $A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq 1 - B(T)$, and complementation proves the raw transfer. Under nonsupercriticality, $B(T) \leq 1 - A(T) \leq 1 - a$, so $B(T) \leq \min\{g_c(1 - a), 1 - a\} = \widehat{g}_c(1 - a)$. The final assertion follows in the same way. $\square$

Proposition C.3 (Zero-radial distinction). *For $0 < x < 1$,*

$$g_0(x) > x, \quad \widehat{g}_0(x) = x,$$

and therefore

$$g_0^\vee(a) < a, \quad \widehat{g}_0^\vee(a) = a \quad (0 < a < 1).$$

Proof. The exact diameter formula gives

$$g_0(x) = \frac{x - 1 + \sqrt{1 + 6x - 3x^2}}{2}.$$

Since

$$1 + 6x - 3x^2 - (1 + x)^2 = 4x(1 - x) > 0,$$

one has $g_0(x) > x$. The remaining assertions follow from the definitions. $\square$

C.4. Center-assisted transfers and the free envelope. Let $J \subseteq [0, 1]$ be empty or a closed interval. For $0 \leq p \leq 1$, put

$$e_J(p) = \sup\{x \in [0, 1] : [0, x] \subseteq [0, p] \cup J\}, \quad \mathcal{R}_J(p) = 1 - e_J(p).$$

If $J = [L, U]$, then

$$(23) \quad \mathcal{R}_{[L, U]}(p) = \begin{cases} 1 - p, & p < L, \\ 1 - \max\{p, U\}, & p \geq L, \end{cases} \quad \mathcal{R}_\emptyset(p) = 1 - p.$$

The map is nonincreasing in p and under enlargement of J .

Lemma C.4 (Generalized boundary handoff). *Suppose a unit boundary edge is covered by a left trace contained in $[0, p]$, a center trace J , and a right trace contained in $[1 - q, 1]$. Then*

$$q \geq \mathcal{R}_J(p).$$

Define

$$g_{c, J}^\vee(a) = \mathcal{R}_J(g_c(1 - a)), \quad \widehat{g}_{c, J}^\vee(a) = \mathcal{R}_J(\widehat{g}_c(1 - a)).$$

Apply these maps with $p = B(T)$ and $q = A(T_{\text{next}})$, where T is an actual V triangle satisfying $A(T) \geq a$ and $C(T) \geq c$, and T_{next} is the next incident actual V triangle. Then

$$(24) \quad A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq g_{c, J}^\vee(a),$$

and the hatted version holds when T is nonsupercritical:

$$(25) \quad A(T_{\text{next}}) \geq \widehat{g}_{c, J}^\vee(a).$$

Proof. The component of $[0, p] \cup J$ containing 0 is $[0, e_J(p)]$. If $1 - q > e_J(p)$, the intervening open interval is uncovered. The transfer statements follow from Lemma C.2 and the fact that $\mathcal{R}_J$ is nonincreasing. $\square$

For $0 \leq c < 1/2$, define

$$(26) \quad g_c^{\text{sc}} = \sup_{\{x: g_c(x) > x\}} g_c(x) = \frac{c + \sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4}}{2}.$$

The supremum is not attained. Hence an actual strict-supercritical V triangle T with $C(T) \geq c$ satisfies

$$(27) \quad B(T) < g_c^{\text{sc}}.$$

If, in addition, its outgoing edge is center-free and T_{next} is the next incident actual V triangle, then coverage gives

$$(28) \quad A(T_{\text{next}}) > 1 - g_c^{\text{sc}}.$$

The former notation was $B_{\text{sc}}(c) = g_c^{\text{sc}}$ and $A_{\text{sc}}(c) = 1 - g_c^{\text{sc}}$.

C.5. Relaxed composition and path budgets. For maps listed in geometric V-triangle order, write

$$(29) \quad [\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r](x) = (\Phi_r \circ \cdots \circ \Phi_1)(x).$$

The leftmost slot acts first. Write $I(x) = x$.

Lemma C.5 (Relaxed composition). *Suppose actual demands satisfy*

$$x_j \geq \Phi_j(x_{j-1}) \quad (1 \leq j \leq r),$$

where every Φ_j is nondecreasing. If $\underline{\Phi}_j \leq \Phi_j$, then

$$x_r \geq [\underline{\Phi}_1 \mid \cdots \mid \underline{\Phi}_r](x_0).$$

Proof. Set $y_0 = x_0$ and $y_j = \underline{\Phi}_j(y_{j-1})$. Monotonicity gives $x_j \geq \Phi_j(x_{j-1}) \geq \Phi_j(y_{j-1}) \geq y_j$ inductively. $\square$

Lemma C.6 (Boundary-path budget). *Let $E_0, \dots, E_k$ be consecutive boundary edges and let $T_1, \dots, T_k$ be the roles at their intermediate vertices. Suppose:*

- (1) *on E_0 , the component covered from the endpoint opposite T_1 by all roles other than T_1 has extent at most u ;*
- (2) *on E_k , the analogous component opposite T_k has extent at most v ;*
- (3) *on every middle edge, no role other than the two incident path roles has positive-length trace;*
- (4) *the chain is covered.*

Then

$$(30) \quad \sum_{j=1}^k (A_j + B_j) \geq k + 1 - u - v.$$

Consequently, if all k internal V triangles are nonsupercritical, the chain is impossible whenever $u + v < 1$.

Proof. The first and last component hypotheses give $A_1 \geq 1 - u$ and $B_k \geq 1 - v$. On every middle edge the center and all nonincident roles have been excluded, so $B_j + A_{j+1} \geq 1$. Adding proves the formula. $\square$

C.6. Low roots, selected T_+ curves, and thresholds. For the high-radial maps define

$$(31) \quad e(d) = \frac{1-d}{2} \left(1 - \sqrt{4(1-d)^2 - 3} \right) \quad \left(0 < d < 1 - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \right),$$

and, for the low-radial order transition,

$$(32) \quad h(c) = \frac{2c}{1 + \sqrt{16c^2 - 3}} \quad \left(\frac{1}{2} < c \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \right).$$

Proposition C.7 (Universal selected- T_+ curve). *Fix $0 < d < 1/2$, put $c = 1 - d$, and suppose an input p belongs to a selected T_+ arc of $\widehat{g}_c^\vee$. Write*

$$q = \widehat{g}_c^\vee(p), \quad \nu = q - p, \quad x = \frac{q - d}{1 - d}.$$

Then

$$(33) \quad \nu = \sigma(x) = 1 - \sqrt{1 - x + x^2},$$

and

$$(34) \quad q = d + (1 - d)x, \quad p = d + (1 - d)x - \sigma(x).$$

Consequently the selected arc is increasing and strictly concave.

Proof. The selected quadratic is

$$(1 - q)(q - d) = (1 - d)^2 \nu(2 - \nu).$$

Substitution gives $x(1 - x) = \nu(2 - \nu)$, and the selected component uses the smaller root $\nu = \sigma(x)$. The input function is increasing and strictly convex because σ is strictly concave; inversion gives the assertion. $\square$

The corresponding chord bounds are

$$(35) \quad \widehat{g}_{1-d}^\vee(p) \geq p + \frac{d}{e(d) - d}(p - d),$$

and, with $t = h(1 - d)$,

$$(36) \quad \widehat{g}_{1-d}^\vee(p) \geq p + \frac{1 - 2t}{t - d}(p - d).$$

For every coefficient λ proved valid on the relevant selected arc, write

$$(37) \quad \widehat{g}_{1-d}^{\vee, \lambda}(p) := p + \lambda(p - d) \leq \widehat{g}_{1-d}^\vee(p).$$

The rational form (18) gives, in the historical notation $x = 1 - \beta$,

$$(38) \quad \beta = \frac{z(2 - z)}{1 - z^2}, \quad m_\beta = \frac{1 - z + z^2}{1 - z^2}.$$

For $0 < d < 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, the exact high-demand threshold is

$$(39) \quad z > e(d) \implies \widehat{g}_{1-d}^\vee(z) \geq 1 - e(d).$$

Define

$$(40) \quad \widehat{g}_{1-d}^{\vee, \text{th}}(z) = \begin{cases} z, & z \leq e(d), \\ 1 - e(d), & z > e(d), \end{cases} \quad \widehat{g}_{1-d}^{\vee, \text{th}} \leq \widehat{g}_{1-d}^\vee.$$

Lemma C.8 (Threshold routing). *Let $z_j = \Phi_j(z_{j-1})$, where every Φ_j is nondecreasing and extensive. If $\Phi_k = \hat{g}_{1-d}^\vee$ and $z_{k-1} > e(d)$, then $z_j \geq 1 - e(d)$ for all $j \geq k$. If a chain contains later occurrences of $\hat{g}_{1-d_1}^\vee$ and $\hat{g}_{1-d_2}^\vee$ and*

$$z_0 > e(d_1), \quad \min\{e(d_1), e(d_2)\} < Q,$$

then at least one of those two V triangles forces every subsequent output above $1 - Q$.

Proof. The first assertion is (39) followed by extensivity. If $e(d_1) < Q$, use the first threshold. Otherwise $z_0 > e(d_1) \geq Q > e(d_2)$, so the second threshold fires. The conclusion is “at least one”, not uniqueness; both thresholds may be available. $\square$

APPENDIX D. DERIVATION OF THE LOCAL ADMISSIBLE SET

This section proves the explicit description stated in Proposition 2.5. It also derives the three polynomial cells used by the exact-demand appendix and records the component selectors introduced when a positive support equation is squared.

Let

$$u = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right), \quad v = \left(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right),$$

and put

$$O = 0, \quad A = au, \quad B = bv, \quad C = c(u + v), \quad K = \text{conv}\{O, A, B, C\}.$$

Set

$$s = a + b, \quad d = a^2 + ab + b^2.$$

D.1. The triangular hull. Assume first that $s > 0$ and $cs \leq ab$. If $a, b > 0$, then

$$\frac{c}{a} + \frac{c}{b} \leq 1,$$

so

$$C = \frac{c}{a}A + \frac{c}{b}B + \left(1 - \frac{c}{a} - \frac{c}{b}\right)O \in \text{conv}\{O, A, B\}.$$

The zero-coordinate cases follow by continuity. The distance AB equals $\sqrt{d}$ and is the diameter of $\triangle OAB$. Put

$$T = -bu - av.$$

The triangle $\text{conv}\{A, B, T\}$ is equilateral of side $\sqrt{d}$, and

$$O = \frac{b^2}{d}A + \frac{a^2}{d}B + \frac{ab}{d}T.$$

Thus it contains O and therefore also C . Every enclosing set has diameter at least AB , so

$$L_{\min}(a, b, c) = \sqrt{d}.$$

When $a = b = 0$, the hull is the segment $[0, c(u + v)]$ and its least enclosing equilateral side is c .

D.2. The quadrilateral hull and the four calipers. Assume now that $s > 0$ and $cs > ab$. The four hull vertices occur in the cyclic order

$$O, B, C, A.$$

By Proposition C.1, a minimizing orientation has an outward normal perpendicular to one of the four hull edges.

For the edge OA , the three supports give

$$L_{OA} = b + \max\{a, c\};$$

reflection gives

$$L_{BO} = a + \max\{b, c\}.$$

For the edge AC , put

$$R_a = \sqrt{a^2 - ac + c^2}.$$

An outward unit normal is

$$n_0 = \frac{1}{2R_a}(\sqrt{3}a, 2c - a).$$

If $x_+ = \max\{x, 0\}$, the support values for n_0, Rn_0, R^2n_0 are

$$\frac{\sqrt{3}ac}{2R_a}, \quad \frac{\sqrt{3}a(a-c)_+}{2R_a}, \quad \frac{\sqrt{3}c \max\{b, (c-a)_+\}}{2R_a}.$$

Multiplying their sum by $2/\sqrt{3}$ gives

$$L_{AC} = \begin{cases} (a^2 + bc)/R_a, & a \geq c, \\ c(a+b)/R_a, & a < c \leq a+b, \\ c^2/R_a, & c > a+b. \end{cases}$$

Reflection exchanges a and b and gives L_{CB} . These four hull edges are exhaustive, so

$$L_{\min}(a, b, c) = \min\{L_{OA}, L_{BO}, L_{AC}, L_{CB}\}.$$

This proves Proposition 2.5, including all equality and degenerate cases by continuity.

D.3. Equivalent polynomial cells. For the exact transfer calculations put

$$m = \min\{a, b\}, \quad M = \max\{a, b\}, \quad q = s^4 - s^2 + ab,$$

and define

$$\begin{aligned} F_L(a, b, c) &= c^4 - c^2 + mc - m^2, \\ F_T(a, b, c) &= (s^2 - 1)c^2 + Mc - M^2, \\ F_S(a, b, c) &= (m^2 - 1)c^2 + (2mM^2 + M)c + M^4 - M^2. \end{aligned}$$

We prove

$$(41) \quad \mathcal{A} = \mathcal{A}_L \cup \mathcal{A}_T \cup \mathcal{A}_S,$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{A}_L &= \{d \leq 1, s \leq 1, q \leq 0, F_L \leq 0\}, \\ \mathcal{A}_T &= \{d \leq 1, s \leq 1, q \geq 0, F_T \leq 0, c \leq 2M\}, \\ \mathcal{A}_S &= \{d \leq 1, s > 1, F_S \leq 0, c \leq 1/2\}, \end{aligned}$$

with all variables in $[0, 1]$.

Assume by symmetry that $a = m \leq b = M$. Reading the active support points in the four-caliper formulas gives the following contact patterns:

range	active supports	unit-frontier equation
$s < 1, q < 0$	$\{O\}, \{C\}, \{A, C\}$	$F_L = 0$
$s < 1, q > 0$	$\{O\}, \{B, C\}, \{A\}$	$F_T = 0$
$s = 1$	preceding pattern with an O, B tie	$c = M$
$s > 1$	$\{B\}, \{B, C\}, \{A\}$	$F_S = 0$.

The inactive-support inequalities reduce respectively to $q \leq 0$, $q \geq 0$, and $s > 1$. The side-length equations have positive sides; squaring them gives exactly $F_L = 0, F_T = 0, F_S = 0$. It remains to identify the geometric connected component after squaring.

For Cell T , $0 < s < 1$, the roots of $F_T = 0$ are

$$c_- = \frac{2M}{1 + \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}, \quad c_+ = \frac{2M}{1 - \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}.$$

The inequality $F_T \leq 0$ contains the interval $0 \leq c \leq c_-$ and the formal high component $c \geq c_+$. The geometric component is the one connected to $c = 0$. One has

$$c_- \leq 2M \leq c_+,$$

with equality of all three quantities only when the two roots coalesce. Hence

$$c \leq 2M$$

selects exactly the component containing $c = 0$. Equivalently one may use $M + 2(s^2 - 1)c \geq 0$.

For Cell S ,

$$F_S(a, b, 0) = M^2(M^2 - 1) < 0, \quad F_S(a, b, M) = M^2(s^2 - 1) > 0.$$

Furthermore $4F_S(a, b, 1/2)$ is increasing in m , and at $m = 1 - M$ it equals

$$M^2(2M - 1)^2.$$

Because $s > 1$ gives $m > 1 - M$, one has $F_S(a, b, 1/2) > 0$. The quadratic opens downward, so $1/2$ lies strictly between its two roots. Therefore $c \leq 1/2$ selects the smaller-root component containing $c = 0$.

For Cell L , the fiber from $c = 0$ reaches one selected root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$; monotonicity there follows from $4c^3 - 2c + m > 0$. At $q = 0$ the L and T formulas meet and both give $c = s$. This proves (41) and, in particular, proves that $\mathcal{A}$ is coordinatewise down-closed.

D.4. The radial envelope. Solving the selected frontier equations gives

$$c_{\max}(a, b) = \begin{cases} 1, & a = b = 0, \\ C_L(m), & s \leq 1, q \leq 0, (a, b) \neq (0, 0), \\ \frac{2M}{1 + \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}, & s \leq 1, q > 0, \\ \frac{M(2mM + 1) - M\sqrt{4d - 3}}{2(1 - m^2)}, & s > 1, \end{cases}$$

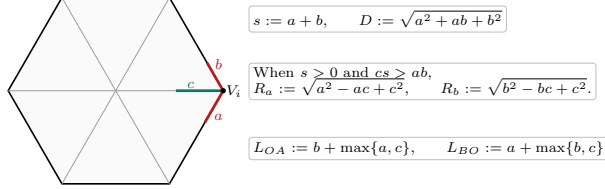
where $C_L(m)$ is the unique root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$ of

$$z^4 - z^2 + mz - m^2 = 0.$$

At $q = 0$ the two subcritical formulas agree and equal s . These formulas are the radial-envelope inputs used later in Strategies 2 and 4.

Scalar data for the explicit admissible-set formula

representative V triangle lengths are schematic; formulas are exact

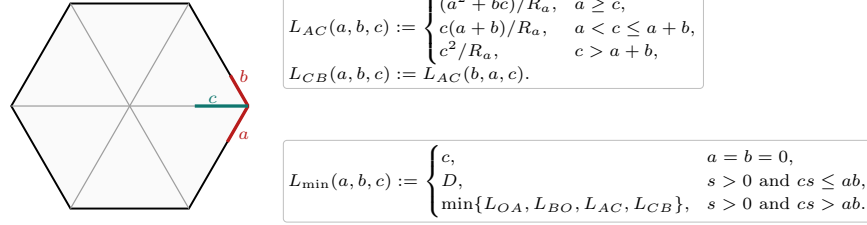


D is the triangular-hull enclosure value; R_a, R_b are the two four-sided caliper denominators.
 $K(a, b, c) = \text{conv}\{0, au, bv, c(u+v)\}$

FIGURE 16. The scalar and caliper-denominator data entering the exact admissible-set formula.

The exact least-enclosure formula

the skeleton fixes the V triangle geometry; the piecewise formulas are exact



same local demand hull $K(a, b, c)$

$$\mathcal{A} = \{(a, b, c) \in [0, 1]^3 : L_{\min}(a, b, c) \leq 1\}.$$

FIGURE 17. The complete piecewise least-enclosure function and its exact relation to $\mathcal{A}$.

D.5. Exact admissible-set diagrams.

APPENDIX E. SIGNED CE1/CE2 REDUCTIONS

This section gives one signed center model and the common one-gap V triangle interface. The transfer notation has already been fixed in Section C: the exact nonsupercritical incoming-reach map is $\widehat{g}_c^\vee$, while g_c itself remains the historical boundary-defect map.

E.1. One signed center normal form.

Proposition E.1 (Signed CE1/CE2 center normal form). *Let T_C be a closed unit equilateral triangle with $O \in \text{int}(T_C)$ and a positive-length boundary trace. Normalize such a trace to $e_{0,1}$ and use affine coordinates*

$$X = V_0 + b(V_1 - V_0) + a(V_5 - V_0).$$

There are parameters

$$0 < R < 1, \quad W = 1 - R,$$

$$E = \sqrt{1 - RW}, \quad \eta = 1 - E, \quad P = E(1 - E),$$

and nonnegative center slacks α, δ such that, with

$$k = \eta + \alpha + \delta,$$

the center triangle is

$$(42) \quad \boxed{\begin{aligned} F_0 &= R + \alpha - a + Wb, \\ F_1 &= Rb + Wa - k, \\ F_2 &= W + \delta - b + Ra, \end{aligned}} \quad T_C = \{F_0, F_1, F_2 \geq 0\}.$$

Define

$$(43) \quad \Delta_R = P - \alpha - W\delta, \quad \Delta_L = P - R\alpha - \delta.$$

Then

$$(44) \quad T_C \cap e_{0,1} = \left[\frac{k}{R}, W + \delta \right], \quad \mathcal{H}^1(T_C \cap e_{0,1}) = \frac{\Delta_R}{R},$$

and the possible companion trace is

$$(45) \quad T_C \cap e_{5,0} = \left[\frac{k}{W}, R + \alpha \right] \quad \text{when } \Delta_L > 0, \quad \mathcal{H}^1(T_C \cap e_{5,0}) = \frac{[\Delta_L]_+}{W}.$$

The normalization requires $\Delta_R > 0$, and

$$(46) \quad T_C \text{ is CE1} \iff \Delta_L \leq 0, \quad T_C \text{ is CE2} \iff \Delta_L > 0.$$

The six center exits, measured from O , are

$$(47) \quad \boxed{\begin{aligned} d_0^C &= E - \alpha - \delta, & d_1^C &= \frac{\delta}{R}, & d_2^C &= \delta, \\ d_3^C &= \min \left\{ \frac{\alpha}{R}, \frac{\delta}{W} \right\}, & d_4^C &= \alpha, & d_5^C &= \frac{\alpha}{W}. \end{aligned}}$$

For closures of original open center roles one has $\alpha, \delta > 0$.

Proof. Write

$$T_C \cap e_{0,1} = [s, t], \quad 0 \leq s < t \leq 1.$$

The two sides through these endpoints have a positive slope ratio. Reflect across the perpendicular bisector of $e_{0,1}$ if necessary and call the ratio $R \leq 1$; put $W = 1 - R$. Direct equations for the three side lines give

$$F_1 = Rb + Wa - Rs, \quad F_2 = -b + Ra + t, \quad F_0 = Wb - a + E + Rs - t,$$

where $E = \sqrt{1 - RW}$ is forced by the unit side-length relation. If $R = 1$, then $F_0(O) = s - t < 0$, contrary to $O \in \text{int}(T_C)$; hence $0 < R < 1$.

Set

$$\alpha = F_0(O), \quad \delta = F_2(O).$$

Then

$$t = W + \delta, \quad Rs = \eta + \alpha + \delta = k,$$

and substitution gives (42). The gradients are the three unit-equilateral side-normal directions and

$$F_0 + F_1 + F_2 = E,$$

so the three inequalities define the same unit equilateral triangle.

On $e_{0,1}$ one has $a = 0$. The active inequalities are

$$Rb \geq k, \quad b \leq W + \delta,$$

which gives (44); its length is

$$W + \delta - \frac{k}{R} = \frac{P - \alpha - W\delta}{R}.$$

On $e_{5,0}$ one has $b = 0$, and the active inequalities are

$$Wa \geq k, \quad a \leq R + \alpha.$$

Their signed interval length is

$$R + \alpha - \frac{k}{W} = \frac{P - R\alpha - \delta}{W},$$

which proves (45).

The positive right trace gives

$$\delta < \frac{P}{W} = \frac{ER}{1+E} < \frac{R}{2}.$$

On $e_{1,2}$, parameterized by $b = 1 + q$, $a = q$, the slack F_2 is

$$\delta - R - Wq < 0.$$

Thus a second positive trace cannot occur on $e_{1,2}$. The CE classification says that a center triangle has at most two positive boundary traces and that two such traces are adjacent. Hence $e_{5,0}$ is the only possible companion edge, and its signed length proves (46). Equality $\Delta_L = 0$ is only a point contact and is therefore CE1.

For the radial exits, substitute the six ray parametrizations in (42). On r_1 the decreasing slack is $\delta - Rq$; on r_2 it is $\delta - q$; on r_3 the two decreasing slacks are $\alpha - Rq$ and $\delta - Wq$. Reflection gives r_4, r_5 , and on r_0 the decreasing slack is $E - \alpha - \delta - q$. This proves (47).

Finally,

$$W(\alpha + \delta) \leq \alpha + W\delta < P,$$

so

$$E - \alpha - \delta > E - \frac{P}{W} = \frac{E(E - R)}{W} > \frac{1}{2},$$

where the last inequality is equivalent to $2E(E - R) - W = (E - R)^2 > 0$. Together with

$$\alpha < P < \min \left\{ \frac{R}{2}, \frac{W}{2} \right\}, \quad \delta < \frac{R}{2},$$

the midpoint tests give the exact midpoint set $\{M_0\}$. For the closure of an original open center role, all three center slacks are positive; hence $\alpha, \delta > 0$. $\square$

Remark E.2 (Legacy variables). For CE1, take

$$\lambda = R, \quad s = \frac{k}{R}, \quad t = W + \delta, \quad C_0 = \alpha, \quad C_2 = \delta.$$

For CE2, take

$$x = \frac{k}{W}, \quad \nu = R + \alpha, \quad y = \frac{k}{R}, \quad v = W + \delta.$$

If $S = x + y$ and $D = \sqrt{x^2 + xy + y^2}$, then

$$S = \frac{k}{RW}, \quad D = \frac{Ek}{RW},$$

and the old coupling equation is

$$(\nu + v)S - xy = D.$$

Thus the CE1 and CE2 formula lists are two coordinate readings of Proposition E.1.

E.2. Boundary contribution and diameter transfer.

Corollary E.3 (Common center-boundary formula). *The full center-boundary contribution is*

$$(48) \quad L_{\partial H}(T_C) = \frac{\Delta_R}{R} + \frac{[\Delta_L]_+}{W}.$$

In CE1,

$$L_{\partial H}(T_C) \leq P \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4}.$$

In CE2,

$$L_{\partial H}(T_C) = \frac{E}{1+E} - \frac{E^2(\alpha + \delta)}{RW} < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Proof. Equation (48) is the sum of (44) and (45). If $\Delta_L \leq 0$, then $R\alpha + \delta \geq P$. Multiplying by W and using $\alpha \geq RW\alpha$ gives

$$\alpha + W\delta \geq WP.$$

Thus $\Delta_R \leq RP$, so the contribution is at most P . Since $E \geq \sqrt{3}/2$ and $E(1-E)$ decreases on this interval, the CE1 cap follows.

If $\Delta_L > 0$, direct addition gives

$$\begin{aligned} L_{\partial H}(T_C) &= \frac{P - \alpha - W\delta}{R} + \frac{P - R\alpha - \delta}{W} \\ &= \frac{P - E^2(\alpha + \delta)}{RW}. \end{aligned}$$

Here $W + R^2 = W^2 + R = E^2$ and $P/(RW) = E/(1+E)$, so the last expression is strictly below $1/2$. $\square$

Lemma E.4 (Adjacent-edge diameter transfer). *For $0 \leq q \leq 1$, put*

$$\beta(q) = \frac{-q + \sqrt{4 - 3q^2}}{2}.$$

If a unit equilateral triangle reaches parameters q, b on two adjacent boundary edges, then

$$b \leq \beta(q).$$

For $q > 0$,

$$\beta(q) < 1 - \frac{q}{2}, \quad 1 - \beta(q) > \frac{q}{2}.$$

Proof. The squared distance between the two boundary points is $q^2 + qb + b^2$, so it is at most one. Solving the quadratic in b gives the first assertion. For $q > 0$, $\sqrt{4 - 3q^2} < 2$, which gives both strict linear comparisons. $\square$

E.3. The local propagation interface. The exact nonsupercritical reach transfer is $\widehat{g}_c^\vee$. It is nondecreasing and extensive:

$$(49) \quad \widehat{g}_c^\vee(z) \geq z.$$

The exact reflection duality is

$$(50) \quad \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a) \leq z \iff \widehat{g}_c^\vee(1-z) \leq 1-a.$$

Suppose an actual nonsupercritical V triangle has maximal reaches (A_i, B_i, C_i) and

$$A_i \geq z, \quad C_i \geq c_i.$$

Then its outgoing reach satisfies

$$B_i \leq \widehat{g}_{c_i}(1-z).$$

If the next boundary handoff gives $A_{i+1} \geq 1 - B_i$, then

$$(51) \quad \begin{aligned} A_{i+1} &\geq 1 - B_i \\ &\geq 1 - \widehat{g}_{c_i}(1-z) \\ &= \widehat{g}_{c_i}^\vee(z). \end{aligned}$$

Every composition below is shorthand for repeated applications of this inequality to specified actual V triangles.

E.4. The common one-gap interface.

Proposition E.5 (Common five-V-triangle one-gap reduction). *Assume every vertex role is Vd0, $N_+ = 1$, and the normalized right center trace contains a V-gap, possibly a singleton. In the CE2 case assume the companion trace contains no V-gap. Put*

$$X = R - \delta, \quad H = \frac{k}{2R}, \quad m_3 = \min \left\{ \frac{\alpha}{R}, \frac{\delta}{W} \right\},$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} c_1 &= 1 - \frac{\delta}{R}, \quad c_2 = 1 - \delta, \quad c_3 = 1 - m_3, \\ c_4 &= 1 - \alpha, \quad c_5 = 1 - \frac{\alpha}{W}, \quad c_0 = k. \end{aligned}$$

Let

$$z_0 = X, \quad z_i = \widehat{g}_{c_i}^\vee(z_{i-1}) \quad (1 \leq i \leq 5),$$

and $Z = z_5$. Then the actual reaches satisfy

$$(52) \quad A_0 \geq Z, \quad A_0 \leq g_k \left(1 - \frac{k}{R} \right) < 1 - H.$$

Consequently it is enough to prove

$$(53) \quad [\widehat{g}_{1-\alpha}^\vee \mid \widehat{g}_{1-m_3}^\vee \mid \widehat{g}_{1-\delta}^\vee](H) > W + \delta.$$

Proof. The exact-midpoint argument makes V triangles $1, \dots, 5$ nonsupercritical and V triangle 0 uniquely supercritical. Gap containment gives

$$B_0 \geq \frac{k}{R}, \quad A_1 \geq X.$$

Suppose inductively that $A_i \geq z_{i-1}$. Radial coverage gives actual radial reach at least c_i , and the hatted outgoing cap gives

$$B_i \leq \widehat{g}_{c_i}(1 - z_{i-1}).$$

The next boundary handoff therefore gives

$$A_{i+1} \geq 1 - B_i \geq \widehat{g}_{c_i}^\vee(z_{i-1}) = z_i.$$

For the final handoff, the CE1 companion trace is empty and the CE2 companion trace is gap-free, so $A_0 \geq z_5 = Z$.

The same V triangle has boundary reach at least k/R and radial reach at least k . Reflection and down-closedness of $\mathcal{A}$ give

$$\left(\frac{k}{R}, A_0, k\right) \in \mathcal{A},$$

so

$$A_0 \leq g_k \left(1 - \frac{k}{R}\right).$$

Lemma E.4 gives

$$g_k \left(1 - \frac{k}{R}\right) \leq \beta \left(\frac{k}{R}\right) < 1 - \frac{k}{2R} = 1 - H,$$

which proves (52).

The first and fifth maps are extensive and the middle maps are nondecreasing, so it is enough to prove

$$[\widehat{g}_{c_2}^\vee \mid \widehat{g}_{c_3}^\vee \mid \widehat{g}_{c_4}^\vee](X) > 1 - H.$$

Three applications of (50) show that its negation is equivalent to the negation of (53). This proves the reduction. $\square$

The CE1 sign $\Delta_L \leq 0$ is completed by the selected- T_+ relaxation in Proposition L.2. We now give the shorter CE2 scalar clause.

Lemma E.6 (CE2 total slack and two thresholds). *Assume $\Delta_R > 0$ and $\Delta_L > 0$, and put*

$$T = \alpha + \delta, \quad Q = \frac{\eta + T}{2R}.$$

Then

$$(54) \quad T < \frac{\eta}{E},$$

and

$$(55) \quad \min\{e(\alpha), e(\delta)\} < Q.$$

Proof. The CE2 inequalities are

$$\alpha + W\delta < P, \quad R\alpha + \delta < P.$$

Multiply the first by W , the second by R , and add. Since $W + R^2 = W^2 + R = E^2$, this gives

$$E^2T < P = E\eta,$$

which is (54).

Let $d = \min\{\alpha, \delta\}$. Since $d \leq T/2$ and the rational low-root bound is increasing,

$$\min\{e(\alpha), e(\delta)\} < \frac{2d}{1 - 2d} \leq \frac{T}{1 - T}.$$

It remains to prove

$$\frac{T}{1 - T} < \frac{\eta + T}{2R}.$$

Define

$$\Phi(t) = (\eta + t)(1 - t) - 2Rt.$$

This function is concave, so its minimum on $[0, \eta/E]$ is at an endpoint. Clearly $\Phi(0) = \eta > 0$. Direct simplification using $E^2 = 1 - R + R^2$ gives

$$\Phi\left(\frac{\eta}{E}\right) = \frac{R(E - R)^2}{E^2} > 0.$$

Thus $\Phi(T) > 0$, proving (55). $\square$

Proposition E.7 (Short CE2 one-gap completion). *Under the CE2 hypotheses of Proposition E.5, the one-gap state is impossible in either orientation.*

Proof. The right-gap initial input is $z_0 = R - \delta$. The strict CE2 domain gives

$$Wz_0 = RW - W\delta = \eta + P - W\delta > \eta + \alpha.$$

For

$$\pi(q) = (\eta + q)(1 - 2q) - 2qW,$$

one has

$$\pi(0) = \eta > 0, \quad \pi(P) = \eta(\eta + 2ER^2) > 0.$$

Concavity therefore gives $\pi(\alpha) > 0$, and the low-root bound yields

$$(56) \quad z_0 > \frac{\eta + \alpha}{W} > \frac{2\alpha}{1 - 2\alpha} > e(\alpha).$$

If $e(\alpha) < Q$, extensivity carries (56) to the V triangle-4 map $\hat{g}_{1-\alpha}^\vee$, which gives an output at least $1 - e(\alpha) > 1 - Q$. All later maps preserve it. If $e(\alpha) \geq Q$, Lemma E.6 gives $e(\delta) < Q$, and

$$z_0 > e(\alpha) \geq Q > e(\delta).$$

The V triangle-2 map $\hat{g}_{1-\delta}^\vee$ then gives an output above $1 - Q$, again preserved by all later maps. Thus $Z > 1 - Q = 1 - H$, contradicting (52).

Reflection exchanges

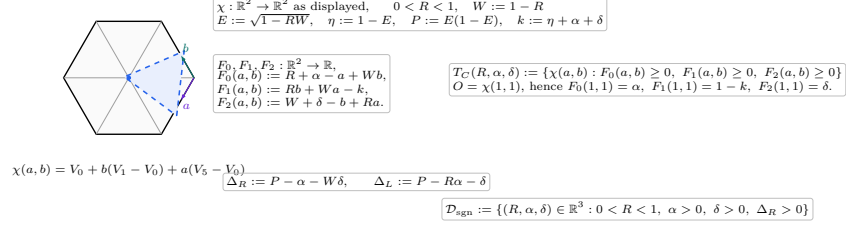
$$R \leftrightarrow W, \quad \alpha \leftrightarrow \delta$$

and reverses the V-triangle order. The signed CE2 domain and the proof above are invariant under this exchange, so the left-gap orientation is impossible as well. $\square$

Remark E.8 (Why the CE1 scalar clause remains separate). The geometric one-gap interface is common, but (55) is not valid on the full CE1 sign domain. Thus the merger stops at Proposition E.5; the CE1 selected- T_+ clause and the CE2 threshold clause are genuinely different scalar proofs of the same target (53).

(e) signed parameters and affine center chart

the chart formulas are exact; parameter callouts are non-metric



R is an affine slope parameter; only $\ell_R, \ell_L, d_i^C, c_i^C$ in the trace-and-exit panels are displayed as skeleton lengths.

FIGURE 18. The affine center chart and the exact dependency structure of the signed parameters.

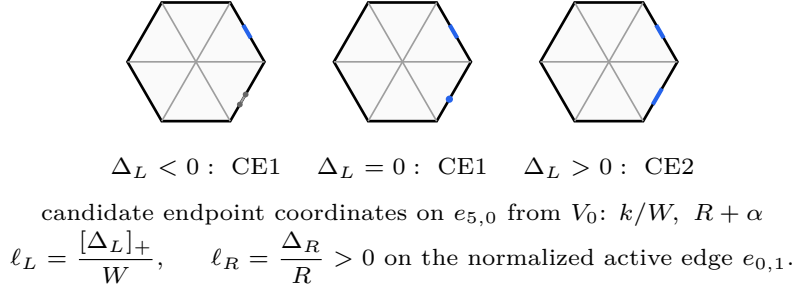
(f) companion-surplus sign on $e_{5,0}$ 

FIGURE 19. The exact sign test for the candidate companion trace, including the CE1 point-contact case.

(h) center exits and complementary Strategy 2 demands

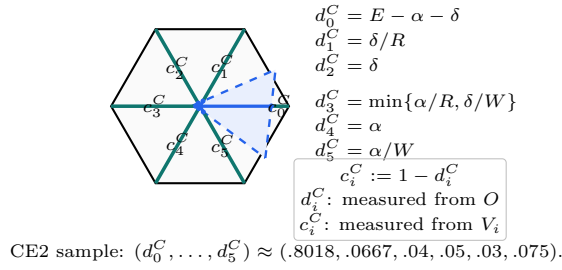
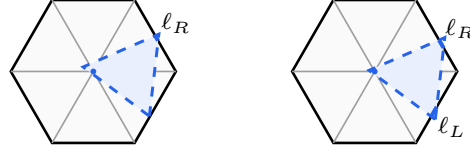


FIGURE 20. The six exact center exits d_i^C and complementary radial demands $c_i^C = 1 - d_i^C$.

(i) **boundary-contribution bounds on the skeleton**

$$\begin{aligned} \text{CE1 : } L_{\partial H}(T_C) &= \ell_R \leq P \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4} \\ \text{CE2 : } L_{\partial H}(T_C) &= \ell_R + \ell_L < \frac{1}{2} \end{aligned}$$

FIGURE 21. The exact CE1 and CE2 center-boundary contributions and their general bounds.

E.5. **Exact signed-center diagrams.**

APPENDIX F. TRACE BUDGETS AND LENGTH CONTRADICTIONS

This section develops the boundary and conditional-skeleton trace bounds used by the length mechanism.

For a closed triangle T and a rectifiable target E , write

$$L_E(T) = \mathcal{H}^1(T \cap E).$$

The passage from an original open role U to its closure $T = \overline{U}$ can only enlarge the trace. Hence a cover of E by the open roles implies

$$(57) \quad \mathcal{H}^1(E) \leq L_E(T_C) + \sum_{i=0}^5 L_E(T_i).$$

All estimates in this section concern full traces. They therefore remain valid for any assigned measurable subsets of those traces.

The strategy uses only the perimeter ∂H and the full skeleton S , whose measures were recorded in (8). Every skeleton estimate below is conditional on its stated center and V triangle hypotheses; no unconditional noncoverage assertion for S is made.

 ∂H : length 6 S : length 12

the full-skeleton estimate is used only under its stated branch hypotheses

FIGURE 22. The two one-dimensional targets. The full skeleton is used only under the hypotheses of the corresponding trace budget.

F.1. Conditional skeleton trace caps. We now develop the skeleton estimate used only when the center is CE1 or CE2. The first lemma is the center contribution.

Lemma F.1 (Center skeleton cap). *If T_C is a CE1 or CE2 center role and contains exactly one radial midpoint, then*

$$L_S(T_C) < \frac{3}{2}.$$

Proof. Normalize the unique midpoint as M_0 and the positive boundary trace to $e_{0,1}$. Use the signed variables of Proposition E.1; in particular

$$W = 1 - R, \quad E = \sqrt{1 - RW}, \quad \eta = 1 - E, \quad P = E(1 - E).$$

The positive trace condition is

$$(58) \quad \alpha + W\delta < P.$$

The two possible boundary contributions are

$$\ell_{01} = W + \delta - \frac{\eta + \alpha + \delta}{R}, \quad \ell_{50} = \frac{[P - (R\alpha + \delta)]_+}{W}.$$

The six radial contributions are bounded by

i	0	1	2	3	4	5
$\mathcal{H}^1(T_C \cap r_i)$	$E - \alpha - \delta$	δ/R	δ	$\min\{\alpha/R, \delta/W\}$	α	α/W

Adding gives

$$L_S(T_C) \leq K_R + \mathcal{E}(\alpha, \delta),$$

where

$$K_R = W + E - \frac{\eta}{R}$$

and

$$\mathcal{E}(\alpha, \delta) = -\frac{\alpha}{R} + \frac{\alpha}{W} + \delta + \min\left\{\frac{\alpha}{R}, \frac{\delta}{W}\right\} + \frac{[P - (R\alpha + \delta)]_+}{W}.$$

Splitting only according to the minimum and the positive part gives

$$(59) \quad \mathcal{E}(\alpha, \delta) \leq \frac{P}{W}.$$

For example, if $\alpha/R \leq \delta/W$, the expression without the positive part is $\alpha/W + \delta$; when the positive part is active, its excess over P/W is $\alpha - R\delta/W \leq 0$. The reflected order gives excess $\delta - W\alpha/R \leq 0$. If the positive part vanishes, (58) gives the same bound strictly.

Put $A = 1 + R - R^2$. Then

$$\frac{3}{2} - K_R - \frac{P}{W} = \frac{1 + A - 2EA}{2RW}.$$

Both sides of $1 + A > 2EA$ are positive, and

$$(1 + A)^2 - 4A^2E^2 = R^2W^2(5 + 4R - 4R^2) > 0.$$

Thus $K_R + P/W < 3/2$. □

Lemma F.2 (Positive-support skeleton cap). *Let T_i be the closure of an original open vertex role, so $V_i \in \text{int}(T_i)$. If T_i has positive-length intersection with an adjacent radial arm, then*

$$L_S(T_i) < \frac{3}{2}.$$

Proof. Normalize to $i = 0$ and translate the hexagon by V_0 :

$$\tilde{H} = V_0 + H, \quad \tilde{O} = V_0, \quad W_j = V_0 + V_j.$$

Then $W_3 = O$, $W_2 = V_1$, and $W_4 = V_5$. The five original skeleton components on which a unit triangle containing V_0 can have positive-length trace are

$$[V_0, V_1], [V_0, V_5], [O, V_1], [O, V_0], [O, V_5].$$

All five belong to the skeleton $\tilde{S}$ of $\tilde{H}$. Since $V_0 = \tilde{O}$ is interior to T_0 , the triangle is a legitimate center role for $\tilde{H}$. Its positive adjacent-arm trace is a positive boundary-edge trace of $\tilde{H}$, so it is CE1 or CE2 by Proposition B.3. Proposition B.11 and Lemma F.1 therefore give

$$L_{\tilde{S}}(T_0) < \frac{3}{2}.$$

A nonlocal component of S is more than unit distance from the interior point V_0 , apart from zero-measure endpoints. Hence $L_S(T_0) \leq L_{\tilde{S}}(T_0)$. $\square$

Lemma F.3 (No-support skeleton cap). *If a vertex role has $A_i + B_i \leq 1$ and no positive-length trace on either adjacent radial arm, then*

$$L_S(T_i) \leq 2.$$

Proof. Its boundary contribution is $A_i + B_i \leq 1$ by (62). For $P = sV_j \in r_j \setminus \{O\}$,

$$\|V_i - P\|^2 = 1 + s^2 - 2s \cos \frac{(j-i)\pi}{3} > 1$$

when $j \notin \{i-1, i, i+1\}$. The two adjacent arms have zero-length trace by hypothesis, so only the own unit arm can contribute positive length. This adds at most one. $\square$

For the remaining cap we use one specialized part of the exact local equilateral enclosure criterion. In local directions u, v meeting at 120° , suppose a closed unit triangle contains

$$0, \quad au, \quad bv, \quad c(u+v),$$

with $0 \leq a \leq b \leq 1$ and $a + b > 1$. The support-line calculation gives the selected supercritical cell

$$(60) \quad \begin{aligned} a^2 + ab + b^2 &\leq 1, & c &\leq \frac{1}{2}, \\ (a^2 - 1)c^2 + (2ab^2 + b)c + (b^4 - b^2) &\leq 0, \end{aligned}$$

where c lies on the connected component containing $c = 0$. To see the selector directly, the quadratic is negative at $c = 0$, positive at $c = 1/2$, and opens downward. For the middle assertion, four times its value at $1/2$ is increasing in a and, at $a = 1 - b$, equals $b^2(2b - 1)^2$; it is therefore positive when $a + b > 1$. Hence $c \leq 1/2$ selects its smaller-root component. Formula (60) follows by fixing in the support sum the three active contacts $\{B\}$, $\{B, c(u+v)\}$, and $\{A\}$, and squaring the positive unit-side equation.

Lemma F.4 (Supercritical skeleton cap). *If $A_i + B_i > 1$, then*

$$L_S(T_i) < \frac{3}{2}.$$

Proof. By Proposition B.5, a vertex role is Vd0, Vd1, Vd2, or T3-like. Proposition F.6 makes every Vd1/Vd2 V triangle nonsupercritical, and Lemma B.8 does the same for T3-like V triangles. Hence a supercritical role is Vd0 and, by definition, has no positive-length trace on either adjacent arm. Thus, after normalizing and writing $a = A_i$, $b = B_i$, the skeleton trace has length $a + b + c$, where c is the own-arm reach. Reflect so that $a \leq b$, and put

$$s = a + b, \quad \delta = b - a, \quad c_0 = \frac{3}{2} - s.$$

The diameter constraint gives

$$1 < s \leq \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}}, \quad 0 \leq \delta \leq \sqrt{4 - 3s^2}.$$

Let $P(c)$ denote the quadratic in (60). Substitution and multiplication by 16 give

$$\begin{aligned} 16P(c_0) = Q(s, \delta) &= \delta^4 + 8\delta^3 s - 6\delta^3 + 14\delta^2 s^2 - 18\delta^2 s + 5\delta^2 \\ &\quad - 8\delta s^3 + 30\delta s^2 - 34\delta s + 12\delta \\ &\quad + s^4 - 6s^3 - 19s^2 + 60s - 36. \end{aligned}$$

Its derivative factors as

$$\frac{\partial Q}{\partial \delta} = 2(2\delta + 4s - 3)(\delta^2 + \delta(4s - 3) + (s - 1)(2 - s)) \geq 0.$$

Therefore

$$Q(s, \delta) \geq Q(s, 0) = (s - 1)(s^3 - 5s^2 - 24s + 36) > 0.$$

Indeed, the cubic is decreasing on $[1, 2/\sqrt{3}]$ and at its right endpoint equals $88/3 - 136\sqrt{3}/9 > 0$. Hence $P(c_0) > 0$. Since (60) selects the smaller-root component, $P(c) \leq 0$ forces $c < c_0$. Thus $a + b + c < 3/2$. $\square$

Lemma F.5 (A positive-support rescuer is forced). *Suppose T_C is CE1 or CE2 and, after symmetry, contains exactly M_0 . If at least two vertex V triangles are supercritical, then a vertex role distinct from a chosen supercritical role has positive-length adjacent-arm support.*

Proof. Choose a supercritical index $s \neq 0$. Lemma B.10 gives $M_s \notin T_s$, and $M_s \notin T_C$ by the unique-midpoint property. In the original open cover, M_s is therefore contained by some other open vertex role. Diameter one restricts this role to U_{s-1} or U_{s+1} . Because it contains an interior point of the adjacent arm, its intersection with that arm has positive length. $\square$

F.2. Vd1/Vd2 corner estimates. We next isolate the much stronger trace loss caused by Vd1 and Vd2 geometry. For the following two results use the temporary coordinates

$$X = V_0 + x(V_5 - V_0) + y(V_1 - V_0).$$

Thus $V_0 = (0, 0)$, $V_5 = (1, 0)$, $V_1 = (0, 1)$, $O = (1, 1)$, and $\|(x, y)\|^2 = x^2 + y^2 - xy$.

Proposition F.6 (Vd1/Vd2 corner normal form). *Let T be the closure of an original Vd1 or Vd2 role at V_0 , and let a, b be its exact reaches toward V_5, V_1 . There is a unique $t > 0$ such that, with $d = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}$,*

$$T = \left\{ (x, y) : \begin{aligned} &x - (t + 1)y \leq a, \\ &ty - (t + 1)x \leq tb, \\ &tx + y \leq d - a - tb \end{aligned} \right\}.$$

The raw traces, in coordinates measured from the indicated outer vertex, are

$$\begin{array}{l|l} r_0 & 0 \leq s \leq \frac{d-a-tb}{t+1} \\ r_1 & \frac{t(1-b)}{t+1} \leq s \leq \frac{d-a-tb-1}{t} \\ r_5 & \frac{1-a}{t+1} \leq s \leq d-a-tb-t. \end{array}$$

Intersecting with $[0, 1]$ gives the actual traces. Moreover,

$$(61) \quad a + b < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Proof. A Vd1/Vd2 triangle has one vertex W outside H and two vertices U, Z in H . Since V_0 is an interior convex combination of them, both coordinates of W are negative. The two axis endpoints $(a, 0), (0, b)$ lie on distinct sides incident with W . Put $p = U - W$, $q = Z - W$. Both vectors have positive coordinates and satisfy

$$\|p\| = \|q\| = \|p - q\| = 1.$$

The order in which the two sides cross the positive axes selects the 60° rotation

$$q = (p_x - p_y, p_x), \quad p_x > p_y > 0.$$

Writing $t = (p_x - p_y)/p_y$ gives uniquely

$$p = \frac{(t+1, 1)}{d}, \quad q = \frac{(t, t+1)}{d}.$$

The two side lines through the axis endpoints and the parallel third side are exactly those in (F.6). Substitution of $(s, s), (s, 1), (1, s)$ gives (F.6).

If the r_1 trace has positive length, its lower endpoint is smaller than its upper endpoint. Clearing denominators gives

$$(t+1)a + tb < (t+1)(d-1) - t^2.$$

Since the left side is at least $t(a+b)$,

$$a + b < \frac{(t+1)(d-1) - t^2}{t} < \frac{1}{2}.$$

For the last inequality, both sides are positive and

$$\left(t^2 + \frac{3t}{2} + 1\right)^2 - (t+1)^2(t^2 + t + 1) = \frac{t^2}{4} > 0.$$

Reflection proves the same conclusion when the supported arm is r_5 . $\square$

Lemma F.7 (Vd2 neighboring-midpoint cap). *If an original Vd2 role contains either neighboring midpoint, then its exact boundary reaches satisfy*

$$a + b < \frac{1}{3}.$$

Proof. In Proposition F.6, reflection sends (t, a, b, M_1, M_5) to $(1/t, b, a, M_5, M_1)$, so assume $t \geq 1$ and put $U = a + tb$.

If $M_5 = (1, 1/2)$ is contained, the third half-plane in (F.6) gives

$$a + b \leq U \leq d - t - \frac{1}{2} \leq \sqrt{3} - \frac{3}{2} < \frac{1}{3};$$

the middle expression decreases for $t \geq 1$.

If $M_1 = (1/2, 1)$ is contained, the second and third half-planes give

$$b \geq \frac{t-1}{2t}, \quad a+b \leq S(t) := d - t - \frac{1}{2t}.$$

Positive-length contact with the other adjacent arm r_5 gives, by (F.6),

$$a+b < R(t) := \frac{2(t+1)d - 3t^2 - t - 2}{2t}.$$

Direct differentiation shows that S is increasing and R decreasing on $[1, \infty)$. For example, the sign calculation for S' reduces to

$$(2t+1)^2 t^4 - (t^2 + t + 1)(2t^2 - 1)^2 = (t+1)(t^3 + 3t^2 - 1) > 0,$$

while $R' < 0$ follows from $d > t + 1/2$. Splitting at $t = 4/3$ yields

$$\begin{aligned} 1 \leq t \leq \frac{4}{3} : \quad a+b &\leq S(4/3) = \frac{8\sqrt{37}-41}{24} < \frac{1}{3}, \\ t \geq \frac{4}{3} : \quad a+b &< R(4/3) = \frac{7\sqrt{37}-39}{12} < \frac{1}{3}. \end{aligned}$$

The final inequalities follow respectively from $8\sqrt{37} < 49$ and $7\sqrt{37} < 43$. $\square$

F.3. Boundary trace caps. The signed center normal form gives the CE1 and CE2 center contributions from one formula; no separate maximal-interval calculation is needed here.

Theorem F.8 (Boundary trace table). *For closures of original open roles, the following bounds hold:*

role	hypothesis	$L_{\partial H}$
T_C	CE0	0
T_C	CE1	$\leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4}$
T_C	CE2	$< \frac{1}{2}$
T_i	Vd0, $A_i + B_i \leq 1$	$\leq \frac{1}{2}$
T_i	Vd0, $A_i + B_i > 1$	$\leq \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}}$
T_i	Vd1/Vd2	$< \frac{1}{2}$
T_i	T3-like	< 1 .

Proof. For every vertex role,

$$(62) \quad L_{\partial H}(T_i) = A_i + B_i.$$

Indeed, the two incident traces are initial intervals of these lengths. A relative-interior point of any nonincident edge is more than unit distance from V_i , whereas V_i is interior to the diameter-one triangle T_i . This excludes any other positive-length boundary trace.

The CE0 V triangle is the definition. Both remaining center V triangles are the two class specializations of the common signed formula in Corollary E.3.

For a nonsupercritical Vd0 V triangle, (62) is enough. For a supercritical V triangle, its incident endpoints are at squared distance $A_i^2 + A_i B_i + B_i^2 \leq 1$, and hence

$$\frac{3}{4}(A_i + B_i)^2 \leq 1.$$

This proves the $2/\sqrt{3}$ cap. The Vd1/Vd2 V triangle is (61). Finally, the Type II calculation in Proposition B.6 gives for an original T3-like role

$$A_i + B_i = z - \alpha < z < 1$$

because $0 < t < 1$ and $\alpha > 0$. $\square$

F.4. Terminal length contradictions.

Proposition F.9 (Boundary-length branches). *The following branches are impossible:*

- (1) CE0 with $N_+ = 0$;
- (2) CE0 with $N_+ = 1$ and at least one Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (3) CE1 or CE2 with $N_+ = 0$ and at least one Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (4) CE1 with $N_+ = 1$ and at least one Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (5) CE2 with $N_+ = 1$ and at least two Vd1/Vd2 roles.

Proof. In CE0, the center open role contains no relative-interior boundary point. No nonincident vertex role can contain such a point either. Hence on every edge the two incident open vertex traces form two nonempty relatively open sets covering a connected interval; they overlap in positive length. Thus

$$1 < B_i + A_{i+1}$$

on every edge. Summing gives $6 < \sum_i (A_i + B_i)$, contradicting $N_+ = 0$. This proves (1).

Items (2)–(5) are respectively items (1)–(4) of the common budget Corollary F.17. That corollary applies the one master perimeter deficit to the center cap and the indicated strict Vd1/Vd2 caps. $\square$

Proposition F.10 (Vd2 neighboring-midpoint branch). *Assume a CE2, $N_+ = 1$ configuration has exactly one Vd1/Vd2 role, that role is Vd2 and contains a neighboring midpoint, and all other vertex roles are Vd0. Then the boundary cannot be covered.*

Proof. This is item (5) of Corollary F.17, using Lemma F.7. $\square$

Proposition F.11 (Branches closed by Strategy 1). *Direct length-sum obstructions close the following routing entries and hybrid subcase:*

- (1) CE0, $N_+ = 0$;
- (2) CE0, $N_+ = 1$, with a Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (3) CE1/CE2 with $q = N_+ + m \geq 3$;
- (4) CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$, with a Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (5) CE1, $N_+ = 1$, with exactly one Vd1/Vd2 role and no T3-like role;
- (6) the Vd2 neighboring-midpoint subcase of the CE2 hybrid routing entry.

Proof. Items (1), (2), (4), and (5) are Proposition F.9. Item (3) is the short-role count and the three-short-role theorem in Corollary F.17. Item (6) is Proposition F.10. This is only the indicated subcase of the exceptional CE2 V triangle; its remaining placements are handled by the exact-demand strategy. $\square$

F.5. Common perimeter and skeleton budgets. The signed center formula also removes repeated length arithmetic. We first state a generic perimeter deficit, then count all short roles before entering the CE1/CE2 case tree.

Lemma F.12 (Master perimeter deficit). *Put*

$$\theta = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} - 1.$$

Suppose a branch has a center contribution L_C , n supercritical Vd0 V triangles, $m \geq 1$ distinguished nonsupercritical V triangles with strict boundary caps $q_1, \dots, q_m < 1$, and $6 - n - m$ remaining V triangles whose boundary contributions are at most 1. If

$$(63) \quad L_C + n\theta \leq \sum_{j=1}^m (1 - q_j),$$

then the seven roles do not cover ∂H .

Proof. The supercritical Vd0 cap is $2/\sqrt{3}$. Hence the total boundary contribution is strictly less than

$$L_C + n\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} + \sum_{j=1}^m q_j + (6 - n - m) = 6 + L_C + n\theta - \sum_{j=1}^m (1 - q_j) \leq 6.$$

The strictness follows from $m \geq 1$ and the strict distinguished-V triangle caps. A cover of the perimeter would give the opposite weak inequality by subadditivity. $\square$

Lemma F.13 (Small center slacks in the one-Vd1/Vd2 branch). *Assume there is exactly one supercritical Vd0 V triangle, exactly one Vd1/Vd2 V triangle, and four nonsupercritical Vd0 V triangles. Then every candidate surviving the perimeter budget is CE2 and satisfies*

$$(64) \quad \boxed{\alpha + \delta < \frac{1}{24}, \quad \alpha + \delta < \frac{\min\{R, W\}}{6}.}$$

Proof. The Vd1/Vd2 boundary cap is strict and equals $1/2$. If the perimeter were covered, Lemma F.12 would force

$$L_C + \theta > \frac{1}{2}.$$

Put

$$\kappa = \frac{1}{2} - \theta = \frac{3}{2} - \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}}.$$

Thus $L_C > \kappa$. The CE1 cap in Corollary E.3 gives

$$L_C + \theta \leq \left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4} \right) + \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} - 1 \right) < \frac{1}{2},$$

so every survivor is CE2.

Set $T = \alpha + \delta$. The CE2 formula gives

$$T < M(E) := \frac{RW}{E^2} \left(\frac{E}{1+E} - \kappa \right).$$

Since $RW = 1 - E^2$,

$$M(E) = \frac{1 - E}{E^2} (E - \kappa(1 + E)),$$

and

$$M'(E) = -\frac{E - 2\kappa}{E^3} < 0 \quad \left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \leq E < 1 \right).$$

Here $2\kappa < \sqrt{3}/2$, because it is equivalent to $6\sqrt{3} < 11$, whose square is $108 < 121$. Therefore

$$T < M\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = \frac{8\sqrt{3}}{9} - \frac{3}{2} < \frac{1}{24}.$$

The last inequality is equivalent to $64\sqrt{3} < 111$, and follows after squaring from $12288 < 12321$.

For the second estimate, use $E/(1 + E) < 1/2$:

$$T < \frac{RW}{E^2} \left(\frac{1}{2} - \kappa \right) = \frac{RW}{E^2} \theta.$$

Since

$$E^2 = W + R^2 = R + W^2,$$

one has $RW/E^2 \leq R$ and $RW/E^2 \leq W$. Also $\theta < 1/6$, equivalently $12 < 7\sqrt{3}$, whose square is $144 < 147$. This proves (64). $\square$

Lemma F.14 (CE2 initial endpoints dominate the total slack). *Assume $\Delta_R > 0$ and $\Delta_L > 0$. Put*

$$T = \alpha + \delta, \quad x = \frac{\eta + T}{W}, \quad y = \frac{\eta + T}{R}.$$

Then

$$(65) \quad \boxed{T < \frac{1}{2} \min\{x, y\}.}$$

Proof. Equation (54) gives $T < \eta/E$. Moreover

$$E^2 - (2R - 1)^2 = 3RW > 0,$$

so $|2R - 1| < E$ and therefore $|2R - 1|T < \eta$. Hence

$$x - 2T = \frac{\eta - (1 - 2R)T}{W} > 0,$$

and

$$y - 2T = \frac{\eta - (2R - 1)T}{R} > 0.$$

This is (65). $\square$

Theorem F.15 (Three short vertex roles). *Call a vertex role short if it is supercritical or has positive-length intersection with an adjacent radial arm. If an exact- M_0 CE1/CE2 branch contains at least three short vertex roles, then the seven roles do not cover the full skeleton S .*

Proof. The center skeleton cap is

$$L_S(T_C) < \frac{3}{2}.$$

Every short role also has skeleton contribution strictly less than $3/2$: this is the supercritical cap for a supercritical role and the translated center-role cap for an original positive-support role. Every remaining role is nonsupercritical and has no adjacent-ray support, so its skeleton contribution is at most 2.

If there are $q \geq 3$ short roles, then

$$\begin{aligned} L_S(T_C) + \sum_{i=0}^5 L_S(T_i) &< \frac{3}{2} + q\frac{3}{2} + (6-q)2 \\ &= \frac{27-q}{2} \\ &\leq 12. \end{aligned}$$

The full skeleton has length 12, so subadditivity for a cover gives a contradiction. $\square$

Lemma F.16 (Short-role count). *Let m be the number of vertex roles of type Vd1, Vd2, or T3-like, and let q be the number of short vertex roles. Then*

$$(66) \quad \boxed{q = N_+ + m.}$$

Consequently, every exact- M_0 CE1/CE2 branch with $N_+ + m \geq 3$ is impossible.

Proof. The exhaustive vertex classification says that Vd0 is exactly the class with no positive-length adjacent-arm support, while Vd1, Vd2, and T3-like are exactly the three classes with such support. Proposition F.6 gives $A_i + B_i < 1/2$ for Vd1/Vd2, and Lemma B.8 gives $A_i + B_i \leq 1$ for T3-like. Thus none of these m roles is supercritical. Conversely, every supercritical role is Vd0, so it has no positive adjacent-arm support. The two disjoint sources of short roles are therefore the N_+ supercritical roles and the m non-Vd0 roles. This proves (66); Theorem F.15 gives the last assertion. $\square$

Corollary F.17 (Length branches closed by the common budgets). *The following branches are impossible.*

- (1) CE0, $N_+ = 1$, and at least one Vd1/Vd2 V triangle;
- (2) $N_+ = 0$ and at least one Vd1/Vd2 V triangle, for either CE1 or CE2;
- (3) CE1, $N_+ = 1$, and at least one Vd1/Vd2 V triangle;
- (4) CE2, $N_+ = 1$, and at least two Vd1/Vd2 V triangles;
- (5) CE2, $N_+ = 1$, with a Vd2 V triangle containing a neighboring midpoint;
- (6) CE1 or CE2 with $N_+ + m \geq 3$, where m is the number of Vd1, Vd2, or T3-like roles;
- (7) CE1 or CE2 with $N_+ \geq 2$.

Proof. For item 1, take $L_C = 0$, one supercritical cap $2/\sqrt{3}$, and one strict Vd1/Vd2 cap $1/2$ in Lemma F.12; the needed inequality is

$$\frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} - 1 < \frac{1}{2}.$$

For item 2, the center contribution is strictly less than $1/2$ and the chosen Vd1/Vd2 V triangle has strict cap $1/2$; the other five V triangles contribute at most 1 each. This is Lemma F.12 with $n = 0$ and $q_1 = 1/2$.

For item 3, the unique supercritical V triangle is Vd0, while the CE1 center cap, the Vd1/Vd2 cap, and the four remaining unit caps give

$$\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} - \frac{3}{4}\right) + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} + 4 < 6.$$

For item 4, the corresponding CE2 sum is strictly less than

$$\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} + 3 < 6.$$

For item 5, the neighboring-midpoint Vd2 cap is $1/3$, and the total is strictly less than

$$\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} + \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} + 4 < 6.$$

Item 6 is Lemma F.16 and Theorem F.15.

Finally suppose $N_+ \geq 2$. Choose a supercritical index $s \neq 0$. Its own midpoint M_s is not covered by that V triangle, and the exact- M_0 center does not cover it. Diameter locality leaves only V triangles $s-1, s, s+1$ as possible vertex roles containing M_s . Thus one of the adjacent V triangles contains M_s and, because it is the closure of an original open role, has positive-length support on the adjacent radial arm. By Lemma F.16, this rescuer is nonsupercritical and distinct from the two supercritical V triangles. Thus there are three short roles, and the theorem applies. $\square$

APPENDIX G. SHORT LOCAL PROFILES AND EXACT VD PLACEMENTS

This appendix proves the local profile estimates used by the one-special-role branches. A T3-like rescuer and a Vd1 rescuer satisfy the same two scalar inequalities and therefore share one center-hiding theorem. The remaining Vd1/Vd2 placements use the interval residuals from Section C, one global radial envelope, and two immediate consequences of the corner normal form.

For $0 \leq c < 1/2$, put

$$(67) \quad B_{\text{sc}}(c) = \frac{c + \sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4}}{2}, \quad A_{\text{sc}}(c) = 1 - B_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

At $c = 1/2$, the same symbols denote the continuous endpoint values $B_{\text{sc}}(1/2) = A_{\text{sc}}(1/2) = 1/2$; this is a convention, not the supremum of a nonempty strict-supercritical feasible set. The free strict-supercritical envelope says that a strict supercritical V triangle with radial demand at least c has outgoing reach strictly below $B_{\text{sc}}(c)$, and B_{sc} is strictly decreasing.

G.1. A global quarter radial envelope. For $(p, h) \in [0, 1]^2$, let $c_{\text{max}}(p, h)$ be the maximal radial coordinate such that (p, h, c) belongs to the local admissible set.

Lemma G.1 (Quarter radial envelope). *If*

$$0 \leq h \leq p, \quad p + h < 1,$$

then

$$(68) \quad c_{\text{max}}(p, h) \leq 1 - \frac{h}{4}.$$

The inequality is strict on the selected $\mathcal{A}_T$ component.

Proof. Put $s = p + h$ and $q = s^4 - s^2 + ph$. Since $s < 1$, only the two nonsupercritical cells of Proposition M.2 occur.

On $\mathcal{A}_L$, the smaller boundary coordinate is h , and the selected radial frontier is the unique root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$ of

$$P_h(c) = c^4 - c^2 + hc - h^2 = 0.$$

At $c_0 = 1 - h/4$,

$$P_h(c_0) = \frac{h}{256}(h^3 - 16h^2 - 240h + 128).$$

The cubic decreases on $[0, 1/2]$ and has value $33/8$ at $1/2$, so this is positive for $h > 0$. Moreover

$$P_h\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = -\left(h - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}\right)^2 \leq 0, \quad P'_h(c) > 0 \quad (c \geq \sqrt{3}/2).$$

Hence the selected root is below c_0 ; for $h = 0$ equality gives $c_{\max} = 1$.

On $\mathcal{A}_T$, put

$$r = \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}, \quad \gamma = \frac{p - h}{s}.$$

The exact identity

$$\frac{q}{s^2} = \frac{r^2 - \gamma^2}{4}$$

gives $0 \leq \gamma < r$. Write $\gamma = wr$, $0 \leq w < 1$. Then

$$p = \frac{s(1 + wr)}{2}, \quad h = \frac{s(1 - wr)}{2}, \quad c_{\max} = \frac{s(1 + wr)}{1 + r}.$$

For

$$\Psi(w) = c_{\max} + \frac{h}{4}$$

one has

$$\Psi'(w) = \frac{sr(7 - r)}{8(1 + r)} > 0,$$

so

$$\Psi(w) < \Psi(1) = \frac{s(9 - r)}{8}.$$

Since $4s^2 = r^2 + 3$,

$$256 - (r^2 + 3)(9 - r)^2 = (1 - r)(r^3 - 17r^2 + 67r + 13) > 0$$

for $0 \leq r < 1$; the cubic is increasing and positive on this interval. Thus $s(9 - r) < 8$ and $c_{\max} + h/4 < 1$. $\square$

G.2. The rational T3-like rescuer profile.

Lemma G.2 (T3-like rescuer profile). *Let a translated T3-like role at V_0 contain M_1 , have boundary trace $[0, a]$ on $e_{5,0}$, and have adjacent-radial trace $[c, u]$ on r_1 measured from V_1 toward O . Then*

$$(69) \quad a \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c), \quad \frac{a}{a + 1 - u} \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

Proof. The translated T3-like normal form supplies

$$1 \leq D \leq \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}}, \quad E = \sqrt{4 - 3D^2}, \quad \varrho = \frac{D + E}{2},$$

and

$$\frac{E}{2D} \leq a \leq \frac{4 - 3D + E}{4D}.$$

Its radial interval is

$$c = \frac{D(1 + a) - 1}{\varrho}, \quad u = 1 - \frac{\varrho}{D} + a.$$

Put

$$x = \frac{aD}{\varrho}, \quad \theta = \frac{D - 1}{\varrho}.$$

The relation $\varrho^2 - D\varrho + D^2 = 1$ gives

$$\varrho = \frac{1 - 2\theta}{1 - \theta + \theta^2}, \quad D = \frac{1 - \theta^2}{1 - \theta + \theta^2}, \quad E = \frac{1 - 4\theta + \theta^2}{1 - \theta + \theta^2},$$

with $0 \leq \theta \leq 2 - \sqrt{3}$. Moreover

$$(70) \quad c = x + \theta, \quad \frac{1 - 4\theta + \theta^2}{2(1 - 2\theta)} \leq x \leq \frac{1}{2} - \theta.$$

Let

$$\Phi(z) = \frac{z(2 - z)}{1 + z}.$$

It is increasing on $[0, 1/2]$ and $\Phi(A_{\text{sc}}(c)) = c$. Hence it is enough to prove $\Phi(x) \leq x + \theta$, or equivalently

$$Q_\theta(x) = 2x^2 + (\theta - 1)x + \theta \geq 0.$$

The vertex is $x_* = (1 - \theta)/4$. If $0 \leq \theta \leq 1/5$, the lower endpoint x_L in (70) satisfies

$$x_L - x_* = \frac{1 - 5\theta}{4(1 - 2\theta)} \geq 0,$$

and

$$Q_\theta(x_L) = \frac{\theta(1 - 5\theta + 11\theta^2 - \theta^3)}{2(1 - 2\theta)^2} \geq 0.$$

If $1/5 \leq \theta \leq 2 - \sqrt{3}$, the vertex lies in the feasible interval and

$$Q_\theta(x) \geq Q_\theta(x_*) = \frac{10\theta - 1 - \theta^2}{8} > 0.$$

Thus $x \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c)$. Since $D \geq \varrho$, one has $a \leq x$, and

$$\frac{a}{a + 1 - u} = \frac{aD}{\varrho} = x.$$

This proves both inequalities. $\square$

G.3. The Vd1 rescuer profile.

Lemma G.3 (Vd1 rescuer profile). *Let a Vd1 role at V_0 contain M_1 , have boundary trace $[0, a]$ on $e_{5,0}$, and have adjacent-radial trace $[c, u]$ on r_1 . Assume it has no positive support on r_5 . Then*

$$(71) \quad a \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c), \quad \frac{a}{a+1-u} \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

Proof. The Vd corner normal form gives $t > 0$, $d = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}$, and

$$c = \frac{t(1-b)}{t+1}, \quad u = \frac{d-a-tb-1}{t}.$$

The midpoint condition implies

$$tb = t - c(t+1), \quad a + tb \leq d - 1 - \frac{t}{2}.$$

One-sided support forces $t \geq 1$. Indeed, if $t < 1$, then

$$d - a - tb - t \geq 1 - \frac{t}{2} > \frac{1}{t+1} > \frac{1-a}{t+1},$$

so the raw r_5 interval has positive length, contrary to the Vd1 type.

Put

$$F(t, c) = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1} - 1 - \frac{3t}{2} + c(t+1).$$

Then $a \leq F(t, c)$. Since $c \leq 1/2$,

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial t} = \frac{2t+1}{2\sqrt{t^2+t+1}} - \frac{3}{2} + c \leq \frac{2t+1}{2\sqrt{t^2+t+1}} - 1 < 0,$$

where the last inequality follows from $(2t+1)^2 < 4(t^2+t+1)$. Thus F decreases for $t \geq 1$, and

$$a \leq F(t, c) \leq L(c) := \sqrt{3} - \frac{5}{2} + 2c.$$

Every feasible V triangle has $L(c) \geq 0$. The inequality $2L(c) \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c)$ is equivalent to

$$\sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4} \leq 12 - 4\sqrt{3} - 9c.$$

The right side is positive on $[0, 1/2]$. Squaring is therefore legitimate, and the squared difference is $4Q(c)$, where

$$Q(c) = 20c^2 + (18\sqrt{3} - 52)c + 47 - 24\sqrt{3}.$$

The polynomial is decreasing on $[0, 1/2]$ and $Q(1/2) = 26 - 15\sqrt{3} > 0$. Hence $2L(c) \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c)$, and therefore $a \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c)$.

Put $\varepsilon = 1 - u > 0$. The endpoint formula gives

$$\varepsilon = \varepsilon_0 + \frac{a}{t}, \quad \varepsilon_0 = \frac{2t+1-c(t+1)-d}{t}.$$

Since $c \leq 1/2$ and $t \geq 1$,

$$2t+1-c(t+1)-d \geq \frac{3t+1}{2} - d > 0;$$

the last inequality follows after squaring from $(3t+1)^2/4 - d^2 = (5t^2+2t-3)/4 > 0$. Thus $\varepsilon_0 > 0$. Moreover,

$$\varepsilon_0 + \frac{F(t, c)}{t} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Since $z/(z + \varepsilon_0 + z/t)$ increases in z ,

$$\frac{a}{a + \varepsilon} \leq \frac{F(t, c)}{F(t, c) + 1/2} \leq \frac{L(c)}{L(c) + 1/2} \leq 2L(c) \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

□

G.4. A common adjacent-rescuer theorem.

Lemma G.4 (Common adjacent-rescuer obstruction). *Let a local rescuer T_0 have trace $[0, a]$ on $e_{5,0}$ and adjacent-radial trace $[c, u]$ on r_1 , measured from V_1 toward O . Put*

$$\varepsilon = 1 - u > 0, \quad \Theta = \frac{a}{a + \varepsilon}.$$

Assume

$$(72) \quad a \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c), \quad \Theta \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c),$$

and assume radial isolation forces the center to cover the O -side gap of length ε . If T_1 is the unique strict supercritical V triangle and T_2, T_3, T_4, T_5 are nonsupercritical, then the perimeter and r_1 are not covered.

Proof. The center exit on r_1 is δ/R , so radial isolation gives

$$\delta \geq R\varepsilon.$$

Let h be the reach forced on T_5 along $e_{5,0}$. If the companion center trace does not hide the gap after coordinate a , then

$$h \geq 1 - a \geq B_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

In the only hiding order,

$$\frac{k}{W} \leq a < R + \alpha.$$

The left endpoint inequality and radial isolation give

$$k \leq Wa, \quad R\varepsilon \leq Wa,$$

so $R(a + \varepsilon) \leq a$ and $R \leq \Theta$. Also

$$\alpha \leq Wa - R\varepsilon - \eta,$$

whence

$$R + \alpha \leq a + R(u - a).$$

The hiding order forces $u > a$, and therefore

$$R + \alpha \leq a + \Theta(u - a) = \Theta \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

Thus in every ordering

$$h \geq B_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

Coverage of r_1 gives the supercritical V triangle radial demand at least c , so its outgoing reach satisfies

$$b_1 < B_{\text{sc}}(c) \leq h.$$

Lemma C.6, applied to T_2, T_3, T_4, T_5 , gives

$$\sum_{i=2}^5 (a_i + b_i) \geq 4 + h - b_1 > 4,$$

contrary to their four nonsupercritical caps. □

Corollary G.5 (T3-like and Vd1 adjacent rescue). *The common adjacent-rescuer lemma applies both to the exactly-one-T3-like branch and to the normalized Vd1 V triangle containing the neighboring midpoint.*

Proof. Lemmas G.2 and G.3 give the two local inequalities. In both branches, midpoint and support isolation force the center to cover the O -side radial gap before the rescuer begins. $\square$

G.5. Adjacent Vd1/Vd2 placement.

Lemma G.6 (Adjacent Vd1/Vd2 placement). *Assume a reduced CE2 exact- M_0 candidate has $N_+ = 1$, V triangle T_0 uniquely supercritical, V triangle T_1 the unique Vd1/Vd2 V triangle, and V triangles T_2, T_3, T_4, T_5 nonsupercritical Vd0. Then the perimeter together with r_2 is not covered. The reflected T_5 placement is also impossible.*

Proof. Let

$$I_L = \left[\frac{k}{W}, R + \alpha \right], \quad I_R = \left[\frac{k}{R}, W + \delta \right].$$

For the supercritical reaches (a_0, b_0) , put

$$A = \mathcal{R}_{I_R}(b_0), \quad H = \mathcal{R}_{I_L}(a_0).$$

The endpoint-distance inequality is

$$a_0^2 + a_0 b_0 + b_0^2 \leq 1.$$

It implies $a_0, b_0 < 1$. The signed center bounds give $R + \alpha < 1$, so $H > 0$. Boundary propagation gives

$$a_i \geq A, \quad b_i \geq H \quad (1 \leq i \leq 5).$$

The Vd cap gives

$$(73) \quad A + H < \frac{1}{2}.$$

The common perimeter budget gives

$$T := \alpha + \delta < \frac{1}{24}, \quad T < \frac{\min\{R, W\}}{6}.$$

We claim

$$(74) \quad \delta < \frac{H}{4}.$$

If $H = W - \alpha$, then

$$4\delta + \alpha \leq 4T < \frac{2W}{3} < W.$$

Suppose $H = 1 - a_0$. The other residual cannot be $1 - b_0$, since otherwise (73) would give $a_0 + b_0 > 3/2$, whereas the endpoint-distance inequality gives $a_0 + b_0 \leq 2/\sqrt{3} < 3/2$. Hence

$$A = 1 - (W + \delta), \quad b_0 \geq y := \frac{k}{R},$$

and $W + \delta > 1/2 + H$. Diameter transfer gives

$$H > \frac{y}{2} > \frac{\eta}{2R}.$$

Thus

$$\delta > J(R) := R - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\eta}{2R}.$$

Writing $\eta/R = W/(1+E)$, exact differentiation gives

$$4E(1+E)^2 J'(R) = 2E(1+E)(1+2E) - W(2R-1).$$

If $R \leq 1/2$, the second term is nonnegative after subtraction. If $R \geq 1/2$, then $W(2R-1) \leq 1/8$, while the first term is larger than $1/8$. Thus $J'(R) > 0$. Since $J(3/8) = 1/24$, the bound $\delta < 1/24$ forces $R < 3/8$. Then

$$(2-3R)^2 - E^2 = (3-8R)(1-R) > 0,$$

so $\eta/R > 1/3$ and $H > 1/6$. Hence $4\delta < 1/6 < H$, proving (74).

The center interval on r_2 begins from the vertex side at $1-\delta$. If T_1 supports r_2 , its exact endpoint satisfies

$$u_2 < 1 - b_1 - \frac{a_1}{t} \leq 1 - H < 1 - \delta.$$

Thus it does not bridge to the center. For T_2 , boundary handoff gives

$$a_2 > \frac{1}{2} + A, \quad b_2 \geq H.$$

Put $p = 1/2 + A$. Equation (73) gives $0 \leq H \leq p$ and $p + H < 1$. Lemma G.1 gives

$$c_2 \leq c_{\max}(p, H) \leq 1 - \frac{H}{4} < 1 - \delta.$$

Thus neither possible radial bridge reaches the center interval, and r_2 is uncovered. $\square$

G.6. Nonadjacent Vd1/Vd2 placements.

Lemma G.7 (Nonadjacent Vd1/Vd2 placements). *Under the same reduced CE2 branch, let the unique Vd1/Vd2 V triangle be T_τ with $\tau \in \{2, 3, 4\}$. Then the perimeter together with r_τ is not covered.*

Proof. Put

$$T = \alpha + \delta, \quad x = \frac{\eta + T}{W}, \quad y = \frac{\eta + T}{R}.$$

Lemma F.14 gives

$$T < \frac{1}{2} \min\{x, y\}.$$

Let (a_0, b_0) be the reaches of the unique supercritical V triangle. Then

$$a_0 + b_0 > 1, \quad a_0^2 + a_0 b_0 + b_0^2 \leq 1.$$

Let

$$B = e_{[y, W+\delta]}(b_0), \quad U = e_{[x, R+\alpha]}(a_0), \quad A = 1 - B, \quad H = 1 - U.$$

Boundary propagation and the Vd cap give

$$a_\tau \geq A, \quad b_\tau \geq H, \quad A + H < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Let $\beta(q) = (-q + \sqrt{4-3q^2})/2$. The component endpoint B is either b_0 or $W + \delta$. In the latter case the center diameter gives $B \leq \beta(x)$. In the former case, if $a_0 < x$, then $U = a_0$ and $A + H < 1/2$ would force $a_0 + b_0 > 3/2$, contrary to

$a_0 + b_0 \leq 2/\sqrt{3}$. Hence $a_0 \geq x$, and $B = b_0 \leq \beta(a_0) \leq \beta(x)$. Reflection gives $U \leq \beta(y)$. Consequently

$$A > \frac{x}{2} > T, \quad H > \frac{y}{2} > T.$$

Thus

$$d_\tau^C < \min\{A, H\} \quad (\tau = 2, 3, 4),$$

because the three exits are δ , α , and $\min\{\alpha/R, \delta/W\} \leq T$.

The Vd corner normal form gives the own-radial margin

$$c_\tau < 1 - \min\{A, H\}.$$

But the center interval begins from the vertex side at

$$1 - d_\tau^C > 1 - \min\{A, H\}.$$

The two radial traces are disjoint, and all other roles are excluded by Vd0 locality and diameter locality. $\square$

G.7. Placement interfaces. The local profile and radial-separation lemmas above are assembled exactly once in Section Q. This appendix contains no independent CE2 one-Vd placement assembly.

APPENDIX H. STRATEGY 2 GEOMETRY-PARAMETER BRIDGES

This appendix is the only place where geometric Strategy 2 records and the self-contained optimization variables coexist. Every proposition below has one task: produce a point of an explicitly registered real domain and identify the objective with the scalar quantity used in the body. No optimization inequality is proved here.

H.1. Signed center and the four all-Vd0 problems.

Proposition H.1 (Signed-domain bridge). *Let (R, α, δ) be the normalized signed-center record. Under*

$$r = R, \quad a = \alpha, \quad d = \delta,$$

the full geometric CE1 and CE2 center cells are respectively $\mathcal{D}_{C1}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{C2}$. The additional orientation and handoff inequalities in the CE1 all-Vd0 one-gap branch give the smaller cell $\mathcal{D}_1$, while $\mathcal{D}_2 = \mathcal{D}_{C2}$.

Proof. The signed-center normal form gives

$$W = 1 - R, \quad E = \sqrt{1 - RW}, \quad \eta = 1 - E, \quad P = E(1 - E),$$

$$k = \eta + \alpha + \delta, \quad \Delta_R = P - \alpha - W\delta, \quad \Delta_L = P - R\alpha - \delta.$$

After substitution these are the definitions of $w, e, \eta, p, k, \Delta_R, \Delta_L$. The CE sign is exactly the sign of Δ_L . In the oriented CE1 one-gap branch the midpoint and endpoint orders additionally give

$$\alpha < W/2, \quad \delta < R/2, \quad R\delta - W\alpha > 0,$$

which are precisely the extra inequalities defining $\mathcal{D}_1$. $\square$

For an endpoint record $\mathbf{e} = (a_-, a_+, c_-, c_+)$, write

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}) = \widehat{g}_{c_-}(1 - a_-) + \widehat{g}_{c_+}(1 - a_+).$$

The exact function dictionary is

$$F(c, x) = \widehat{g}_c(1 - x), \quad T(c, x) = \widehat{g}_c^\vee(x).$$

Proposition H.2 (Endpoint bridge). *The normalized one-gap endpoint record is*

$$\left(\frac{k}{r}, r - d, 1 - \frac{a}{w}, 1 - \frac{d}{r} \right),$$

and

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{\text{one}}) - 1 = \Psi_{\text{E1}}(r, a, d).$$

On $\mathcal{D}_2$, the paired record is

$$\left(w - a, r - d, \frac{w - a}{w}, \frac{r - d}{r} \right),$$

and

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{\text{two}}) - 1 = \Psi_{\text{E2}}(r, a, d).$$

Proof. Substitute the signed trace endpoints and complementary radial exits, then use $F(c, x) = \widehat{g}_c(1 - x)$. $\square$

Proposition H.3 (Returned-demand bridge). *Put*

$$X = r - d, \quad H = \frac{k}{2r}, \quad m = \min \left\{ \frac{a}{r}, \frac{d}{w} \right\}.$$

Let $Y_0 = H$ and

$$Y_1 = T(1 - a, Y_0), \quad Y_2 = T(1 - m, Y_1), \quad Y_3 = T(1 - d, Y_2).$$

The objective $Y_3 > w + d = 1 - X$ in Problem S2-R1 or S2-R2 is the complement-dual form of the middle-three exact forward-transfer inequality. It implies the body target $Z > 1 - H$.

Proof. The five radial demands are

$$1 - \frac{d}{r}, \quad 1 - d, \quad 1 - m, \quad 1 - a, \quad 1 - \frac{a}{w}.$$

The first and fifth transfers are extensive. Three exact complement-duality steps reverse the middle transfers and transform the forward terminal bound into $Y_3 > 1 - X$. $\square$

H.2. T3 endpoint domain.

Proposition H.4 (Symmetry and exact T3 source variables). *Normalizing the unique center midpoint to M_0 , and then choosing the supported adjacent arm r_1 , uses only the D_6 -symmetry of the regular hexagon. Those two without-loss-of-generality normalizations are retained.*

The later trace-dominating translation is not a D_6 -symmetry. Its output is replaced by the exact real parameters

$$0 < \tau < 1, \quad z = \sqrt{1 - \tau + \tau^2}, \quad 0 < \beta < \frac{\tau z}{1 + z}.$$

The boundary endpoints and adjacent-radial interval are

$$b_- = \beta, \quad b_+ = z - \beta,$$

$$q = 1 - z + \beta, \quad c_\star = \frac{q}{\tau}, \quad u_\star = 1 + \beta - \tau.$$

Every support-isolated endpoint record therefore determines a point of one cell in Definition I.12.

Proof. The first paragraph is the dihedral normalization in the role-forcing and support-isolation lemmas. For the non-symmetry step use the exhaustive translated Type-II equations. With its original orientation parameter τ , one has

$$D = \frac{1}{z}, \quad R = \frac{\tau}{z}.$$

The translated side offset is β , and direct substitution gives the four displayed endpoint formulas. The center residual orders and the radial hit/miss orders are precisely the cells $\mathcal{R}_i, \mathcal{L}_{\varepsilon,j}, \mathcal{K}_h$. The exact capped map supplies one contact cell for each endpoint in the hard region. $\square$

Proposition H.5 (T3 objective bridge). *For the point $\xi \in \Omega_{T3}$ produced above,*

$$\text{Cap}(\mathbf{e}_{T3}) - 1 = \Psi_{T3}(\xi).$$

Proof. The variables A_1, A_5 are the far-side residual boundary demands, while C_1, C_5 are the complementary radial demands. Apply $F(c, x) = \hat{g}_c(1 - x)$ to both endpoint terms. $\square$

H.3. Adjacent-rescuer domains.

Proposition H.6 (First rescuer source bridge). *The exact rational variables of the T3-like local profile satisfy*

$$0 \leq \theta \leq 2 - \sqrt{3}, \quad x_L(\theta) \leq x \leq \frac{1}{2} - \theta,$$

and produce

$$a = x\rho(\theta), \quad c = x + \theta, \quad u = 1 - \rho(\theta) + a.$$

Hence the record belongs to Ω_{SC}^T .

Proof. Use

$$\theta = \frac{D-1}{\varrho}, \quad x = \frac{aD}{\varrho}.$$

The exact inverse formulas for D, ϱ give the graph identities and the stated interval bounds. This replaces the genuine translation reduction; it does not alter the preceding D_6 -normalization. $\square$

Proposition H.7 (Second rescuer source bridge). *The Vd1 corner variables satisfy the equations and inequalities of Ω_{SC}^V . In particular, absence of a positive interval on the second adjacent arm is exactly*

$$\Delta(t) - a - tb - t \leq \frac{1-a}{t+1}.$$

Proof. The two raw endpoints on that arm are

$$\lambda_5 = \frac{1-a}{t+1}, \quad \mu_5 = \Delta(t) - a - tb - t.$$

Since $\lambda_5 > 0$, absence of a positive interval is equivalent to $\mu_5 \leq \lambda_5$. The remaining equations are the first-arm graph and the neighboring-midpoint inequality. $\square$

H.4. Vd radial domains.

Proposition H.8 (Explicit residual bridge). *For a center interval $[L, U]$, the component endpoint and residual used in the Vd placement proofs are exactly*

$$E(L, U; x), \quad R(L, U; x).$$

Thus every center-assisted boundary residual belongs to one of the three explicit order cells in Problem S2-VD. Moreover, with

$$x = \frac{k}{w}, \quad y = \frac{k}{r},$$

the two center endpoint pairs satisfy

$$x^2 + x(w + d) + (w + d)^2 \leq 1, \quad y^2 + y(r + a) + (r + a)^2 \leq 1.$$

These are the explicit center-distance constraints included in the nonadjacent Vd cells.

Proof. If $x < L$, the initial component ends at x . If $L \leq x \leq U$, it continues through the interval to U . If $U < x$, it already extends to x . The cases are disjoint after assigning equality to the middle cell. The two quadratic inequalities are the endpoint-distance inequalities for the two normalized center traces, after substituting the signed-center formulas. $\square$

Proposition H.9 (Explicit corner-graph bridge). *Let p_1, q_1 be the exact boundary reaches of an adjacent Vd role and let $t > 0$ be its corner parameter. The far endpoint of a supported adjacent interval is*

$$u_+ = \frac{\sqrt{t^2 + t + 1} - p_1 - tq_1 - 1}{t}.$$

For a nonadjacent role with boundary reaches p_v, q_v , its own-radial endpoint is

$$C_v = \frac{\sqrt{t^2 + t + 1} - p_v - tq_v}{t + 1}.$$

Consequently the adjacent and nonadjacent records lie in the cells of Definitions I.17 and I.19.

Proof. Both identities are exact endpoint formulas of the corner normal form. Positive support is the explicit order $\lambda_+ < u_+$; absence of positive support is $u_+ \leq \lambda_+$. The center exits for the three nonadjacent indices are

$$d, \quad \min \left\{ \frac{a}{r}, \frac{d}{w} \right\}, \quad a,$$

which are exactly the finite order cells in the definition. $\square$

Remark H.10. The Vd1-supercritical two-chart replacement is not represented by a scalar problem. It changes geometric roles while preserving skeleton coverage and remains a geometric theorem.

APPENDIX I. STRATEGY 2 AS REAL-VARIABLE OPTIMIZATION

This appendix is the formalization interface for the scalar part of Strategy 2. Every registered problem contains only:

- (1) finitely many real input variables;
- (2) explicit radical or rational derived functions;
- (3) a finite union of branchwise semialgebraic cells;
- (4) an objective or recurrence; and
- (5) a required strict or weak sign.

No hexagon, triangle, boundary edge, role type, translated object, placement coordinate, or supremum occurs in a problem definition. The sole dictionary back to geometry is Appendix H.

I.1. The primitive capped-output function. For

$$\frac{1}{2} < c < 1, \quad 0 \leq x \leq 1,$$

define

$$h(c) = \frac{2c}{1 + \sqrt{16c^2 - 3}}, \quad Q_-(c, x) = \frac{\sqrt{x^2 - cx + c^2}}{c} - x.$$

For

$$\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \leq c < 1,$$

define

$$L(c) = \frac{c}{2} \left(1 - \sqrt{4c^2 - 3} \right), \quad U(c) = c - L(c).$$

Finally put

$$D_+(c, x) = (2xc^2 + c)^2 - 4(1 - c^2)(1 - x^2)c^2$$

and, whenever $D_+(c, x) \geq 0$, define

$$Q_+(c, x) = \frac{2(1 - x^2)c^2}{2xc^2 + c + \sqrt{D_+(c, x)}}.$$

Lemma I.1 (Radical and denominator domains). *If $1/2 < c < 1$ and $1 - c \leq x \leq 1$, then*

$$D_+(c, x) = c^2 (4x^2 + 4cx + 4c^2 - 3) \geq c^2 (2c - 1)^2 > 0.$$

Every denominator in h, Q_-, Q_+ is positive on the branch on which the corresponding expression is used. The functions L, U are real-valued on their stated domain.

Proof. The displayed factorization is direct. The quadratic $x \mapsto 4x^2 + 4cx + 4c^2 - 3$ is increasing for $x \geq 0$, so its value at $x = 1 - c$ is $(2c - 1)^2$. The remaining assertions follow from $c > 1/2$, positivity of square roots, and $2xc^2 + c > 0$. $\square$

Definition I.2 (Pure capped-output function). Define $F : (1/2, 1) \times [0, 1] \rightarrow [0, 1]$ as follows. For $1/2 < c \leq \sqrt{3}/2$, put

$$F(c, x) = \begin{cases} 1 - x, & 0 \leq x \leq 1 - c, \\ Q_+(c, x), & 1 - c < x < h(c), \\ h(c), & x = h(c), \\ Q_-(c, x), & h(c) < x < c, \\ 1 - x, & c \leq x \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

For $\sqrt{3}/2 < c < 1$, put

$$F(c, x) = \begin{cases} 1 - x, & 0 \leq x \leq 1 - c, \\ Q_+(c, x), & 1 - c < x \leq L(c), \\ L(c), & L(c) < x < U(c), \\ Q_-(c, x), & U(c) \leq x < c, \\ 1 - x, & c \leq x \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

Define the complementary update

$$T(c, x) := 1 - F(c, x).$$

The equality assignments in Definition I.2 are part of the problem specification. In particular, the value at $x = L(c)$ is the selected Q_+ value $U(c)$, while the open interval immediately to its right has value $L(c)$.

Definition I.3 (Pure lower relaxations). For $0 < d < 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, define

$$E_0(d) := L(1 - d).$$

For $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, define

$$A_{d,\lambda}(x) := x + \lambda(x - d).$$

It is licensed on an interval I only after proving

$$A_{d,\lambda}(x) \leq T(1 - d, x) \quad (x \in I).$$

Define

$$\Theta_d(x) = \begin{cases} x, & 0 \leq x \leq E_0(d), \\ 1 - E_0(d), & E_0(d) < x \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

The verification appendix proves

$$\Theta_d(x) \leq T(1 - d, x).$$

These are proof devices for Problems I.9 and I.10; they are not additional primitive functions in the problem statements.

I.2. Branchwise strict optimization. Because F has different algebraic expressions on different contact cells and has a genuine jump at one high-radial boundary, no expression may be optimized outside the cell on which it represents F .

Definition I.4 (Strict branch certificate). Let

$$D = \bigsqcup_{\lambda \in \Lambda} D_\lambda$$

be a finite disjoint decomposition of a bounded real domain. Suppose that, for every λ , the selected branch expression Ψ_λ extends continuously to a compact set $K_\lambda \supseteq D_\lambda$. A *strict branch certificate* for $\Psi < 0$ consists of

$$\max_{z \in K_\lambda} \Psi_\lambda(z) \leq 0$$

and

$$D_\lambda \cap \{z : \Psi_\lambda(z) = 0\} = \emptyset$$

for every $\lambda \in \Lambda$.

The compact set K_λ is part of the certificate; it need not be the topological closure when the selected radical or rational expression does not extend to every closure point. The equality-exclusion condition is essential: on an open feasible cell the supremum may equal zero although the desired pointwise inequality is strict.

For a polynomial encoding, replace every radical $\sqrt{P(z)}$ by a fresh variable s with

$$s \geq 0, \quad s^2 = P(z).$$

Replace every minimum or maximum by finitely many ordered cells, assigning each equality to one specified cell. Record denominator positivity before clearing denominators.

I.3. Signed real parameter domains. Use independent variables

$$(r, a, d) \in \mathbb{R}^3$$

and define

$$\begin{aligned} w = 1 - r, \quad e = \sqrt{1 - rw}, \quad \eta = 1 - e, \quad p = e(1 - e), \quad k = \eta + a + d, \\ \Delta_R = p - a - wd, \quad \Delta_L = p - ra - d. \end{aligned}$$

Definition I.5 (Pure signed domains). Define

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}} = \{(r, a, d) : 0 < r < 1, a > 0, d > 0, \Delta_R > 0\}.$$

The full signed center cells are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{D}_{C1} &= \{(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}} : \Delta_L \leq 0\}, \\ \mathcal{D}_{C2} &= \{(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}} : \Delta_L > 0\}. \end{aligned}$$

The oriented CE1 one-gap cell is

$$\mathcal{D}_1 = \left\{ (r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_{C1} : a < \frac{w}{2}, \quad d < \frac{r}{2}, \quad rd - wa > 0 \right\},$$

and put

$$\mathcal{D}_2 := \mathcal{D}_{C2}.$$

Thus $\mathcal{D}_{C1} \sqcup \mathcal{D}_{C2} = \mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}}$. The extra order condition in $\mathcal{D}_1$ is used only by the oriented CE1 one-gap return problem; it is not imposed on the T3 endpoint problem.

Proposition I.6 (Basic domain bounds). *On $\mathcal{D}_{\text{sgn}}$,*

$$\begin{aligned} 0 < a < \frac{w}{2}, \quad 0 < d < \frac{r}{2}, \\ 0 < \frac{k}{r} < w + d < 1. \end{aligned}$$

On $\mathcal{D}_{C2}$, also

$$0 < \frac{k}{w} < r + a < 1.$$

Consequently every occurrence of F in Problems S2-E1, S2-E2, S2-R1, and S2-R2 has first argument in $(1/2, 1)$ and second argument in $[0, 1]$.

Proof. The identities

$$1 - e = \frac{rw}{1 + e}, \quad p = \frac{erw}{1 + e} < \frac{rw}{2}$$

and $\Delta_R > 0$ give

$$0 < a < p < \frac{rw}{2}, \quad 0 < d < \frac{p - a}{w} < \frac{r}{2}.$$

Moreover,

$$w + d - \frac{k}{r} = \frac{\Delta_R}{r} > 0.$$

The upper endpoint $w + d$ is below one because $d < r/2 < r$. On $\mathcal{D}_{C2}$,

$$r + a - \frac{k}{w} = \frac{\Delta_L}{w} > 0,$$

and $r + a < 1$ follows from $a < w/2 < w$. The claimed F -argument bounds follow directly. The return recurrence starts at $k/(2r) \in (0, 1/2)$, uses parameters $1 - a, 1 - d, 1 - \min\{a/r, d/w\} \in (1/2, 1)$, and T maps to $[0, 1]$. $\square$

I.4. Four all-Vd0 optimization problems.

Definition I.7 (Problem S2-E1: one-gap endpoint). For $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1 \cup \mathcal{D}_2$, define

$$x_- = \frac{k}{r}, \quad x_+ = r - d, \quad c_- = 1 - \frac{a}{w}, \quad c_+ = 1 - \frac{d}{r},$$

and

$$\Psi_{E1}(r, a, d) = F(c_-, x_-) + F(c_+, x_+) - 1.$$

The optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{E1}(r, a, d) < 0 \quad ((r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1 \cup \mathcal{D}_2).}$$

Definition I.8 (Problem S2-E2: paired endpoint). For $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2$, define

$$x_- = w - a, \quad x_+ = r - d, \quad c_- = \frac{x_-}{w}, \quad c_+ = \frac{x_+}{r},$$

and

$$\Psi_{E2}(r, a, d) = F(c_-, x_-) + F(c_+, x_+) - 1.$$

The optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{E2}(r, a, d) < 0 \quad ((r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2).}$$

For the return problems define

$$X = r - d, \quad Y_0 = \frac{k}{2r}, \quad m = \min \left\{ \frac{a}{r}, \frac{d}{w} \right\},$$

and recursively

$$Y_1 = T(1 - a, Y_0), \quad Y_2 = T(1 - m, Y_1), \quad Y_3 = T(1 - d, Y_2).$$

Definition I.9 (Problem S2-R1: CE1 returned demand). For $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1$, define

$$\Psi_{R1}(r, a, d) = w + d - Y_3.$$

The optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{R1}(r, a, d) < 0 \quad ((r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1).}$$

Definition I.10 (Problem S2-R2: CE2 returned demand). For $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2$, define

$$\Psi_{R2}(r, a, d) = w + d - Y_3.$$

The optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{R2}(r, a, d) < 0 \quad ((r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2)}.$$

The required threshold condition is an inclusive disjunction: at least one of the two stated threshold cells holds. No uniqueness or disjointness condition is added.

I.5. Finite contact-label cells. Let

$$\mathfrak{L} = \{\text{Full}, L, T_-, T_+\}.$$

For $(c, x) \in (1/2, 1) \times [0, 1]$, define the following pairwise disjoint predicates:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{C}_{\text{Full}} &= \{(c, x) : x \leq 1 - c \text{ or } c \leq x\}, \\ \mathcal{C}_L &= \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{1}{2} < c \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, x = h(c) \right\} \\ &\quad \cup \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} < c < 1, L(c) < x < U(c) \right\}, \\ \mathcal{C}_{T_-} &= \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{1}{2} < c \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, h(c) < x < c \right\} \\ &\quad \cup \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} < c < 1, U(c) \leq x < c \right\}, \\ \mathcal{C}_{T_+} &= \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{1}{2} < c \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, 1 - c < x < h(c) \right\} \\ &\quad \cup \left\{ (c, x) : \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} < c < 1, 1 - c < x \leq L(c) \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

Write

$$\text{Cell}_\ell(c, x) \iff (c, x) \in \mathcal{C}_\ell.$$

The equality $x = h(c)$ is assigned to L , $x = L(c)$ is assigned to T_+ , and $x = U(c)$ is assigned to T_- . Hence

$$(1/2, 1) \times [0, 1] = \bigsqcup_{\ell \in \mathfrak{L}} \mathcal{C}_\ell.$$

This is the finite branch index used by the endpoint problems. No algebraic expression is optimized outside its own cell.

I.6. Problem S2-T3: explicit finite endpoint cells. Use independent variables

$$(r, a, d, \tau, \beta) \in \mathbb{R}^5.$$

Define

$$\begin{aligned} w &= 1 - r, & e &= \sqrt{1 - rw}, & \eta &= 1 - e, & p &= e(1 - e), & k &= \eta + a + d, \\ s_R &= \frac{k}{r}, & t_R &= w + d, & s_L &= \frac{k}{w}, & t_L &= r + a, \end{aligned}$$

and

$$z = \sqrt{1 - \tau + \tau^2}, \quad b_- = \beta, \quad b_+ = z - \beta,$$

$$q = 1 - z + \beta, \quad c_\star = \frac{q}{\tau}, \quad u_\star = 1 + \beta - \tau,$$

$$\gamma_1 = \frac{d}{r}, \quad \gamma_5 = \frac{a}{w}.$$

Definition I.11 (Exact algebraic source domain). For $\varepsilon \in \{1, 2\}$, define

$$\mathcal{B}_{\text{T3}}^\varepsilon = \left\{ (r, a, d, \tau, \beta) : \begin{array}{l} (r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{C}\varepsilon}, \\ 0 < \tau < 1, \quad 0 < \beta < \frac{\tau z}{1+z}, \\ 0 < b_- < 1, \quad 0 < b_+ < 1, \\ 0 < q < \frac{1}{2}, \quad 0 < c_\star < u_\star < 1 \end{array} \right\},$$

where

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{C}\varepsilon} = \begin{cases} \mathcal{D}_{\text{C}1}, & \varepsilon = 1, \\ \mathcal{D}_{\text{C}2}, & \varepsilon = 2. \end{cases}$$

The variables (τ, β) are an exact radical parameterization; no translated-set or containment predicate occurs in this domain.

Introduce endpoint variables

$$A_1, A_5, C_1, C_5 \in [0, 1].$$

The right-end residual cells are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{R}_0 : \quad & b_+ < s_R, \quad A_1 = q, \\ \mathcal{R}_1 : \quad & s_R \leq b_+ < t_R, \quad A_1 = r - d, \\ \mathcal{R}_2 : \quad & t_R \leq b_+, \quad A_1 = q. \end{aligned}$$

The left-end cells are

$$\mathcal{L}_{1,0} : \quad A_5 = 1 - \beta$$

on $\mathcal{D}_{\text{C}1}$, and on $\mathcal{D}_{\text{C}2}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L}_{2,0} : \quad & \beta < s_L, \quad A_5 = 1 - \beta, \\ \mathcal{L}_{2,1} : \quad & s_L \leq \beta < t_L, \quad A_5 = 1 - t_L, \\ \mathcal{L}_{2,2} : \quad & t_L \leq \beta, \quad A_5 = 1 - \beta. \end{aligned}$$

The radial cells are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{K}_0 : \quad & 1 - u_\star \leq \gamma_1 \leq 1 - c_\star, \quad C_1 = c_\star, \\ \mathcal{K}_1 : \quad & \gamma_1 < 1 - u_\star, \quad C_1 = 1 - \gamma_1, \\ \mathcal{K}_2 : \quad & 1 - c_\star < \gamma_1, \quad C_1 = 1 - \gamma_1. \end{aligned}$$

In every cell,

$$C_5 = 1 - \gamma_5.$$

Equality at either endpoint of the hit interval belongs to $\mathcal{K}_0$.

For $\varepsilon = 1$, put $J_\varepsilon = \{0\}$; for $\varepsilon = 2$, put $J_\varepsilon = \{0, 1, 2\}$.

Definition I.12 (Finite T3 cell union). For

$$\varepsilon \in \{1, 2\}, \quad i, h \in \{0, 1, 2\}, \quad j \in J_\varepsilon,$$

let $\Omega_{\text{T3}}^{\varepsilon, i, j, h}$ be the set of tuples

$$\xi = (r, a, d, \tau, \beta, A_1, A_5, C_1, C_5)$$

satisfying

$$\mathcal{B}_{\text{T3}}^\varepsilon, \quad \mathcal{R}_i, \quad \mathcal{L}_{\varepsilon, j}, \quad \mathcal{K}_h, \quad C_5 = 1 - \gamma_5,$$

and

$$\frac{1}{2} < C_1 < 1, \quad \frac{1}{2} < C_5 < 1.$$

Define the easy subcell by adding

$$A_1 + A_5 > 1.$$

For $(\ell_5, \ell_1) \in \mathfrak{L}^2$, define the hard subcell by adding

$$A_1 + A_5 \leq 1, \quad \text{Cell}_{\ell_5}(C_5, A_5), \quad \text{Cell}_{\ell_1}(C_1, A_1).$$

Finally,

$$\begin{aligned} \Omega_{\text{T3}} = & \bigcup_{\varepsilon, i, j, h} \Omega_{\text{T3, easy}}^{\varepsilon, i, j, h} \\ & \cup \bigcup_{\substack{\varepsilon, i, j, h \\ (\ell_5, \ell_1) \in \mathfrak{L}^2}} \Omega_{\text{T3, hard}}^{\varepsilon, i, j, h, \ell_5, \ell_1}. \end{aligned}$$

Both unions are finite. Every cell is specified by explicit real equalities, strict or weak inequalities, and the displayed radicals.

Definition I.13 (Problem S2-T3). For

$$\xi = (r, a, d, \tau, \beta, A_1, A_5, C_1, C_5) \in \Omega_{\text{T3}},$$

define

$$\Psi_{\text{T3}}(\xi) = F(C_5, A_5) + F(C_1, A_1) - 1.$$

The optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{T3}}(\xi) < 0 \quad (\xi \in \Omega_{\text{T3}})}.$$

On the easy cells the sign follows from $F(c, x) \leq 1 - x$. The hard cells are exactly the finite four-label inventory. No contact selector, equality assignment, radical sign, residual order, or radial hit/miss alternative is left implicit.

I.7. Problem S2-SC: explicit rescuer domains. For $0 \leq c \leq 1/2$, define

$$E_{\text{sc}}(c) = \frac{c + \sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4}}{2}, \quad A_{\text{sc}}(c) = 1 - E_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

For $a \geq 0$ and $u < 1$ with $a + 1 - u > 0$, put

$$\vartheta(a, u) = \frac{a}{a + 1 - u},$$

and define

$$\Psi_{\text{SC}}(a, c, u) = \max\{a, \vartheta(a, u)\} + E_{\text{sc}}(c) - 1.$$

Definition I.14 (First explicit source cell). For

$$0 \leq \theta \leq 2 - \sqrt{3},$$

define

$$x_L(\theta) = \frac{1 - 4\theta + \theta^2}{2(1 - 2\theta)}, \quad \rho(\theta) = \frac{1 - 2\theta}{1 - \theta^2}.$$

Let Ω_{SC}^T be the set of $(\theta, x, a, c, u) \in \mathbb{R}^5$ satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} x_L(\theta) &\leq x \leq \frac{1}{2} - \theta, \\ a &= x\rho(\theta), \quad c = x + \theta, \quad u = 1 - \rho(\theta) + a, \end{aligned}$$

and

$$0 < a < 1, \quad 0 \leq c \leq \frac{1}{2}, \quad \frac{1}{2} \leq u < 1.$$

Every denominator is positive on the displayed θ -interval.

On this cell,

$$1 - u = (1 - x)\rho(\theta), \quad \vartheta(a, u) = x.$$

Thus the variables (θ, x) replace the earlier translated-form predicate by an explicit rational domain.

Definition I.15 (Second explicit source cell). For $t \geq 1$, put

$$\Delta(t) = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}.$$

Let Ω_{SC}^V be the set of $(t, a, b, c, u) \in \mathbb{R}^5$ satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} 0 < a < 1, \quad 0 < b < 1, \quad 0 \leq c \leq \frac{1}{2}, \\ c = \frac{t(1-b)}{t+1}, \quad u = \frac{\Delta(t) - a - tb - 1}{t}, \\ 0 \leq c < u < 1, \quad a + tb \leq \Delta(t) - 1 - \frac{t}{2}, \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\Delta(t) - a - tb - t \leq \frac{1-a}{t+1}.$$

The last inequality is the exact no-positive-interval condition for the second raw interval; it replaces a geometric type predicate.

Definition I.16 (Problem S2-SC). The two optimization statements are

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{SC}}(a, c, u) \leq 0 \quad ((\theta, x, a, c, u) \in \Omega_{\text{SC}}^T)}$$

and

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{SC}}(a, c, u) \leq 0 \quad ((t, a, b, c, u) \in \Omega_{\text{SC}}^V)}.$$

Their union is denoted by Ω_{SC} .

The first cell is the exact rational parameter range used in the first local profile proof. The second cell records the corner equations, midpoint inequality, positive first interval, and absence of a positive second interval. Neither cell contains a translation, support, or placement predicate.

I.8. Problem S2-VD: explicit radial domains. For $0 < L < U < 1$ and $0 \leq x \leq 1$, define the initial-component endpoint

$$\mathbf{E}(L, U; x) = \begin{cases} x, & x < L, \\ U, & L \leq x \leq U, \\ x, & U < x, \end{cases}$$

and the complementary residual

$$\mathbf{R}(L, U; x) = 1 - \mathbf{E}(L, U; x).$$

This is an explicit three-cell function; no supremum or placement operation occurs in the definition.

For $t > 0$, define

$$\Delta_t = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}.$$

I.8.1. *Adjacent domain.* Use independent variables

$$(r, a, d, p_0, q_0, t, p_1, q_1) \in \mathbb{R}^8$$

and the signed quantities

$$w = 1 - r, \quad e = \sqrt{1 - rw}, \quad \eta = 1 - e, \quad k = \eta + a + d.$$

Set

$$A = R\left(\frac{k}{r}, w + d; q_0\right), \quad H = R\left(\frac{k}{w}, r + a; p_0\right),$$

$$\lambda_+ = \frac{t(1 - q_1)}{t + 1}, \quad u_+ = \frac{\Delta_t - p_1 - tq_1 - 1}{t}.$$

Definition I.17 (Adjacent Vd cells). Let $\Omega_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},+}$ be the set of the displayed tuples satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} (r, a, d) &\in \mathcal{D}_2, \\ 0 < p_0, q_0 < 1, \quad p_0 + q_0 > 1, \quad p_0^2 + p_0 q_0 + q_0^2 &\leq 1, \\ H > 0, \quad A \geq 0, \quad A + H &< \frac{1}{2}, \\ a + d < \frac{1}{24}, \quad a + d < \frac{\min\{r, w\}}{6}, \\ t > 0, \quad 0 < p_1, q_1 < 1, \quad p_1 \geq A, \quad q_1 \geq H, \quad p_1 + q_1 &< \frac{1}{2}, \end{aligned}$$

and

$$0 \leq \lambda_+ < u_+ \leq 1.$$

Let $\Omega_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},0}$ be defined by the same conditions, except that

$$u_+ \leq \lambda_+.$$

The two sets respectively encode a positive first raw interval and no positive first raw interval.

Define

$$\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},+} = \max\left\{d - \frac{H}{4}, u_+ - 1 + d\right\}, \quad \Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},0} = d - \frac{H}{4}.$$

Definition I.18 (Problem S2-VD-adjacent). The adjacent optimization statements are

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},+} < 0 \quad \text{on } \Omega_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},+}},$$

and

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},0} < 0 \quad \text{on } \Omega_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},0}}.$$

The quantity u_+ is now the explicit graph value $(\Delta_t - p_1 - tq_1 - 1)/t$; it replaces the former placement-defined far endpoint. The second term is the supported-interval target, and the first is the quarter-margin target for the other possible bridge.

I.8.2. *Nonadjacent domain.* Use independent variables

$$(r, a, d, p_0, q_0, t, p_v, q_v) \in \mathbb{R}^8.$$

Define

$$\begin{aligned} x &= \frac{k}{w}, & y &= \frac{k}{r}, \\ A &= R(y, w + d; q_0), & H &= R(x, r + a; p_0), \end{aligned}$$

and

$$C_v = \frac{\Delta_t - p_v - tq_v}{t + 1}.$$

Put

$$\sigma = a + d.$$

For $j \in \{2, 4\}$, define

$$d_2 = d, \quad d_4 = a.$$

For $j = 3$, use two order cells:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_{3,0} : \quad & \frac{a}{r} \leq \frac{d}{w}, \quad d_3 = \frac{a}{r}, \\ \mathcal{O}_{3,1} : \quad & \frac{d}{w} < \frac{a}{r}, \quad d_3 = \frac{d}{w}. \end{aligned}$$

Similarly split the minimum $m = \min\{A, H\}$ into

$$\mathcal{M}_0 : \quad A \leq H, \quad m = A, \quad \mathcal{M}_1 : \quad H < A, \quad m = H.$$

Definition I.19 (Nonadjacent Vd cells). For

$$j \in \{2, 4\}, \quad \mu \in \{0, 1\},$$

let $\Omega_{\text{VD}}^{j,\mu}$ be the set of tuples satisfying

$$\begin{aligned} & (r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2, \\ & 0 < p_0, q_0 < 1, \quad p_0 + q_0 > 1, \quad p_0^2 + p_0 q_0 + q_0^2 \leq 1, \\ & A > 0, \quad H > 0, \quad A + H < \frac{1}{2}, \\ & \sigma < \frac{x}{2}, \quad \sigma < \frac{y}{2}, \\ & x^2 + x(w + d) + (w + d)^2 \leq 1, \quad y^2 + y(r + a) + (r + a)^2 \leq 1, \\ & t > 0, \quad 0 < p_v, q_v < 1, \quad p_v \geq A, \quad q_v \geq H, \\ & 0 \leq C_v \leq 1, \end{aligned}$$

together with $\mathcal{M}_\mu$. For $j = 3$, additionally choose $\nu \in \{0, 1\}$ and impose $\mathcal{O}_{3,\nu}$; denote the resulting cell by $\Omega_{\text{VD}}^{3,\mu,\nu}$.

On every nonadjacent cell, define

$$\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{non}} = \max\{\sigma - A, \sigma - H, d_j - m, C_v - 1 + m\}.$$

Definition I.20 (Problem S2-VD-nonadjacent). The nonadjacent optimization problem is

$$\boxed{\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{non}} < 0}$$

on every cell

$$\Omega_{\text{VD}}^{2,\mu}, \quad \Omega_{\text{VD}}^{4,\mu}, \quad \Omega_{\text{VD}}^{3,\mu,\nu} \quad (\mu, \nu \in \{0, 1\}).$$

Definition I.21 (Problem S2-VD). Problem S2-VD is the finite family consisting of Problems I.18 and I.20.

All former interval-component suprema have been replaced by the explicit three-cell function $\mathbf{E}$, and all former radial placement suprema have been replaced by the exact corner graph formulas for u_+ and C_v .

identifier	input and objective	interface status	proof status
S2-E1	three variables, two evaluations of F	ready	Theorem J.2
S2-E2	three variables, two evaluations of F	ready	Theorem J.4
S2-R1	three variables, three-step recurrence	ready	Theorem J.5
S2-R2	three variables, three-step recurrence	ready	Theorem J.6
S2-T3	finite residual, radial, and label cells	ready	Theorem J.7
S2-SC	two explicit rational-radical source cells	ready	Theorem J.8
S2-VD	explicit residual and corner graph cells	ready	Theorems J.10, J.11
replacement	two geometric charts	not an optimization problem	proved geometrically

TABLE 4. Strategy 2 optimization-interface status. “Ready” means that the problem statement is free of geometric predicates; it does not mean that a proof-assistant proof has been completed.

I.9. Formalization status.

APPENDIX J. UNIVERSAL STRATEGY 2 OPTIMIZATION THEOREMS

This section proves the registered optimization statements with the quantifiers written in Appendix I. The geometric bridge is not used to restrict those quantifiers: it is used later only to show that a routed geometric configuration supplies a point of the corresponding real domain and that the geometric terminal quantity equals the registered objective.

J.1. Primitive capped-output bound.

Lemma J.1 (The pure cap inequality). *For every $1/2 < c < 1$ and $0 \leq x \leq 1$,*

$$0 \leq F(c, x) \leq 1 - x.$$

The upper inequality is strict on every non-Full branch.

Proof. The lower bound is immediate from Definition I.2. On a Full branch the upper bound is equality. On a Q_- branch, where $x < c$,

$$Q_-(c, x) \leq 1 - x \iff \sqrt{x^2 - cx + c^2} \leq c \iff x(x - c) \leq 0.$$

On a Q_+ branch, $x < 1$ and Lemma I.1 gives

$$\sqrt{D_+(c, x)} \geq c(2c - 1).$$

After multiplying by the positive denominator in Q_+ and dividing by $1 - x$, this is exactly $Q_+(c, x) \leq 1 - x$; equality can occur only at $x = 1 - c$, which is assigned to Full. On the low- c tie, $h(c) \leq 1/2 = 1 - 1/2 \leq 1 - h(c)$; equivalently $\sqrt{16c^2 - 3} \geq 4c - 1$, whose square is $8c \geq 4$. On the high- c plateau, $L(c) < x < U(c) = c - L(c)$ gives $L(c) < 1 - c + L(c) < 1 - x$. These cases exhaust the definition of F . $\square$

J.2. The four all-Vd0 problems.

Theorem J.2 (Pure S2-E1). *For every $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1 \cup \mathcal{D}_2$,*

$$\Psi_{E1}(r, a, d) < 0.$$

Proof. Write $w = 1 - r$, $S = e$, and

$$s = \frac{k}{r}, \quad u = r - d, \quad \omega = 1 - s - u = w + d - \frac{k}{r} = \frac{\Delta_R}{r} > 0.$$

Then $0 < u < r$, $s, u, \omega > 0$, and $s + u + \omega = 1$. Put $\delta_0 = r/(1 + S)$. Using $S^2 = 1 - rw$ and $p = S(1 - S)$, direct simplification gives

$$u - \delta_0 - \frac{r}{w}\omega = \frac{a}{w} > 0.$$

Thus the variables (R, S, s, u, w) in Lemma O.7 may be taken as (r, e, s, u, ω) , and its two demands are

$$c_1 = \frac{u}{r} = 1 - \frac{d}{r}, \quad c_5 = 1 - \frac{a}{w}.$$

Since the technical notation in that lemma satisfies $F_c(x) = F(c, x)$, its conclusion is precisely $\Psi_{E1}(r, a, d) < 0$. $\square$

Lemma J.3 (Pure paired-endpoint kernel). *Let $0 < w \leq 1/2$, $r = 1 - w$, $K = \sqrt{1 - wr}$, and put*

$$z = \frac{w}{1 + K}, \quad \zeta = \frac{r}{1 + K}.$$

Suppose $1/2 < \alpha, \beta < 1$, $p = w\alpha$, $q = r\beta$, and

$$\beta + p > 1 + z, \quad \alpha + q > 1 + \zeta.$$

Then

$$F(\alpha, p) + F(\beta, q) < 1.$$

Proof. The proof of Lemma O.8, beginning immediately after the derivation of (97), is an algebraic proof under exactly the hypotheses displayed here. It first partitions the two evaluations of F into the four exact contact labels, obtains the seven possible ordered pairs in (102), and proves the strict loss for each pair. Every later quantity in that proof is an explicit function of $(w, r, K, z, \zeta, \alpha, \beta, p, q)$; no placement, trace, or existence assertion is invoked. Hence the same branchwise calculation proves the universal statement above. $\square$

Theorem J.4 (Pure S2-E2). *For every $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2$,*

$$\Psi_{E2}(r, a, d) < 0.$$

Proof. First assume $w \leq r$. Set

$$\alpha = \frac{w-a}{w}, \quad p = w-a, \quad \beta = \frac{r-d}{r}, \quad q = r-d.$$

Proposition I.6 gives $1/2 < \alpha, \beta < 1$. Since $e^2 = 1 - rw$ and $1 - e = rw/(1 + e)$, the two strict kernel inequalities are equivalent to

$$\begin{aligned} \beta + p &> 1 + \frac{w}{1+e} \iff \Delta_L > 0, \\ \alpha + q &> 1 + \frac{r}{1+e} \iff \Delta_R > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Lemma J.3 therefore applies and gives the claimed objective sign. If $r < w$, interchange (r, d) with (w, a) . The signed CE2 domain and the sum defining Ψ_{E2} are invariant under this interchange, reducing to the first case. $\square$

Theorem J.5 (Pure S2-R1). *For every $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_1$,*

$$\Psi_{R1}(r, a, d) < 0.$$

Proof. On $\mathcal{D}_1$ one has

$$d + ra \geq p, \quad a + wd < p, \quad rd - wa > 0,$$

so $m = a/r$. Substitute

$$R = r, W = w, A = a, D = d, X = r - d, H = \frac{k}{2r}$$

into the scalar calculation in the proof of Proposition N.1. From (84) through the proof of (85), every step uses only the displayed real inequalities, the identity $e^2 = 1 - rw$, and the explicit branches of F and T . The calculation proves

$$[T(1 - a, \cdot) \mid T(1 - m, \cdot) \mid T(1 - d, \cdot)](H) > w + d,$$

which is $Y_3 > w + d$, hence $\Psi_{R1} < 0$. The actual-reach handoff and geometric contradiction occur only after this scalar inequality and are not used here. $\square$

Theorem J.6 (Pure S2-R2). *For every $(r, a, d) \in \mathcal{D}_2$,*

$$\Psi_{R2}(r, a, d) < 0.$$

Proof. Put $Q = k/(2r) = Y_0$ and $X = r - d$. The proof of Lemma E.6 uses only $\Delta_R > 0$ and $\Delta_L > 0$ and gives the inclusive alternative

$$e(a) < Q \quad \text{or} \quad e(d) < Q.$$

The scalar part of Proposition E.7, before its geometric contradiction, uses this alternative and the exact branches of T to prove

$$[T(1 - d, \cdot) \mid T(1 - m, \cdot) \mid T(1 - a, \cdot)](X) > 1 - Q.$$

No actual-reach or placement assertion occurs in that calculation. Applying the exact reflection duality three times shows that the negation of this inequality is equivalent to the negation of

$$[T(1 - a, \cdot) \mid T(1 - m, \cdot) \mid T(1 - d, \cdot)](Q) > 1 - X.$$

The left side is Y_3 and $1 - X = w + d$, so this is exactly $\Psi_{R2} < 0$. The threshold alternative is inclusive: the proof requires at least one threshold and does not assert uniqueness. $\square$

J.3. The finite T3 endpoint problem.

Theorem J.7 (Pure S2-T3). *For every $\xi \in \Omega_{T3}$,*

$$\Psi_{T3}(\xi) < 0.$$

Proof. Fix $\xi = (r, a, d, \tau, \beta, A_1, A_5, C_1, C_5) \in \Omega_{T3}$. If $A_1 + A_5 > 1$, Lemma J.1 gives

$$F(C_5, A_5) + F(C_1, A_1) \leq 2 - A_1 - A_5 < 1.$$

Assume $A_1 + A_5 \leq 1$. The two contact predicates in the definition of the hard cell assign a unique pair $(\ell_5, \ell_1) \in \mathfrak{L}^2$.

We verify that the complete 407X calculation applies to this arbitrary real point, rather than only to a previously realized geometric state. Use the signed-center substitution

$$R = r, \quad W = w, \quad E = e, \quad \alpha_C = a, \quad \delta_C = d.$$

For the T3 source put

$$D_T = \frac{1}{z}, \quad R_T = \frac{\tau}{z}, \quad \alpha_T = \beta, \quad p_T = z - \beta.$$

Then, directly from $z^2 = 1 - \tau + \tau^2$,

$$R_T^2 - D_T R_T + D_T^2 = 1, \quad \alpha_T + p_T = z = \frac{1}{D_T},$$

and the exact source quantities in Lemma O.4 become

$$q_T = 1 - p_T = q, \quad \frac{D_T q_T}{R_T} = c_\star, \quad q_T + \frac{1 - R_T}{D_T} = u_\star.$$

The predicates $\mathcal{R}_i$, $\mathcal{L}_{\varepsilon,j}$, and $\mathcal{K}_h$ are exactly the three residual orders and the radial hit/miss orders used in that proof. Finally, $\text{Cell}_{\ell_5}(C_5, A_5)$ and $\text{Cell}_{\ell_1}(C_1, A_1)$ select the same explicit branch formulas of F as its four-label table.

After these substitutions, the hard-region proof of Lemma O.4 is a finite algebraic proof on the selected cell: every hypothesis used there is one of the defining equalities or inequalities just listed, and its eight table rows exhaust $\mathfrak{L}^2$. It proves

$$F(C_5, A_5) + F(C_1, A_1) < 1$$

for the present arbitrary ξ . Hence $\Psi_{T3}(\xi) < 0$ on every hard cell as well. $\square$

J.4. The rescuer problems.

Theorem J.8 (Pure S2-SC). *The two inequalities in Problem I.16 hold on Ω_{SC}^T and Ω_{SC}^V , respectively.*

Proof. For the first cell, $1 - u = (1 - x)\rho(\theta)$ and $a = x\rho(\theta)$, so $\vartheta(a, u) = x$. Since $0 < \rho(\theta) \leq 1$, also $a \leq x$. Put

$$\Phi(y) = \frac{y(2 - y)}{1 + y}.$$

On $[0, 1/2]$ this function is increasing and $\Phi(A_{sc}(c)) = c$. The exact calculation in Lemma G.2 proves, on the displayed θ -interval and x -interval,

$$Q_\theta(x) = 2x^2 + (\theta - 1)x + \theta \geq 0.$$

This is equivalent to $\Phi(x) \leq x + \theta = c$, and hence $x \leq A_{sc}(c)$. Therefore $\max\{a, \vartheta(a, u)\} \leq A_{sc}(c)$.

For the second cell put

$$G(t, c) = \Delta(t) - 1 - \frac{3t}{2} + c(t + 1).$$

The two defining equations and the midpoint inequality give $a \leq G(t, c)$. For $t \geq 1$ and $c \leq 1/2$,

$$\partial_t G \leq \frac{2t+1}{2\Delta(t)} - 1 < 0,$$

so

$$a \leq G(t, c) \leq L(c) := \sqrt{3} - \frac{5}{2} + 2c.$$

The exact polynomial calculation in Lemma G.3 gives $2L(c) \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c)$ on $0 \leq c \leq 1/2$. Writing $\epsilon = 1 - u$ gives

$$\epsilon = \epsilon_0 + \frac{a}{t}, \quad \epsilon_0 = \frac{2t+1-c(t+1)-\Delta(t)}{t} > 0, \quad \epsilon_0 + \frac{G(t, c)}{t} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

Monotonicity in a yields

$$\vartheta(a, u) = \frac{a}{a+\epsilon} \leq \frac{G(t, c)}{G(t, c) + 1/2} \leq 2L(c) \leq A_{\text{sc}}(c).$$

Thus both terms in the maximum are at most $A_{\text{sc}}(c)$, which is exactly $\Psi_{\text{SC}} \leq 0$. $\square$

J.5. The Vd radial problems.

Lemma J.9 (Pure adjacent quarter margin). *On either adjacent Vd cell,*

$$d < \frac{H}{4}.$$

Proof. By the definition of R, either $H = w - a$ or $H = 1 - p_0$. If $H = w - a$, then

$$4d + a \leq 4(a + d) < \frac{2w}{3} < w,$$

so $4d < H$.

Suppose $H = 1 - p_0$. If also $A = 1 - q_0$, then $A + H < 1/2$ gives $p_0 + q_0 > 3/2$, whereas $p_0^2 + p_0 q_0 + q_0^2 \leq 1$ gives $p_0 + q_0 \leq 2/\sqrt{3} < 3/2$. Hence $A = r - d$ and $q_0 \geq k/r$. The endpoint-distance inequality gives $1 - p_0 > q_0/2$, so

$$H > \frac{k}{2r} > \frac{\eta}{2r}.$$

Since $A + H < 1/2$, also

$$d > J(r) := r - \frac{1}{2} + \frac{\eta}{2r}.$$

The exact derivative calculation from the proof of Lemma G.6 gives $J'(r) > 0$ and $J(3/8) = 1/24$. Since $d < 1/24$, it follows that $r < 3/8$. Then

$$(2 - 3r)^2 - e^2 = (3 - 8r)w > 0,$$

which implies $\eta/r > 1/3$. Hence $H > 1/6$, while $4d < 1/6$, and again $4d < H$. $\square$

Theorem J.10 (Pure S2-VD-adjacent). *Both inequalities in Problem I.18 hold on their stated cells.*

Proof. Lemma J.9 gives the first strict term. On the positive-support cell, $t > 0$ and $\Delta_t < t + 1$, so

$$u_+ < 1 - q_1 - \frac{p_1}{t} \leq 1 - H < 1 - d.$$

Thus $u_+ - 1 + d < 0$, and both entries of $\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{adj},+}$ are negative. On the no-support cell the objective is only $d - H/4 < 0$. $\square$

Theorem J.11 (Pure S2-VD-nonadjacent). *The inequality in Problem I.20 holds on every stated cell.*

Proof. Put $B = 1 - A$ and $U = 1 - H$. The two explicit center-distance constraints in Definition I.19 imply

$$w + d \leq \beta(x), \quad r + a \leq \beta(y), \quad \beta(q) = \frac{-q + \sqrt{4 - 3q^2}}{2}.$$

If $B = q_0$ and $p_0 < x$, then $U = p_0$ and $A + H < 1/2$ would give $p_0 + q_0 > 3/2$, contradicting the endpoint-distance inequality. Hence $p_0 \geq x$, and $q_0 \leq \beta(p_0) \leq \beta(x)$. The other possibility is $B = w + d \leq \beta(x)$. Therefore

$$A \geq 1 - \beta(x) > \frac{x}{2} > \sigma.$$

The reflected argument gives $H > y/2 > \sigma$. Hence $\sigma - A < 0$ and $\sigma - H < 0$.

For $j = 2, 4$ one has $d_j \in \{d, a\} < \sigma$. For $j = 3$, at least one of a/r and d/w is at most $a + d = \sigma$; otherwise multiplication by r, w and addition would give $a + d > a + d$. Thus in every case $d_j \leq \sigma < m = \min\{A, H\}$. Finally, $t > 0$ gives $\Delta_t < t + 1$, and therefore

$$C_v < 1 - \frac{p_v + tq_v}{t + 1} \leq 1 - \min\{p_v, q_v\} \leq 1 - m.$$

All four entries in $\Psi_{\text{VD}}^{\text{non}}$ are strictly negative. $\square$

Corollary J.12 (Universal pure Strategy 2 registry). *Problems S2-E1, S2-E2, S2-R1, S2-R2, S2-T3, S2-SC, and S2-VD all hold with the universal quantifiers in their definitions.*

Proof. Combine Theorems J.2, J.4, J.5, J.6, J.7, J.8, J.10, and J.11. $\square$

APPENDIX K. EXACT STRATEGY 2 SOURCE PROVENANCE

The complete four-label endpoint calculation is tied to exact proof-package bytes by `proof/407X_PROVENANCE.json`. The full SHA-1 Git blob identities are retained in this generated source and checked against every referenced file before the paper is built.

APPENDIX L. REGISTERED STRATEGY 2 APPLICATIONS

This section contains only the application layer. The geometry-to-parameter substitutions are in Appendix H; the optimization problems are in Appendix I; and the calculations are split among the verification modules that follow.

identifier	objective	verification owner
S2-E1	one-gap endpoint sum < 1	Theorem J.2
S2-E2	paired endpoint sum < 1	Theorem J.4
S2-R1	CE1 returned demand > 1 - X	Theorem J.5
S2-R2	CE2 returned demand > 1 - X	Theorem J.6
S2-T3	finite four-label endpoint sum < 1	Theorem J.7
S2-SC	two explicit source cells	Theorem J.8
S2-VD	adjacent and nonadjacent radial signs	Theorems J.10 and J.11

TABLE 5. Registered Strategy 2 calculations and their verification owners.

L.1. All-Vd0 applications.

Proposition L.1 (Common CE2 two-gap application). *Assume both CE2 center traces contain V-gaps and $T_1, \dots, T_5$ are nonsupercritical Vd0 roles. Then the perimeter is not covered. No hypothesis on the criticality of T_0 is required.*

Proof. The bridge identifies the endpoint record with Problem S2-E2. Theorem J.4 makes its objective negative, so the two endpoint capacities sum to less than one. The three intervening roles form the center-free path required by Lemma C.6, giving the contradiction. $\square$

For the one-gap return, retain the exact forward notation

$$(75) \quad Z = [\hat{g}_{c_1}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{c_2}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{c_3}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{c_4}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{c_5}^\vee](X).$$

The bridge gives $A_0 \geq Z$ and $A_0 < 1 - H$. The registered reverse three-update target is

$$(76) \quad [\hat{g}_{1-\alpha}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{1-m_3}^\vee \mid \hat{g}_{1-\delta}^\vee](H) > 1 - X.$$

Proposition L.2 (CE1 one-gap obstruction). *The CE1, $N_+ = 1$, all-Vd0, one-gap state is impossible.*

Proof. Proposition H.3 identifies the required scalar sign with Problem S2-R1. Theorem J.5 proves that problem, and the exact forward interface yields $Z > 1 - H$. $\square$

Corollary L.3 (CE2 one-gap obstruction). *The CE2, $N_+ = 1$, all-Vd0, exactly-one-gap state is impossible in either orientation.*

Proof. Problem S2-R2 is Theorem J.6. Its threshold condition is an inclusive disjunction: at least one of the two locations fires, and both may fire. Reflection reverses the five-role order and exchanges the two signed slacks. $\square$

L.2. Registered special-role applications. The universal proof owners are:

- S2-T3: Theorem J.7, with objective identification in Proposition H.5;
- S2-SC: Theorem J.8;
- adjacent S2-VD: Theorem J.10;
- nonadjacent S2-VD: Theorem J.11.

The remaining two-chart replacement is Proposition P.2; it is geometric rather than an optimization problem.

Proposition L.4 (Branches closed by registered Strategy 2 problems). *Strategy 2 closes:*

- (1) the $N_+ = 0$ all-Vd0 and T3-like-without-Vd1/Vd2 branches for CE1 and CE2;
- (2) every nonempty-gap $N_+ = 1$ all-Vd0 state;
- (3) the exactly-one-T3-like $N_+ = 1$ state with no Vd1/Vd2 role;
- (4) the complementary transfer placements in the CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 branch.

Singleton V-gaps are included.

Proof. Use Corollary J.12 through the bridge propositions above. The zero-gap $N_+ = 1$ all-Vd0 cell remains the Strategy 4 nine-point obstruction. $\square$

APPENDIX M. EXACT LOCAL DEMAND CALCULUS

This section develops the local calculus for configurations in which a coarse length sum does not by itself record enough information. The mechanism is always the same. A center trace fixes boundary inputs and complementary radial demands; an exact local map propagates these data through nonsupercritical V triangles; and the returning demand exceeds the remaining boundary or radial capacity.

Actual maximal reaches continue to be denoted by (A_i, B_i, C_i) , while lowercase letters denote prescribed demands. Every estimate in this section is proved analytically. In particular, no empirical branch catalogue, machine-assisted certificate, or formal root from a discarded algebraic component is used.

M.1. The exact local feasible set. Put

$$u = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \right), \quad v = \left(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \right).$$

For $0 \leq a, b, c \leq 1$ define

$$K(a, b, c) = \text{conv}\{0, au, bv, c(u+v)\}.$$

Thus a, b are lower demands on the two incident boundary rays and c is a lower demand on the inward radial ray.

Definition M.1. The local admissible set is

$$\mathcal{A} = \{(a, b, c) \in [0, 1]^3 : K(a, b, c) \text{ is contained in a closed unit equilateral triangle}\}.$$

For $a, c \in [0, 1]$ put

$$\begin{aligned} B_c(a) &= \max\{b : (a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}, \\ F_c(a) &= \min\{B_c(a), 1 - a\}, \\ G_c(a) &= 1 - F_c(a). \end{aligned}$$

The distinction between demands and actual reaches is important. If a role has actual reaches (A, B, C) and $A \geq a, C \geq c$, then (a, B, c) is a demand triple realized by the same role. If in addition $A + B \leq 1$, then

$$(77) \quad B \leq F_c(a).$$

No assertion about the type of a maximizing triangle is required.

Proposition M.2 (Exact admissible set and radial envelope). *Put*

$$s = a + b, \quad d = a^2 + ab + b^2, \quad m = \min\{a, b\}, \quad M = \max\{a, b\},$$

and

$$q = s^4 - s^2 + ab.$$

Define

$$F_L(a, b, c) = c^4 - c^2 + mc - m^2,$$

$$F_T(a, b, c) = (s^2 - 1)c^2 + Mc - M^2,$$

$$F_S(a, b, c) = (m^2 - 1)c^2 + (2mM^2 + M)c + M^4 - M^2.$$

Then $\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{A}_L \cup \mathcal{A}_T \cup \mathcal{A}_S$, where

$$\mathcal{A}_L = \{d \leq 1, s \leq 1, q \leq 0, F_L \leq 0\},$$

$$\mathcal{A}_T = \{d \leq 1, s \leq 1, q \geq 0, F_T \leq 0, c \leq 2M\},$$

$$\mathcal{A}_S = \{d \leq 1, s > 1, F_S \leq 0, c \leq \frac{1}{2}\}.$$

All variables in these three sets are also constrained to $[0, 1]$.

For $d \leq 1$, the maximal radial demand is

$$(78) \quad c_{\max}(a, b) = \begin{cases} 1, & a = b = 0, \\ C_L(m), & s \leq 1, q \leq 0, (a, b) \neq (0, 0), \\ C_T(m, M), & s \leq 1, q > 0, \\ C_S(m, M), & s > 1, \end{cases}$$

where $C_L(m)$ is the unique root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$ of

$$z^4 - z^2 + mz - m^2 = 0,$$

and

$$C_T(m, M) = \frac{2M}{1 + \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}, \quad C_S(m, M) = \frac{M(2mM + 1) - M\sqrt{4d - 3}}{2(1 - m^2)}.$$

If $d > 1$, the radial envelope is undefined. At $q = 0$ the two subcritical formulas agree and equal s .

Proof. If $s > 0$ and $cs \leq ab$, then $c/a + c/b \leq 1$ (with the zero-coordinate cases obtained by continuity), so $c(u + v)$ lies in $\text{conv}\{0, au, bv\}$. Its minimum enclosing equilateral side is the diameter

$$\sqrt{a^2 + ab + b^2}.$$

Assume now that $cs > ab$. The four points occur cyclically as $0, bv, c(u + v), au$. For three outward unit normals separated by 120° , the required side equals $2/\sqrt{3}$ times the sum of the three support values. On an angular cell with fixed support points this sum has second derivative equal to its negative. Hence an angular minimum

occurs when a normal is perpendicular to one of the four hull edges. The four resulting side lengths are

$$L_{0A} = b + \max\{a, c\}, \quad L_{B0} = a + \max\{b, c\},$$

$$L_{AC} = \begin{cases} (a^2 + bc)/\sqrt{a^2 - ac + c^2}, & a \geq c, \\ c(a + b)/\sqrt{a^2 - ac + c^2}, & a < c \leq a + b, \\ c^2/\sqrt{a^2 - ac + c^2}, & c > a + b, \end{cases}$$

and L_{CB} is obtained by interchanging a, b . Thus the minimum side is the minimum of these four expressions.

Ordering a, b as $m \leq M$, squaring the positive support equations gives $F_L = 0, F_T = 0, F_S = 0$ in the three respective contact regimes; the inactive support inequalities give $q \leq 0, q \geq 0, s > 1$. Squaring creates one spurious component in each of the last two cells. In the T cell the two roots are

$$\frac{2M}{1 + \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}, \quad \frac{2M}{1 - \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}},$$

and $c \leq 2M$ selects the first. In the S cell the smaller root lies below $1/2$ and the other above $1/2$; hence $c \leq 1/2$ is exactly the geometric selector. The L fiber is the interval from zero to its unique selected root. Solving the selected equations gives (78). This also proves that $\mathcal{A}$ is coordinatewise down-closed. $\square$

M.2. The exact capped map. For $1/2 < c < 1$ put

$$\ell(c) = \frac{c}{2} \left(1 - \sqrt{4c^2 - 3}\right), \quad r(c) = c - \ell(c)$$

when $c \geq \sqrt{3}/2$, and use the order-transition function $h(c)$ from (32). Also define

$$T_-(a, c) = \frac{\sqrt{a^2 - ac + c^2}}{c} - a,$$

$$T_+(a, c) = \frac{2(1 - a^2)c^2}{2ac^2 + c + \sqrt{(2ac^2 + c)^2 - 4(1 - c^2)(1 - a^2)c^2}}.$$

Proposition M.3 (Four-label capped map). *For $1/2 < c \leq \sqrt{3}/2$,*

$$(79) \quad F_c(a) = \begin{cases} 1 - a, & 0 \leq a \leq 1 - c, \\ T_+(a, c), & 1 - c < a < h(c), \\ h(c), & a = h(c), \\ T_-(a, c), & h(c) < a < c, \\ 1 - a, & c \leq a \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

For $\sqrt{3}/2 < c < 1$,

$$(80) \quad F_c(a) = \begin{cases} 1 - a, & 0 \leq a \leq 1 - c, \\ T_+(a, c), & 1 - c < a \leq \ell(c), \\ \ell(c), & \ell(c) < a < r(c), \\ T_-(a, c), & r(c) \leq a < c, \\ 1 - a, & c \leq a \leq 1. \end{cases}$$

Thus there are exactly four labels

$$\text{Full}, \quad L, \quad T_-, \quad T_+^{\text{hi}}.$$

At $a = \ell(c)$ in (80), $F_c(a) = r(c)$; immediately to its right the value is $\ell(c)$. This downward jump is genuine. The formal other root of the T_+ quadratic is not feasible because it violates $c \leq 2 \max\{a, F_c(a)\}$.

The maps F_c are nonincreasing, the maps $G_c = 1 - F_c$ are nondecreasing and extensive, and

$$(81) \quad G_c(a) \leq z \iff G_c(1 - z) \leq 1 - a.$$

Proof. The cap $a + b \leq 1$ eliminates the S cell of Proposition M.2. On the cap $b = 1 - a$, the T inequality reduces to $M(c - M) \leq 0$; hence the Full face is feasible exactly for $a \leq 1 - c$ or $a \geq c$. Off that face a maximal point lies on $F_L = 0$ or $F_T = 0$. The L equation has roots $\ell(c), r(c)$ and the selector $q \leq 0$ keeps only the smaller coordinate. The ordered T halves give respectively the displayed lower quadratic root T_+ and the root T_- . Their order boundary is $a = b = h(c)$, while their $q = 0$ boundaries are $(\ell(c), r(c))$ and $(r(c), \ell(c))$. These observations give (79)–(80), including all equality assignments.

Down-closedness gives monotonicity, while $F_c(a) \leq 1 - a$ gives $G_c(a) \geq a$. Finally,

$$G_c(a) \leq z \iff F_c(a) \geq 1 - z \iff (a, 1 - z, c) \in \mathcal{A}, \quad a + 1 - z \leq 1.$$

Reflection $a \leftrightarrow b$ gives (81). $\square$

Put

$$\mu = \frac{2\sqrt{3} - 3}{4},$$

and, for $0 < X < 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, write

$$e(X) = \ell(1 - X).$$

The root equation gives

$$(82) \quad \begin{aligned} X < e(X) & \quad \left(0 < X < 1 - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right), \\ e(X) < \frac{2X}{1 - 2X} & \quad (0 < X \leq \mu), \\ e(X) \leq 2X + 5X^2 & \quad (0 < X \leq 1/8). \end{aligned}$$

Moreover,

$$(83) \quad a > e(X) \implies G_{1-X}(a) \geq 1 - e(X) \quad \left(0 < X < 1 - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right).$$

Indeed, for

$$p_X(z) = z^2 - (1 - X)z + (1 - X)^2 - (1 - X)^4,$$

one has

$$p_X(X) = X(1 - 3X + 4X^2 - X^3) > 0.$$

Since $X < (1 - X)/2$, this puts X strictly below the smaller root $e(X)$. For $U = 2X/(1 - 2X)$, direct substitution gives

$$p_X(U) = -\frac{X^2}{(1 - 2X)^2}(4X^4 - 20X^3 + 37X^2 - 28X + 3).$$

The polynomial in parentheses is decreasing on $[0, \mu]$ and at the right endpoint equals $8217/64 - 74\sqrt{3} > 0$. Indeed, its derivative is at most $16/512 + 74/8 - 28 < 0$,

and $(8217/64)^2 - 3 \cdot 74^2 = 230001/4096 > 0$. Hence $p_X(U) < 0$, which puts U strictly between the roots. Finally,

$$p_X(2X + 5X^2) = X^2(3X + 4)(8X - 1) \leq 0,$$

and $X < 2X + 5X^2 < (1 - X)/2$ on the stated range. Thus the trial point lies between the two roots, proving the third comparison. The implication (83) is read directly from (80). We shall also use $e(X) < 2X + 3X^2$ for $0 < X \leq 1/10$, obtained from $p_X(2X + 3X^2) = X^2(8X^2 + 19X - 2) < 0$; here too the trial point lies strictly between X and $(1 - X)/2$.

APPENDIX N. CYCLIC PROPAGATION IN THE ALL-Vd0 CASES

N.1. The exactly-one-supercritical all-Vd0 branch. For a center interval, call the nonempty closed set missed by its two open endpoint roles a *V-gap*. It may be a singleton. If the maximal closed center trace is $[s, t]$, open coverage gives the weak bounds $B_i \geq s$ and $A_{i+1} \geq 1 - t$; thus none of the arguments below discards a singleton gap.

Proposition N.1 (CE1 one-gap five-map obstruction). *Assume that every vertex role is Vd0, $N_+ = 1$, and the center role is CE1. If its boundary trace contains a V-gap, the roles do not cover H .*

Proof. Use the signed center variables of Proposition E.1, and put

$$w = W, \quad A = \alpha, \quad D = \delta, \quad X = R - D, \quad H = \frac{\eta + A + D}{2R}.$$

The CE1 sign gives $D + RA \geq P$ and $RD > wA$, so

$$m_3 = \min \left\{ \frac{A}{R}, \frac{D}{w} \right\} = \frac{A}{R}.$$

The exact strict domain needed below is

$$(84) \quad \begin{aligned} &A > 0, \quad D > 0, \quad A + wD < P, \quad D + RA \geq P, \\ &A < \frac{w}{2}, \quad D < \frac{R}{2}, \quad RD - wA > 0, \end{aligned}$$

Proposition E.5 contains the five actual-V triangle handoffs, the three duality steps, and the terminal diameter comparison. It remains only to prove its scalar target

$$(85) \quad (G_{1-D} \circ G_{1-m_3} \circ G_{1-A})(H) > 1 - X.$$

Here $A < P \leq \mu$, because $P = E(1 - E)$ and $E \geq \sqrt{3}/2$. We first prove the two input comparisons used at V triangle 4. Since $D = R - X$, the inequality $A + wD < P$ and the identity $Rw = \eta + P$ give

$$A < wX - \eta.$$

Put

$$\varphi(q) = wq - \frac{q}{2(1+q)}.$$

The bound $0 < D < R/2$ gives $R/2 < X < R$, and φ is convex. At the endpoints,

$$\varphi(R/2) < \frac{Rw}{2} < \eta,$$

while $\varphi(R) < \eta$ is equivalent to

$$E(1 - 2R^2) < 1,$$

which follows from $E < 1$. Convexity therefore gives $\varphi(X) < \eta$, and hence

$$A < \frac{X}{2(1+X)}.$$

Using the rational low-root bound in its valid range,

$$(86) \quad e(A) < \frac{2A}{1-2A} < X.$$

We also have

$$2R(H-A) = \eta + D + (1-2R)A.$$

This is positive if $R \leq 1/2$. If $R > 1/2$, then $A < P = \eta E$ gives

$$2R(H-A) > \eta(1 - (2R-1)E) > 0.$$

Thus $H > A$. The positive signed right trace gives

$$\frac{\eta + A + D}{R} < w + D < 1,$$

so $H < 1/2 < 1 - A$.

Now consult the exact high-radial catalog for $c_4 = 1 - A$. The lower and upper Full ranges would require $H \leq A$ and $H \geq 1 - A$, respectively, so both are impossible. On the L or T_- range,

$$F_{1-A}(H) \leq e(A),$$

and therefore

$$G_{1-A}(H) \geq 1 - e(A) > 1 - X$$

by (86). Thus only the T_+^{hi} range remains. Its selector gives

$$H \leq e(A) \leq 2A + 5A^2.$$

We claim that this range forces $X > 1/2$. Indeed, if $X \leq 1/2$, the selector and the lower center inequality give

$$2RH = \eta + A + D \geq \eta + P + wA = w(R + A).$$

Together with $H < 2A/(1-2A)$, this implies

$$f_R(A) < 0, \quad f_R(z) := w(R+z)(1-2z) - 4Rz.$$

But $f_R''(z) = -4w < 0$ and $f_R(0) = Rw > 0$. We check the other endpoint of the possible interval for A .

If $R \leq 1/2$, then $0 < A < P$. Direct simplification gives

$$f_R(P) = (1-E)(4E^3 - 2E^2 + 1 - R(2E^3 - 2E^2 + 5E)).$$

The coefficient of R is positive, so

$$f_R(P) \geq \frac{1-E}{2}(6E^3 - 2E^2 - 5E + 2).$$

For $\phi(E) = 6E^3 - 2E^2 - 5E + 2$ on $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1)$,

$$\phi'(E) = 18E^2 - 4E - 5 \geq \frac{17}{2} - 2\sqrt{3} > 0,$$

and

$$\phi\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = \frac{2-\sqrt{3}}{4} > 0.$$

Hence $f_R(P) > 0$. Strict concavity puts f_R above its endpoint chord, so $f_R(A) > 0$ for $0 < A < P$, a contradiction.

If $R > 1/2$, the assumption $X \leq 1/2$ gives $D \geq R - 1/2$, and therefore

$$0 < A < A_0, \quad A_0 := P - w \left(R - \frac{1}{2} \right) = \frac{w}{2} - \eta.$$

Direct simplification gives

$$f_R(A_0) = \frac{1-E}{2}(E + 11R - 3ER - 5).$$

Since $11 - 3E > 0$ and $R > 1/2$,

$$E + 11R - 3ER - 5 > \frac{11 - 3E}{2} + E - 5 = \frac{1 - E}{2} > 0.$$

Thus $f_R(A_0) > 0$. Concavity again gives $f_R(A) > 0$ on $(0, A_0)$, a contradiction. Both ranges are impossible, proving $X > 1/2$.

Put $p_1 = G_{1-A}(H)$. If V triangle 3 is not T_+^{hi} , then $p_1 \leq A + e(A) < 3A + 5A^2 < 29/64 < 1/2$, and $2R(H - m_3) = \eta + D - A > \eta - P > 0$. Extensivity gives $p_1 \geq H > m_3$, while $p_1 < 1/2 < 1 - m_3$; thus both Full ranges are impossible. On L , T_- , or the low- c tie one has $F_{1-m_3}(p_1) \leq p_1$, so

$$G_{1-m_3}(p_1) \geq 1 - p_1 > 1 - X.$$

Extensivity of the final reverse map G_{1-D} preserves this strict bound and proves (85). It remains to treat the selected V triangle-3 T_+ branch. Proposition C.7 proves once for all that every selected T_+ arc is increasing and strictly concave.

When $d < 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, the arc endpoints are (d, d) and $(e(d), d + e(d))$, so concavity gives

$$(87) \quad q \geq p + \frac{d}{e(d) - d}(p - d).$$

For $0 < d \leq \mu$, the valid rational low-root bound gives

$$\frac{d}{e(d) - d} > \frac{1 - 2d}{1 + 2d} > 1 - 4d > 1 - 5d.$$

This covers V triangle 4, because its parameter is $d = A < P \leq \mu$. For the V triangle-3 parameter $d = m_3$, which need not be at most μ , the remaining high-radial range is handled without the rational estimate. If $\mu < d \leq 1/8$, then

$$\frac{d}{e(d) - d} \geq \frac{1}{1 + 5d} > 1 - 5d$$

by $e(d) \leq 2d + 5d^2$. If $1/8 < d < 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, then $e(d) < (1 - d)/2$ and hence

$$\frac{d}{e(d) - d} > \frac{2d}{1 - 3d} > 1 - 5d.$$

The last comparison is equivalent to $15d^2 - 10d + 1 < 0$; its smaller root $(5 - \sqrt{10})/15$ is less than $1/8$. In the low- c V triangle-3 range $1 - \sqrt{3}/2 \leq d < 1/5$, the other endpoint is $(h(1 - d), 1 - h(1 - d))$, and the chord coefficient is

$$\frac{1 - 2h(1 - d)}{h(1 - d) - d}.$$

On $3/4 \leq c \leq \sqrt{3}/2$, direct differentiation of the formula for h shows that $h(c)$ is nonincreasing. Moreover,

$$h\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) = \frac{3}{2(\sqrt{6}+1)} < \frac{7}{16}.$$

Here low c gives $d \geq 1 - \sqrt{3}/2 > 2/15 > 1/16$, and hence

$$h(1-d) < \frac{7}{16} < \frac{3+d}{7}.$$

Thus the displayed chord coefficient is greater than $1/3$, while $1 - 5d < 1/3$. For $d \geq 1/5$, extensivity alone is stronger than the V triangle-3 estimate.

Applying these chord bounds first with $d = A$ and then with $d = m_3$ proves, without an omitted selected branch,

$$\begin{aligned} p_1 &> L_1 := (2 - 4A)H - (1 - 4A)A, \\ p_2 &:= G_{1-m_3}(p_1) > L_2 := (2 - 5m_3)L_1 - (1 - 5m_3)m_3. \end{aligned}$$

Finally let

$$D_0 = P - RA, \quad D_h = A(4R - 1) + 10RA^2 - \eta, \quad x = Rw.$$

Feasibility puts $D_0 \leq D \leq D_h$. We first prove that the actual feasible value satisfies $D < 1/10$. Since

$$P = \frac{xE}{1+E} < \frac{x}{2}, \quad \eta = \frac{x}{1+E} > \frac{x}{2},$$

the contrary assumption $D \geq 1/10$ and $A + wD < P$ give

$$A < \bar{A} := \frac{w(5R - 1)}{10}.$$

The function $D_h(A)$ is increasing, so

$$D \leq D_h(A) < D_h(\bar{A}) < U(R) := \bar{A}(4R - 1) + 10R\bar{A}^2 - \frac{x}{2}.$$

Direct expansion yields

$$\frac{1}{10} - U(R) = -\frac{R}{10}P_4(R), \quad P_4(R) = 25R^4 - 60R^3 + 26R^2 + 22R - 14.$$

For $y = 2R - 1 \in [0, 1]$,

$$16P_4(R) = 25y^4 - 20y^3 - 106y^2 + 124y - 39 \leq -101y^2 + 124y - 39 < 0.$$

The last quadratic has discriminant -380 . Hence $U(R) < 1/10$, a contradiction, and therefore $D < 1/10$.

It remains to compare L_2 with $2D + 3D^2$. Put

$$J(D) = L_2(D) - \frac{23}{10}D.$$

Since

$$L_2 - 2D - 3D^2 - J(D) = 3D \left(\frac{1}{10} - D \right) > 0,$$

it is enough to prove $J(D) > 0$. Exact differentiation gives

$$J'(D) = \frac{S(R, A)}{10R^2}, \quad S(R, A) = 100A^2 - (40R + 50)A + R(20 - 23R).$$

The inequality $D_0 \leq D_h$ is equivalent to

$$x \leq A(5R - 1 + 10RA).$$

Because $A < P < x/2 \leq 1/8$,

$$A > L := \frac{4x}{25R - 4}.$$

Also $\partial_A S = 200A - 40R - 50 < -45$, and direct substitution gives

$$S(R, L) = -\frac{Rq_3(R)}{(25R - 4)^2},$$

where

$$q_3(R) = 8775R^3 - 14260R^2 + 7928R - 1120.$$

For $y = 2R - 1$,

$$8q_3(R) = 8775y^3 - 2195y^2 + 997y + 3007 \geq 812 > 0.$$

Thus $J'(D) < 0$ and $J(D) \geq J(D_h)$.

At $D = D_h$ one has $H = 2A + 5A^2$. Write $L_{2,h} = L_2(D_h)$. Expansion gives

$$L_{2,h} - A(1 + 4R) = \frac{A}{R^2} \mathcal{Q}(R, A),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Q}(R, A) &= 100A^3R - 40A^2R^2 - 30A^2R + 12AR^2 - 15AR + 5A \\ &\quad - 4R^3 + 5R^2 - R. \end{aligned}$$

On $0 \leq A \leq x/2$,

$$\partial_A^2 \mathcal{Q} = 20R(30A - 4R - 3) < 0.$$

Its two endpoint values are

$$\mathcal{Q}(R, 0) = x(4R - 1) > 0, \quad \mathcal{Q}\left(R, \frac{x}{2}\right) = \frac{x}{2}p(R),$$

where

$$p(R) = 25R^5 - 30R^4 + 20R^3 - 3R^2 - 7R + 3.$$

For $y = 2R - 1$,

$$32p(R) = 25y^5 + 65y^4 + 90y^3 + 106y^2 - 35y + 5 > 0,$$

because the terms of degree at least three are nonnegative and $106y^2 - 35y + 5$ has discriminant -895 . Concavity therefore gives $L_{2,h} > A(1 + 4R)$.

On the other hand, $A < P = \eta E$ and $A < P < x/2$ imply

$$\frac{D_h}{A} = 4R - 1 + 10RA - \frac{\eta}{A} < C_0 := 4R - 2 + 5Rx - \frac{x}{2}.$$

Here we used

$$\frac{1}{E} > 1 + \frac{x}{2}, \quad (1 - x) \left(1 + \frac{x}{2}\right)^2 = 1 - \frac{x^2(3 + x)}{4} < 1.$$

Finally,

$$1 + 4R - \frac{23}{10}C_0 = \frac{h_3(R)}{20}, \quad h_3(R) = 230R^3 - 253R^2 - 81R + 112.$$

Since $h_3''(R) = 46(30R - 11) \geq 184$, strong convexity at $R_0 = 20/23$ gives

$$h_3(R) \geq \frac{788}{529} - \frac{(17/23)^2}{368} = \frac{289695}{194672} > 0.$$

Consequently

$$J(D_h) > A \left(1 + 4R - \frac{23}{10}C_0 \right) > 0,$$

and hence

$$p_2 > L_2 > 2D + 3D^2.$$

The low root $e(D)$ is the smaller root of

$$H_D(z) = z^2 - (1 - D)z + (1 - D)^2 - (1 - D)^4,$$

and direct substitution gives $H_D(2D + 3D^2) = D^2(8D^2 + 19D - 2) < 0$. Hence $e(D) < 2D + 3D^2 < p_2$. The one-hit part of Lemma C.8, applied to the V triangle-2 map, gives

$$G_{1-D}(p_2) \geq 1 - e(D) > 1 - X,$$

because

$$e(D) < 2D + 3D^2 < \frac{23}{100} < \frac{1}{2} < X.$$

This is (85). The actual-V triangle and terminal inequalities in Proposition E.5 now give the contradiction. $\square$

Proposition N.2 (nonempty gap all-Vd0, $N_+ = 1$). *If the center role is CE1 or CE2, every vertex role is Vd0, and $N_+ = 1$, then no cover of H can have a boundary gap in the actual open vertex-role traces.*

Proof. The midpoint argument used above makes T_0 uniquely supercritical. In an assumed cover, every boundary gap in the vertex-role traces must lie in a center trace. CE1 therefore has the one-gap state excluded by Proposition N.1. For CE2, the exactly-one-gap state is Proposition E.7; the two-gap state is the common application in Proposition L.1. This exhausts the one- and two-gap states, including singleton gaps. The zero-gap state is intentionally owned by the center-independent obstruction of Strategy 4. $\square$

APPENDIX O. NONSUPERCRITICAL, T3-LIKE, AND VD1/VD2 DEMAND BRANCHES

O.1. The exactly-one-T3 branch.

Proposition O.1 (Exactly one T3-like V triangle). *Assume the center role is CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly one vertex role is T3-like, and no role is Vd1 or Vd2. Then the roles do not cover H .*

Proof. Normalize the center midpoint to M_0 . A T3-like V triangle misses its own midpoint, a supercritical V triangle misses its local midpoint, and a Vd0 V triangle cannot rescue a neighboring midpoint. Consequently, after reflection,

$$T_0 \text{ is T3-like, } M_1 \in T_0, \quad T_1 \text{ is uniquely supercritical,}$$

and $T_2, \dots, T_5$ are nonsupercritical Vd0 V triangles. The rational local calculation is Lemma G.2. It verifies the two local inequalities in (72), while midpoint and support isolation force the center to cover the O -side radial gap. The common adjacent-rescuer obstruction, Corollary G.5, therefore gives the contradiction. $\square$

O.2. The nonsupercritical CE1/CE2 boundary packages. Figure 23 gives a common schematic for the package proved below.

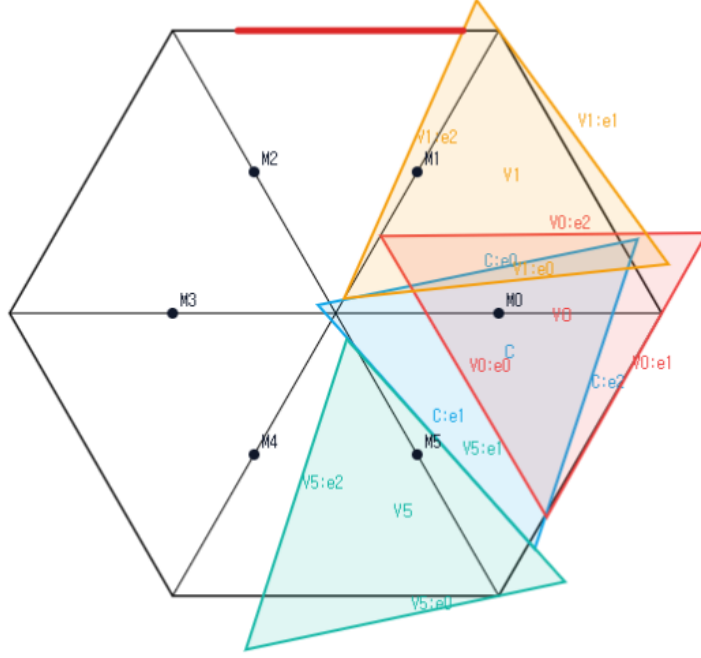


FIGURE 23. Schematic view of the common CE1/CE2, $N_+ = 0$, all-Vd0 boundary package, not to scale. The center role and three representative Vd0 vertex roles are shown; the remaining three roles are omitted for readability. The simultaneous placement is not a candidate cover, and no proof depends on visual inspection.

Proposition O.2 (All-Vd0 skeleton-data obstruction). *Let the center role be CE1 or CE2. Assume all six vertex roles are Vd0,*

$$A_i + B_i \leq 1 \quad (i = 0, \dots, 5),$$

and the seven open roles cover the full skeleton

$$S = \partial H \cup \bigcup_{i=0}^5 r_i.$$

Then no such configuration exists. Consequently the same role data cannot cover all of H .

Proof. Let d_i^C be the center reach on r_i , measured from O , and set $c_i^C = 1 - d_i^C$. Since every vertex role is Vd0, no adjacent vertex role has a positive-length trace on r_i ; diameter locality excludes nonlocal roles. Skeleton coverage therefore forces

$$(*) \quad C_i \geq c_i^C \quad (i = 0, \dots, 5).$$

Let gr be the number of positive center traces containing a nonempty V-gap. Singleton V-gaps are included. The center classification gives $\text{gr} \in \{0, 1, 2\}$, with $\text{gr} \leq 1$ in CE1.

If $\text{gr} = 0$, the six open vertex traces cover every boundary edge. Thus

$$B_i > 1 - A_{i+1}.$$

Nonsupercriticality and the exact capped transfer give

$$A_{i+1} > 1 - B_i \geq \widehat{g}_{C_i}^\vee(A_i) \geq A_i,$$

which produces the impossible strict cycle

$$A_0 < A_1 < \cdots < A_5 < A_0.$$

Suppose $\text{gr} = 1$. Normalize the active trace to

$$I_R = \left[\frac{k}{R}, W + \delta \right] \subset e_{0,1}$$

and put

$$s = \frac{k}{R}, \quad q = R - \delta.$$

Gap containment gives $B_0 \geq s$ and $A_1 \geq q$. The companion edge is absent or gap-free, so $A_0 + B_5 \geq 1$; since $A_0 + B_0 \leq 1$, one has $B_5 \geq s$. By (*),

$$C_1 \geq 1 - \frac{\delta}{R}, \quad C_5 \geq 1 - \frac{\alpha}{W}.$$

The exact one-side endpoint theorem gives

$$\widehat{g}_{1-\alpha/W}(1-s) + \widehat{g}_{1-\delta/R}(1-q) < 1.$$

The three internal V triangles T_2, T_3, T_4 lie on a center-free boundary path. The path budget forces their total boundary contribution above three, contrary to their three nonsupercritical caps.

If $\text{gr} = 2$, the center is CE2. The paired endpoint theorem, together with (*), gives

$$p = W - \alpha, \quad q = R - \delta, \quad F_{p/W}(p) + F_{q/R}(q) < 1.$$

The same center-free three-V-triangle path gives the contradiction.

The three ranks are exhaustive. $\square$

We next treat the additional T3-like V triangles in the $N_+ = 0$ branch. The following local facts also reappear later.

Lemma O.3 (T3-like midpoint and side tradeoff). *Let T_i be T3-like. Then $M_i \notin T_i$. After applying the closed-trace domination of Proposition B.6, suppose the selected adjacent support is on r_{i+1} and M_{i+1} belongs to the dominated trace. If b is its boundary reach toward V_{i+1} , c its exit on its own arm, and ℓ its entry on r_{i+1} , all measured from the relevant vertex, then*

$$(88) \quad b + c < 1, \quad b + \ell > 1.$$

Consequently two adjacent T3-like traces that cover each other's midpoint, whose selected supports point toward one another, cannot cover both outer half-arms if no other role has positive support there.

Proof. Apply Proposition B.6 and reflect if necessary. Its translated Type-II majorant has parameters

$$0 < t < 1, \quad z = \sqrt{1-t+t^2}, \quad \alpha = 0, \quad 0 < \beta < z.$$

Its wedge vertex has

$$Q_x = \frac{z-t\beta}{1-t+t^2} > 1.$$

Hence

$$t\beta < z - z^2.$$

The majorant's own-radial exit is $c = \beta/(1-t)$. Since

$$(1-z)(1+z) = t(1-t),$$

we obtain

$$c < \frac{z-z^2}{t(1-t)} = \frac{z}{1+z} < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Here $z < 1$ because $0 < t < 1$. Thus the translated majorant misses M_0 , and its closed-trace domination implies that the original T3-like role misses M_0 as well.

For the tradeoff, the translated T3-like trace has the exhaustive Type-II form

$$\begin{aligned} (1-t)x + ty &\geq 0, \\ \beta + tx - y &\geq 0, \quad 0 < t < 1, \quad z = \sqrt{1-t+t^2}, \quad 0 < \beta < z. \\ \beta + x - (1-t)y &\leq z, \end{aligned}$$

For the selected support on r_1 , substitution in the Type-II half-planes gives

$$b = z - \beta, \quad c = \frac{\beta}{1-t}, \quad \ell = \frac{\beta + 1 - z}{1-t}.$$

The condition $M_1 \in T$ is $\beta \leq z - (1+t)/2$. Therefore

$$b + c \leq z + \frac{t}{1-t} \left(z - \frac{1+t}{2} \right) = 1 - \frac{(1-z)^2}{2(1-t)} < 1,$$

whereas

$$b + \ell - 1 = \frac{t(1-z+\beta)}{1-t} > 0.$$

For a crossed adjacent pair, coverage forces $c_i \geq \ell_{i+1}$ and $c_{i+1} \geq \ell_i$. Combining these two inequalities with (88) gives both $b_i < b_{i+1}$ and $b_{i+1} < b_i$, a contradiction. $\square$

Lemma O.4 (The support-isolated four-label inequality). *Assume T_C is CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 0$, no role is Vd1 or Vd2, and, after normalization and reflection, T_0 is T3-like with selected adjacent support on r_1 . Then the two endpoint V triangles in the isolated configuration satisfy*

$$(89) \quad F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) + F_{c_1^*}(a_1^*) < 1,$$

where a_1^*, a_5^* are the exact boundary inputs and c_1^*, c_5^* the exact radial demands defined below.

Proof. Use the CE1 side variables $0 < \lambda < 1$, $\rho = \sqrt{1-\lambda+\lambda^2}$ and center slacks

$$X = F_0(O), \quad Y = F_2(O).$$

Then

$$a_C = \lambda - Y, \quad \lambda s = X + Y + 1 - \rho,$$

and Proposition E.1 gives

$$\rho - X - Y > \frac{1}{2}, \quad \frac{Y}{\lambda} < \frac{1}{2}, \quad \frac{X}{1-\lambda} < \frac{1}{2}.$$

Consequently the apparent minima in the two radial exits collapse to

$$\gamma_1 = \frac{Y}{\lambda}, \quad \gamma_5 = \frac{X}{1-\lambda}.$$

For CE2 the second boundary interval is $[S, T]$, where

$$S = \frac{X + Y + 1 - \rho}{1 - \lambda}, \quad T = X + \lambda.$$

The T3-like normal form supplies $D > 1$, $0 < R < 1$, and $\alpha, p \geq 0$ with

$$R^2 - DR + D^2 = 1, \quad \alpha + p = 1/D, \quad q = 1 - p = \alpha + (D - 1)/D < 1/2.$$

Its interval on r_1 , measured from V_1 , is

$$[c, u], \quad c = Dq/R, \quad u = q + (1 - R)/D.$$

For an initial trace $[0, p]$ and a center interval $J = [L, U]$, define

$$\Theta(p, J) = \begin{cases} 1 - p, & J = \emptyset \text{ or } p < L, \\ 1 - \max\{p, U\}, & p \geq L. \end{cases}$$

Then

$$a_1^* = \Theta(p, [s, t]), \quad a_5^* = \Theta(\alpha, [S, T]),$$

with the second interval empty in CE1, and

$$c_5^* = 1 - \gamma_5, \quad c_1^* = \begin{cases} c, & 1 - u \leq \gamma_1 \leq 1 - c, \\ 1 - \gamma_1, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

If $a_1^* + a_5^* > 1$, the two caps already imply $F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) + F_{c_1^*}(a_1^*) < 1$. Assume the hard region $a_1^* + a_5^* \leq 1$. The following table is an exhaustive audit of the four possible first labels; the middle column records the exact decisive inequality.

first label	right labels	conclusion
L	Full	$e(\gamma_5) < a_1^*$
L	L, T_-	$F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) + F_{c_1^*}(a_1^*) < 1$
L	T_+^{hi}	$e(\gamma_5) < a_1^*$
T_-	L, T_-	$F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) + F_{c_1^*}(a_1^*) < 1$
T_-	Full, T_+^{hi}	$F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) < a_1^*$
Full	all	impossible
T_+^{hi}	Full, T_+^{hi}	impossible
T_+^{hi}	L, T_-	$F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) + F_{c_1^*}(a_1^*) < 1$.

We verify the nonformal entries. Put $\kappa = (1 - \rho)/(1 - \lambda)$. From $X + (1 - \lambda)Y < \rho(1 - \rho)$ one obtains

$$(90) \quad \gamma_1 \geq a_C \implies e(\gamma_5) < a_C,$$

$$(91) \quad S \leq Y/\lambda \implies e(\gamma_5) < S.$$

For (90), one has $\gamma_5 < a_C - \kappa$ and $a_C - \kappa < 1/8$; then (82) applies, and the remaining comparison is

$$(a_C - \kappa) + 5(a_C - \kappa)^2 \leq \kappa.$$

After squaring its positive sides, the difference is $\lambda(23\lambda^3 + 58\lambda^2 + 7\lambda + 72) > 0$. For (91), combine the premise with the center inequality and put $x = \lambda$. This gives $0 < x < 3/8$ and

$$X < X_* = \frac{(1-\rho)(\rho(1-2x) - x(1-x))}{1-x-x^2}.$$

Set

$$\delta = \frac{1-\rho}{1-x} = \frac{x}{1+\rho}, \quad \eta = \frac{X}{1-x}, \quad f = \rho(1-2x) - x(1-x), \quad d = 1-x-x^2.$$

Then $\gamma_5 \leq \eta < \delta f/d$. Moreover

$$\frac{f}{d} < 1-2x,$$

because, after multiplication by positive denominators, this is just

$$\rho < d + \frac{x(1-x)}{1-2x} = 1 + \frac{2x^3}{1-2x}.$$

Hence $\eta < \delta(1-2x) < 1/8$. If $\eta = 0$, the assertion is immediate. Otherwise,

$$S \geq \frac{X+1-\rho}{1-2x} = \frac{1-x}{1-2x}(\eta + \delta) > 2\eta \left(\frac{1-x}{1-2x} \right)^2.$$

On the other hand,

$$5\eta < 5\delta(1-2x) < 2 \left[\left(\frac{1-x}{1-2x} \right)^2 - 1 \right].$$

For the middle sign use $\rho > 1-x$ and

$$2(2-3x)(2-x) - 5(1-2x)^3 = (4x-3)(10x^2-6x-1) > 0 \quad (0 < x < 3/8).$$

Indeed both factors are negative; for the quadratic use $10x^2 \leq 15x/4 < 6x+1$. The low-root estimate (82) now gives

$$e(\gamma_5) \leq 2\gamma_5 + 5\gamma_5^2 \leq 2\eta + 5\eta^2 < S,$$

proving (91) without any polynomial coefficient list. The L separation follows from its exact polynomial: if its output is $z = e(\eta)$ at input $1-\beta$, then

$$\beta \geq z + \eta.$$

Indeed the selector polynomial $P(x, z) = x^4 - 4x^3 + 5x^2 - (2+z)x + z - z^2$ is strictly decreasing on the low range and vanishes at $x = \eta$. Equations (90)–(O.2), with the three possibilities for Θ , prove every first- L entry. For a first T_- label the exact root test

$$T_-(a, c) < z \iff c^2(a+z)^2 - (a^2 - ac + c^2) > 0$$

is increasing in z . Substitution of a_1^* , followed by the center inequality, proves $F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) < a_1^*$ except in the low-low entries, which are immediate from $T_-(a, c) \leq \min\{a, 1-a\}$ and $L < 1/2$. First-coordinate Full would force either $X \geq (1-\lambda)\alpha$ and $Y \geq \lambda - \alpha$, contradicting $s \leq p$, or, in the CE2 overlap case, $S \geq 1/2$, contradicting $S \leq \alpha < 1/2$.

For a first T_+^{hi} label put $r = 1-\lambda$, $y = Y/\lambda$ and choose β so that

$$m = \sqrt{\beta^2 - \beta + 1}, \quad 1 - \gamma_5 = \frac{m}{r + \beta}, \quad F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) = \frac{\beta m}{r + \beta}.$$

The exact selector is

$$(92) \quad \beta \geq \max \left\{ r, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1-r^2}{1+2r} \right\}, \quad r \geq (1-\beta)(r+\beta)^2.$$

The center inequalities give $y < 1/10$ and, with

$$y_* = \frac{r}{1-r} \left(\frac{m}{r+\beta} - \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1-r}{1+\sqrt{r^2-r+1}} \right),$$

give $y < y_*$ and

$$3y_* \leq 1 - \frac{\beta m}{r+\beta}.$$

This proves the right- L entry by $e(y) < 3y$. It excludes right Full and right high by the exact high-input filter. For right T_- with input a_C , direct substitution gives a sum below one. For input q , put $c = 1 - y$, $q = tc$, and let $\hat{b}_1 = F_{c_1^*}(q)$. The selected T_- equations give

$$\hat{b}_1 \leq \kappa := \frac{\sqrt{13}-1}{6}, \quad q \leq \tau < \frac{93}{200},$$

where $\tau \in (0, 1/2)$ is the unique root of $\tau^4 - 3\tau^3 + 3\tau^2 - 3\tau + 1 = 0$. In this CE2 overlap subcase the support ordering gives $q > S$. The common left-high identities are

$$S = S_0 + \frac{1-r}{r}y, \quad S_0 = 1 - \frac{m}{r+\beta} + \frac{1-r}{1+\sqrt{r^2-r+1}}.$$

Since $y > 0$, we have the complete chain

$$S_0 < S < q \leq \tau < \frac{93}{200}.$$

We now replace the former interval subdivision by a one-variable comparison. Write $s = r + \beta$ and $\rho_r = \sqrt{r^2 - r + 1}$. The selected Cell 2 inequality factors as

$$r - (1-\beta)(r+\beta)^2 = (s-1)(\beta^2 + r\beta - r).$$

The second factor is nonnegative because $r \leq \beta$ and $\beta \geq 1/2$; if it vanishes, then $r = \beta = 1/2$. Hence $s \geq 1$. It follows that $\rho_r \leq m$, since $\rho_r^2 - m^2 = (r-\beta)(s-1) \leq 0$.

Define the one-variable lower bound

$$\bar{S}(\beta) = 1 - m + \frac{\beta}{1+m}.$$

Then

$$S_0 \geq 1 - \frac{m}{s} + \frac{1-r}{1+m} \geq \bar{S}(\beta).$$

Indeed, the second difference is

$$(s-1) \left(\frac{m}{s} - \frac{1}{1+m} \right) \geq 0.$$

For the last sign use $s \leq 2\beta \leq m(1+m)$: if $g = 3\beta - \beta^2 - 1$, then $g > 0$ and

$$m^2 - g^2 = -\beta(\beta-1)(\beta^2 - 5\beta + 5) \geq 0, \quad m^2 + g = 2\beta.$$

Put $B_0 = 5657/10000$, $T = 93/200$, and $\beta_* = 161/250$. If $\beta m/s \geq B_0$, then $\beta m \geq B_0$. The function $\phi(\beta) = \beta m$ is strictly increasing, and the exact comparison

$$B_0^2 - \beta_*^2 m(\beta_*)^2 = \frac{22782769}{62500000000} > 0$$

therefore gives $\beta > \beta_*$. On $[\beta_*, 1]$ put

$$H(\beta) = \frac{107}{200} - Tm - (1 - \beta)^2.$$

Since $H'' = -3T/(4m^3) - 2 < 0$, the function H is concave. Its endpoint values are positive: $H(1) = 7/100$, while, for $a_* = 107/200 - (1 - \beta_*)^2 = 51033/125000$,

$$a_*^2 - T^2 m(\beta_*)^2 = \frac{1693881}{62500000000} > 0.$$

Thus $H > 0$ throughout the interval. The identity

$$(\bar{S}(\beta) - T)(1 + m) = H(\beta)$$

shows that $\beta m/s \geq B_0$ would force $S_0 > T$, a contradiction. Consequently

$$F_{c_5^*}(a_5^*) < \frac{5657}{10000} < \frac{7 - \sqrt{13}}{6}.$$

The final strict comparison follows by squaring $\sqrt{13} < 18029/5000$, whose squared difference is $44841/25000000 > 0$. Thus the final sum is also below one. The table is exhaustive, proving (89). $\square$

Proposition O.5 (The $N_+ = 0$ T3-like branch). *Assume that T_C is CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 0$, no vertex role is Vd1 or Vd2, and at least one vertex role is T3-like. Then the seven roles do not cover H .*

Proof. Normalize the unique center midpoint to M_0 and simultaneously apply the closed-trace domination of Proposition B.6 to every T3-like role. If T_0 were not T3-like, a maximal consecutive block of T3-like indices among $1, \dots, 5$ would have to match its roles bijectively to the same block of uncovered midpoints. The matching uses only adjacent indices, because a T3-like role misses its own midpoint and Vd0 roles cannot cover adjacent midpoints. Its first two roles therefore form a crossed pair forbidden by Lemma O.3. Hence T_0 is T3-like; reflect so that it supports r_1 .

There are at most two T3-like roles. Indeed, with $N_+ = 0$ and no Vd1/Vd2 role, the short-role identity gives $q = k$, where k is the number of T3-like roles. If $k \geq 3$, Theorem F.15 gives an immediate full-skeleton contradiction. Midpoint locality then forces T_2, T_4, T_5 to be Vd0. Consequently r_1 has positive support only from T_C, T_0, T_1 , and r_5 only from T_C, T_5 .

The actual outgoing reaches of T_1, T_5 are bounded by the two safe maps in Lemma O.4; an extra adjacent-ray demand on a possible T3-like T_1 only shrinks its feasible set. Thus their sum is less than one. V triangles T_2, T_3, T_4 must cover more than three units of the four intervening boundary edges, while their three nonsuper-critical caps sum to at most three. This contradiction proves the proposition. $\square$

Lemma O.6 (Free strict-supercritical envelope). *For $0 \leq c < 1/2$,*

$$\sup\{b : \exists a, (a, b, c) \in \mathcal{A}, a + b > 1\} = \mathcal{B}(c) := \frac{c + \sqrt{c^2 - 8c + 4}}{2}.$$

The supremum is not attained. For $c \geq 1/2$ the strict feasible set is empty. The function $\mathcal{B}$ is strictly decreasing on $[0, 1/2]$.

Proof. Lemma B.10 excludes $c \geq 1/2$. On the boundary $a = 1 - b$, a support rotation has strict slack precisely when

$$c < \frac{1 - b^2}{2 - b}.$$

The right side decreases from $1/2$ to zero. Solving equality gives the displayed larger root. Equality has no strict support slack, which explains nonattainment. Differentiation gives

$$\mathcal{B}'(c) = \frac{1}{2} \left(1 + \frac{c-4}{\sqrt{c^2-8c+4}} \right) < 0,$$

since $(4-c)^2 - (c^2-8c+4) = 12$. $\square$

O.3. Two reusable capped-loss inequalities.

Lemma O.7 (One-side capped loss). *Let $0 < R < 1$, $S = \sqrt{1-R+R^2}$, and let $s, u, w > 0$ satisfy $s+u+w=1$ and $0 < u < R$. Put*

$$\delta = \frac{R}{1+S}, \quad \gamma = u - \delta - \frac{R}{1-R}w,$$

and assume $\gamma > 0$. Set

$$c_1 = u/R, \quad c_5 = 1 - \gamma.$$

Then

$$(93) \quad F_{c_5}(s) + F_{c_1}(u) < 1.$$

Proof. Put $\eta = (1-R)\delta = 1-S$ and

$$\widehat{b}_5 = F_{c_5}(s), \quad \widehat{b}_1 = F_{c_1}(u).$$

The center identity may be written

$$(94) \quad c_5 = \frac{1-u+\eta-Rs}{1-R}.$$

The hypotheses imply $1/2 < c_1, c_5 < 1$: for example $u > \delta$ gives $c_1 > 1/(1+S) > 1/2$, and $\gamma < u - \delta < R - \delta = RS/(1+S) < 1/2$ gives $c_5 > 1/2$. Thus the four high-radial labels of Proposition M.3 are exhaustive.

Right low labels. If the right label is T_- , its exact frontier equation gives $(u+\widehat{b}_1)^2 = 1-R+R^2 = S^2$, so $\widehat{b}_1 = S-u$. For a right L label write $\widehat{b}_1 = kc_1$, $0 \leq k \leq 1/2$, and $C = 1-k+k^2 = c_1^2$. With $X_R = R+k$, the Cell- L selector factors as

$$q = c_1^2(X_R-1)G_k(X_R), \quad G_k(X) = CX^3 + CX^2 - k(1-k)X + k^2.$$

For $X \geq k$, $G_k(X) > 0$: when $k > 0$, $G'_k(X) \geq k(1+2k-k^2+3k^3) > 0$ and $G_k(k) = k^2(1+k+k^3) > 0$. Hence $q \leq 0$ gives $X_R \leq 1$. If $h_R = 1-X_R$, then

$$S^2 - (u+\widehat{b}_1)^2 = h_R(1+2k^2+k(1-k)h_R) \geq 0.$$

Consequently either right low label satisfies

$$(95) \quad \widehat{b}_1 \leq X := S-u.$$

A left low label against right high or Full. For left T_- put $z = s/c_5 = 1-p$ and $h = \sqrt{1-p+p^2}$. The component selector gives $0 \leq p \leq 1/2$, the frontier gives $s+\widehat{b}_5 = h$, and its selector gives $s \leq (1-p)h$. Equation (94) becomes $c_5(1-Rp) = 1-u+\eta$, whence

$$u \geq \eta + (1-h) + Rph.$$

Put $q_0 = ph$. If $q_0 > R$, then $p(1-p) > R(1-R)$ and the preceding lower bound would give $u > R$. Thus $q_0 \leq R$, and

$$\eta + 1 - h > \frac{R(1-R) + p(1-p)}{2} \geq (1-R)q_0.$$

Substitution in the exact formula

$$w = \frac{(1-R)(1-u)p - \eta(1-p)}{1-Rp}$$

now gives $w < 1 - h$. A right high output has the form $H - u$, where $H = \sqrt{1 - \beta + \beta^2} \leq 1$; for Full take $H = 1$. Hence

$$\widehat{b}_5 + \widehat{b}_1 = h + H - (s + u) = 1 + w - (1 - h) - (1 - H) < 1.$$

For a left L label write

$$c_5 = h(x) := \sqrt{1 - x + x^2}, \quad \widehat{b}_5 = xh(x), \quad 0 \leq x \leq \frac{1}{2},$$

and, along the center line,

$$s(x) = \frac{R - u + \eta + (1-R)(1-h(x))}{R}.$$

If $y = s(x)/h(x)$, the exact selector factorization is

$$\frac{q}{h(x)^2} = (y - (1-x))P_x(y),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} P_x(y) = & (1 - x + x^2)y^3 + (1 + 2x - 2x^2 + 3x^3)y^2 \\ & + (x + 2x^2 - x^3 + 3x^4)y + (x^2 + x^3 + x^5). \end{aligned}$$

Every coefficient is nonnegative on $0 \leq x \leq 1/2$, and the polynomial is positive at every nondegenerate point. Thus a selected L point has $s(x) \leq (1-x)h(x)$. The two curves meet once in $(0, 1/2)$: at $x = 0$ the left side is smaller, while at $x = 1/2$ it is enough to use

$$u \leq \frac{R}{1+R} \quad (\text{Full}), \quad u \leq \min\{RS, S/2\} \quad (T_+^{\text{hi}}).$$

Writing $e_0 = 1 - \sqrt{3}/2$, the corresponding endpoint differences are

$$\frac{(1-R)(R^2 + 2Re_0 + 2e_0)}{2(1+R)} > 0$$

for Full, and respectively $[2e_0(1-R) - R^3]/2 \geq 0$ for $R \leq 1/2$ and $(1-R)(3R + 4e_0 - 2)/4 \geq 0$ for $R \geq 1/2$ in the high case. At the unique transition x_0 , the L frontier is the $q = 0$ endpoint of the preceding T_- branch. Since $xh(x)$ increases, every selected left L output is no larger than that transition output. The preceding strict loss therefore also covers (L, T_+^{hi}) and (L, Full) .

Full and high exclusions. Left Full forces $s < 1/2$ and $\gamma \geq s$. Right Full or right high gives $u \leq 1/2$, but

$$\gamma - s = 2u - 1 - \delta + \frac{1-2R}{1-R}w < 0 :$$

for $R \geq 1/2$ this is immediate, while for $R < 1/2$ use $w < 1 - u$ to bound it by $(u - R)/(1 - R) - \delta < 0$. Thus left Full cannot pair with either label. If the left label is high and the right one Full, then $s < 1/2$ and $u \leq R/(1+R)$, whereas $\gamma > 0$

and $w > 1/2 - u$ force $u > R/2 + \eta > R/(1 + R)$; the final inequality is equivalent to $2(1 + R) > 1 + S$. This pair is also impossible.

A right low label. Use (95). If $s > X$, the cap gives $\widehat{b}_5 + \widehat{b}_1 < 1$. Suppose $s \leq X$ and put

$$c_X = X + 2\delta, \quad f(c, z) = c^4 - c^2 + zc - z^2.$$

At the limiting value $u = R$, with $\kappa = \delta$, one has

$$X_0 = \frac{1 - 2\kappa}{1 + \kappa}, \quad c_0 = \frac{1 + 2\kappa^2}{1 + \kappa}.$$

Now $c_0 > \sqrt{3}/2$ because $16\kappa^4 + 13\kappa^2 - 6\kappa + 1 > 0$, and

$$f(c_0, X_0) = \frac{\kappa^2(1 - 2\kappa)^2(4\kappa^4 + 4\kappa^3 + 10\kappa^2 + 6\kappa + 5)}{(1 + \kappa)^4} > 0.$$

Along the u -line, $\frac{d}{du}f(c_X, X) = -4c_X^3 + c_X + X < 0$, so the same two signs hold before the limiting endpoint. Therefore, for $\ell(c) = c(1 - \sqrt{4c^2 - 3})/2$,

$$\ell(c_X) < X < c_X - \ell(c_X), \quad \ell(c_X) < 1 - X.$$

Write $c = h(z) = \sqrt{1 - z + z^2}$ and let z_X satisfy $h(z_X) = c_X$. The actual $c_5(s)$ corresponds to $0 < z \leq z_X < 1/2$, and

$$s(z) = s_0 + \frac{1 - R}{R}(1 - h(z)), \quad s_0 = \frac{R - u + \eta}{R} > 0.$$

The transition input $(1 - z)h(z)$ decreases, and the preceding root ordering gives $s(z_X) < (1 - z_X)h(z_X)$, hence the same strict inequality for all $z \leq z_X$. To check the order of the two boundary coordinates put

$$\phi(z) = s(z) - zh(z), \quad k_R = \frac{1 - R}{R}.$$

Its endpoint values are $s_0 > 0$ and $X - \ell(c_X) > 0$. Moreover

$$\phi'(z) = \frac{(k_R + z)(1 - 2z)}{2h(z)} - h(z).$$

For $k_R \leq 2$ this is nonpositive; for $k_R > 2$ its zero is described by the strictly increasing function $K_0(z) = (2 - 3z + 4z^2)/(1 - 2z)$, so the minimum is again at an endpoint. Thus $zh(z) < s(z)$. Applying the already displayed polynomial P_z gives the strict Cell- L selector, and $s + zh(z) \leq X + \ell(c_X) < 1$. Since $\partial_b F_L = c(1 - 2z) > 0$ and each feasible fiber is an interval, the capped maximum is

$$\widehat{b}_5 \leq zh(z) \leq z_X h(z_X) = \ell(c_X) < 1 - X.$$

Together with $\widehat{b}_1 \leq X$, this proves the loss for every right low label.

High-high. Let $c_L(z)$ be the unique root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$ of $f(c, z) = 0$. With $D_c = 4c^3 - 2c + z > 0$, implicit differentiation gives

$$c_L''(z) = \frac{2(c^2 - cz + z^2) + 16c^2 z(c - z)}{D_c^3} > 0.$$

A selected left high label requires $s < 1/2$ and $c_5(s) \leq c_L(s)$. Define

$$s_0 = \frac{R - u + \eta}{R};$$

then $0 < s_0 < s$ and $c_5(s_0) = 1$. The explicitly named function $g(z) = c_5(z) - c_L(z)$ is concave, with $g(s_0) > 0$. The right high bound $u \leq \min\{RS, S/2\}$ gives $c_5(1/2) >$

7/8. For $R \leq 1/2$ this follows after squaring from $17 - 10R + 9R^2 - 64R^3 - 64R^4 > 0$ (a decreasing polynomial with value 9/4 at 1/2); for $R \geq 1/2$ it follows from $(3 + R)^2 - 16S^2 = (1 - R)(15R - 7) > 0$. Finally

$$f(7/8, 1/2) = 33/4096 > 0$$

and f increases in c on this range, so $c_L(1/2) < 7/8$ and $g(1/2) > 0$. Concavity contradicts $g(s) \leq 0$. Thus high-high is impossible.

If both labels are low, the cap already gives $\hat{b}_5 + \hat{b}_1 \leq s + u = 1 - w < 1$. The preceding five paragraphs cover every other ordered pair of the four labels, proving (93). $\square$

Lemma O.8 (CE2 two-endpoint capped loss). *Let $[x, U]$ and $[y, v]$ be the two exact CE2 traces in the legacy coordinates of Remark E.2, where U denotes the endpoint called u there. Put*

$$p = 1 - U, \quad q = 1 - v, \quad r = \frac{x}{x + y}, \quad w = \frac{y}{x + y},$$

and reflect if necessary so that $0 < w \leq 1/2$ and $r = 1 - w$. Then

$$(96) \quad F_{p/w}(p) + F_{q/r}(q) < 1.$$

Proof. Put

$$S_0 = x + y, \quad K = \sqrt{1 - wr}, \quad z = \frac{w}{1 + K}, \quad \zeta = \frac{r}{1 + K}, \quad \alpha = \frac{p}{w}, \quad \beta = \frac{q}{r}.$$

Then $D = S_0 K$, $1 - K = wr/(1 + K)$, and the exact midpoint inequalities give $1/2 < \alpha, \beta < 1$. Dividing the coupling equation $(U + v)S_0 - xy = D$ by S_0 , and using successively $x < U$ and $y < v$, gives the strict endpoint inequalities

$$(97) \quad \beta + p > 1 + z, \quad \alpha + q > 1 + \zeta.$$

Define

$$\Phi_w(\alpha) = F_\alpha(w\alpha), \quad \Phi_r(\beta) = F_\beta(r\beta), \quad h(t) = \sqrt{1 - t + t^2}.$$

Thus the desired sum is $\Phi_w(\alpha) + \Phi_r(\beta)$.

Selected branch parametrizations. For a side of weight $\sigma \in \{w, r\}$, every L label has

$$(98) \quad c = h(k), \quad F_c(\sigma c) = kh(k), \quad 0 \leq k \leq w,$$

on either side. On the large side the range follows from

$$Q_{\text{cell}}/h(k)^2 = (k - w)G_k(r + k),$$

where $G_k(X) = h(k)^2 X^3 + h(k)^2 X^2 - k(1 - k)X + k^2 > 0$ for $X \geq k$. The remaining selected parametrizations are

$$(99) \quad \alpha = \frac{h(a)}{w + a}, \quad \Phi_w(\alpha) = a\alpha, \quad r \leq a < 1,$$

$$(100) \quad \beta = \frac{h(b)}{r + b}, \quad \Phi_r(\beta) = b\beta, \quad r \leq b < 1,$$

$$(101) \quad \beta = \frac{K}{r + t}, \quad \Phi_r(\beta) = t\beta = K - r\beta, \quad w \leq t \leq r.$$

For example, the small-high selector factors as

$$h(a)^2 a \left(\frac{w}{(w + a)^2} - (1 - a) \right), \quad w - (1 - a)(w + a)^2 = (a - r)(a^2 + wa - w),$$

which gives $a \geq r$; the other two factorizations are $(b-w)(b^2+rb-r)$ and $(t-w)(r^2-wt)$, respectively. These formulas specify the selected geometric components, not discarded algebraic roots.

The small-side T_- label is absent for $w < 1/2$. Large-side Full is incompatible with the first inequality in (97). Small-side Full can pair only with L : either high or T_- on the large side has $\beta \leq K$, which would force $p > (1+r)z > w/(1+w)$, contrary to Full. Thus, up to the symmetric $w = r = 1/2$ tie, the exact list is

$$(102) \quad (\text{Full}, L), (T_+^{\text{hi}}, L), (L, L), (L, T_-), (L, T_+^{\text{hi}}), (T_+^{\text{hi}}, T_-), (T_+^{\text{hi}}, T_+^{\text{hi}}).$$

Low-low sums are at most $K < 1$: an L output is at most wK , while (101) is at most rK . For Full- L , put

$$b_{\text{thr}} = 1 + z - \frac{w}{1+w}, \quad \kappa = \frac{w}{1+(1+w)z}.$$

Full and (97) give $\beta > b_{\text{thr}}$ and $(1+\kappa)b_{\text{thr}} = 1+z$. Direct reduction yields

$$b_{\text{thr}}^2 - h(\kappa)^2 = \frac{w^2(A(w) + KC(w))}{D_0(w, K)} > 0,$$

where

$$A(w) = 8 - 5w + 22w^2 + 6w^3 + 5w^4 + 5w^5 - w^6,$$

$$C(w) = 8 - w + 14w^2 + 4w^3 - 2w^4 + w^5,$$

$$D_0(w, K) = ((1+w)(1+K))^2(1+K+w+w^2)^2.$$

Both numerator polynomials are positive on $[0, 1/2]$. Since h decreases and $(1+k)h(k)$ increases there, $\beta = h(k) > b_{\text{thr}} > h(\kappa)$ implies $(1+k)\beta < 1+z$; combined with (97), this gives $k\beta < p$ and hence the strict Full- L loss.

It remains to verify the four pairs containing a high label on the small side.

(L, T_+^{hi}) . Use parameters $0 \leq k \leq w$ and $r \leq t < 1$:

$$\alpha = h(k), \quad \Phi_w = kh(k), \quad \beta = \frac{h(t)}{r+t}, \quad \Phi_r = \frac{th(t)}{r+t}.$$

The first output and the last output increase in their parameters, while $h(t)/(r+t)$ decreases. If $w \leq 2/5$, then

$$\Phi_w + \Phi_r < wK + \frac{1}{2-w} < 1;$$

after using $K \leq 1-wr/2$, the positive cleared gap is $P(w) = w^4 - 3w^3 + 4w^2 - 6w + 2$, which decreases on $[0, 2/5]$ and has $P(2/5) = 46/625$. If $w \geq 2/5$, the first endpoint inequality gives $\beta > r+z \geq 3/4$. Since $h(3/4)/(r+3/4) = \sqrt{13}/(7-4w) < 3/4$, monotonicity forces $t < 3/4$. Therefore

$$\Phi_w + \Phi_r < \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4} + \frac{3\sqrt{13}}{20} < 1.$$

(T_+^{hi}, T_-) . Use a, t from (99) and (101). Both demands are at most K . The first endpoint inequality gives

$$\alpha > \frac{1+z-K}{w} = \frac{1+r}{1+K} =: a_0.$$

Thus $K > 1 - w^2$, which forces $w > 1/3$, and comparison at $a = 2/3$ forces $a < 2/3$. The function

$$G(a) = \frac{(1+a)h(a)}{w+a}$$

decreases on $[r, 2/3]$, because its derivative numerator $2a^3 + (4w-1)a^2 + (1-w)a + w-2$ is at most its value $-7/54$ at $(2/3, 1/2)$. Hence $G(a) \leq (1+r)K$. Using the second endpoint inequality and $\Phi_r = K - r\beta$ gives

$$\Phi_w + \Phi_r < (2+r)K - 1 - \zeta < 1.$$

After multiplication by $1+K$, the last nonempty gap is $r(3w - w^2 - K)$; its squared comparison is

$$(3w - w^2)^2 - K^2 = w^4 - 6w^3 + 8w^2 + w - 1 > 0$$

for $w > 1/3$ (value $1/81$ at $1/3$, positive derivative thereafter).

$(T_+^{\text{hi}}, T_+^{\text{hi}})$. Use parameters a, b from (99)–(100). The endpoint inequalities first force $w > 2/5$: for $w \leq 2/5$, the asserted contrary inequality $K(w + 1/(2r)) \leq 1 + z$ reduces, after multiplication by $2r(1+K)$, to

$$K(2w^2 - 4w + 1) + 2w^4 - 4w^3 + w^2 - w + 1 > 0,$$

which is immediate according as the coefficient of K is nonnegative or, using $K \leq 1$, from the decreasing polynomial $2w^4 - 4w^3 + 3w^2 - 5w + 2 \geq 172/625$.

For $F_c(t) = (1+t)h(t)/(c+t)$, the derivative numerator $2t^3 + (4c-1)t^2 + (1-c)t + c-2$ is increasing on the present rectangle, so F_c has at most one interior minimum. Endpoint comparison gives

$$\Phi_w + \alpha \leq \frac{2}{1+w}, \quad \Phi_r + \beta \leq \frac{2}{1+r}.$$

The nontrivial endpoint signs are exactly

$$4 - (1+r)^2(1+w)^2K^2 = -w^2(w-1)^2(w^2 - w - 3) > 0$$

and

$$16r^2 - (1+r)^4h(r)^2 = (1-r)(r^5 + 4r^4 + 7r^3 + 9r^2 - 4r - 1) > 0;$$

the bracket is increasing on $[1/2, 1]$ and equals $13/32$ at $1/2$. Weighting the two strict endpoint inequalities by w/K^2 and r/K^2 gives

$$\alpha + \beta > \frac{2K+1}{K(1+K)}.$$

Consequently

$$\Phi_w + \Phi_r < \frac{2}{1+w} + \frac{2}{1+r} - \frac{2K+1}{K(1+K)} < 1.$$

The numerator of the last gap is $3Kwr - Q(w)$, where $Q(w) = w^4 - 2w^3 + 7w^2 - 6w + 2 > 0$. Its squared difference is

$$D(w) = -w^8 + 4w^7 - 9w^6 + 13w^5 - 41w^4 + 65w^3 - 55w^2 + 24w - 4.$$

Here $D'(w) = (1-2w)H(w)$ with

$$H(w) = 4w^6 - 12w^5 + 21w^4 - 22w^3 + 71w^2 - 62w + 24 > 0$$

on $[2/5, 1/2]$; use $71w^2 - 62w + 24 \geq 743/71$ and the remaining cubic block at least $-11/4$. Thus D increases and $D(2/5) = 4904/390625 > 0$, proving the claim.

(T_+^{hi}, L) . Use the fully specified parameters

$$\alpha = \frac{h(t)}{w+t}, \quad p = w\alpha, \quad b = t\alpha, \quad \frac{1}{2} \leq t < 1,$$

and

$$\beta = H = h(k), \quad \widehat{b}_L = kH, \quad 0 \leq k \leq w.$$

Since $p + b = h(t)$, the first endpoint inequality gives

$$(103) \quad 1 - (b + kH) > G := 2 + z - h(t) - (1 + k)H.$$

Put

$$p_0 = 1 + z - K = \frac{w(2-w)}{1+K},$$

let $t_0 \in (1/2, 1)$ be the unique point with $p(t_0) = wh(t_0)/(w+t_0) = p_0$, and put $b_0 = t_0 p_0/w$. The exact endpoint lemma is

$$(104) \quad b_0 < 1 - wK.$$

To verify it, set $b_* = 1 - wK$ and $T_* = wb_*/p_0$. One has $0 < T_* < 1$, and

$$p_0^2(w + T_*)^2 - w^2h(T_*)^2 = -\frac{w^3(KE(w) + J(w))}{(1+K)^2(2-w)^2} > 0,$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} E(w) &= 2w^5 + 3w^3 - 20w^2 + 23w - 6, \\ J(w) &= w^6 + 8w^5 - 22w^4 + 12w^3 + 6w^2 + 2w - 6. \end{aligned}$$

Here $J \leq -111/64$; if $E > 0$, then $KE + J < E + J < 0$, because $E + J$ is increasing and equals $-139/64$ at $w = 1/2$. Thus $p(T_*) < p(t_0)$. Since $p(t)$ decreases, $t_0 < T_*$ and (104) follows.

Finally put $P = 1 + z - p$. If $P < K$, then $t < t_0$ and $k \leq w$, so

$$G > 2 + z - h(t_0) - (1 + w)K = 1 - b_0 - wK > 0.$$

If $P \geq K$, then $K \leq P \leq P_1 := 1 + z - w/(1+w) \leq 1$ and there is $a \in [0, w]$ with $h(a) = P$. Since $P < H$, one has $k < a$ and $(1+k)H < (1+a)P = P + \ell(P)$, where $\ell(P) = P(1 - \sqrt{4P^2 - 3})/2$. Hence

$$G > \mathcal{D}(P) := 1 - b(P) - \ell(P).$$

This function is concave. Indeed $\ell''(P) > 0$, and the high output b is convex in $p = 1 + z - P$: with $A_t = 2 + w - (1 + 2w)t > 0$ and $Q_t = 8wt^2 + 4t^2 - 8wt - 13t - w + 4 < 0$,

$$\frac{d^2b}{dp^2} = -\frac{2h(t)(t+w)^3Q_t}{w^2A_t^3} > 0.$$

At $P = K$, (104) gives $\mathcal{D}(K) = 1 - b_0 - wK > 0$. At $P = P_1$, set $\kappa = w/(1 + (1+w)z)$. The Full- L comparison already proved gives $P_1 > h(\kappa)$, hence $\ell(P_1) < \kappa P_1 = w/(1+w)$, while $b(P_1) = 1/(1+w)$. Thus $\mathcal{D}(P_1) > 0$, and concavity gives $G > 0$ throughout. Equation (103) proves the final hard pair.

The exact list (102) is now exhausted, proving (96). $\square$

O.4. The exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 placements. We now assume CE2, $N_+ = 1$, and exactly one V triangle is Vd1 or Vd2. The corner normal form of Proposition F.6 will be used in the following form: for some $t > 0$ and $d = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}$,

$$(105) \quad x - (t + 1)y \leq a, \quad ty - (t + 1)x \leq tb, \quad tx + y \leq d - a - tb.$$

In particular $a + b < 1/2$ for a positive-support V triangle.

Lemma O.9 (Vd1 adjacent rescue). *Assume an original open-role skeleton cover in the CE2 exact- M_0 branch, with T_0 the unique Vd1 V triangle, $M_1 \in T_0$, T_1 uniquely supercritical, $T_2, \dots, T_5$ nonsupercritical Vd0, and no other positive-adjacent-support role. Then the perimeter together with r_1 is not covered.*

Proof. Lemma G.3 proves the two local inequalities in (72). Midpoint and support isolation force the center to cover the O -side radial gap before the Vd1 interval. The result is therefore Corollary G.5. $\square$

Lemma O.10 (Vd1-pair replacement interface). *In the remaining adjacent Vd1-supercritical placement, the pair can be replaced by two open nonsupercritical Vd0 roles while preserving full skeleton coverage.*

Proof. This is Proposition P.2, which uses separate local charts at the two distinguished vertices and proves all reach, role, and skeleton-preservation claims explicitly. $\square$

O.5. Exact-demand terminal routing.

Proposition O.11 (Exact-demand terminal branches). *The exact-demand method proves the following terminal exclusions:*

- (1) CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 0$, all vertex roles Vd0;
- (2) CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 0$, with at least one T3-like role and no Vd1/Vd2;
- (3) CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 1$, all vertex roles Vd0, with at least one boundary gap;
- (4) CE1 or CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly one T3-like role and no Vd1/Vd2;
- (5) the CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 branch.

All gap alternatives include singleton gaps.

Proof. The five items are respectively Propositions O.2, O.5, N.2, O.1, and Q.1. The strictness at open handoffs appears in the weak endpoint bounds, the nonattained supercritical envelope, and the strict replacement margins; no positive-length assumption is made about a V-gap itself. $\square$

APPENDIX P. EXACT ENDPOINT AND REPLACEMENT VERIFICATION

This section supplies two pieces that must not be hidden by the concise reader presentation. First, it formally incorporates the complete status-bearing 407X four-label endpoint proof. Second, it gives the explicit Vd1-supercritical two-chart replacement in TeX. The incorporated proof-package objects are part of the proof at the exact Git blobs listed below.

P.1. The incorporated 407X endpoint supplement. All paths in the following table are relative to the numbered 407X_T3_like_no_Vd1Vd2 proof directory. Full blob identities are stored in `proof/407X_PROVENANCE.json`; the paper prints only stable proof identifiers and twelve-character prefixes.

proof object	blob prefix	role
4073	910c7a8a1330	residual reduction
4074	7c72dfaf7eb3	(L , Full)
4075	ebe2b65f8840	first T_- family
4078	f1323325b069	remaining first- L family
4079	c66eea05277d	first-Full exclusion
407a	aa5cb1a6dc63	first T_+^{hi} family
407c	c80243f67124	analytic details
407d	e22c85c95fdd	final assembly

The exact capped-map theorem used by these files is Proposition M.3. Its four labels are

$$\text{Full}, \quad L, \quad T_-, \quad T_+^{\text{hi}}.$$

The supplement retains the exact residual inputs a_1^*, a_5^* and radial demands c_1^*, c_5^* from Lemma O.4. It does not replace them by a symmetric or universal envelope.

first label	right labels	incorporated terminal source
L	Full	‘4074’, low-root separation
L	L, T_-	‘4078’, exact low-sheet inequalities
L	T_+^{hi}	‘4078’ and ‘407c’
T_-	L, T_-	‘4075’, exact root ordering
T_-	Full, T_+^{hi}	‘4075’, strict endpoint separation
Full	all labels	‘4079’, first-Full exclusion
T_+^{hi}	Full, T_+^{hi}	‘407a’, high-input exclusion
T_+^{hi}	L, T_-	‘407a’ and ‘407c’, analytic threshold and right- T_- bounds

TABLE 6. The exhaustive four-label endpoint audit. The listed exact source objects contain every polynomial selector, domain restriction, and strict inequality used in the corresponding entry.

Theorem P.1 (Complete support-isolated T3-like endpoint certificate). *For every support-isolated state of Definition 4.8,*

$$\widehat{g}_{c_5^*}(1 - a_5^*) + \widehat{g}_{c_1^*}(1 - a_1^*) < 1.$$

Proof. If $a_1^* + a_5^* > 1$, the diagonal caps already give the strict inequality. Otherwise Proposition M.3 assigns each endpoint one of the four labels above. Table 6 is an exhaustive partition of the resulting ordered label pairs. The incorporated source in each V triangle proves either that the pair is impossible or that its two exact capped outputs have sum strictly below one. File ‘407d’ checks that the geometric residual reduction in ‘4073’ reaches exactly these branches and no others. Therefore the displayed endpoint inequality holds throughout the complete support-isolated domain. $\square$

P.2. The explicit Vd1–supercritical replacement.

Proposition P.2 (Vd1–supercritical two-chart replacement). *Assume the CE2 branch in which an adjacent Vd1 role and the unique supercritical Vd0 role lie away from the vertex role at the center’s unique midpoint. Assume the shared boundary edge is center-free, all other vertex roles are nonsupercritical Vd0, and no additional role has positive support on the two radial arms of the pair. Then the pair can be replaced by two open nonsupercritical Vd0 roles while preserving coverage of the full skeleton.*

Proof. After a fresh cyclic renumbering, let the Vd1 role be based at V_0 , the supercritical role at V_1 , and let the Vd1 role contain M_1 . Write a, b for the Vd1 boundary reaches and use the Vd corner parameter $t \geq 1$, with $d = \sqrt{t^2 + t + 1}$. Put

$$c = \frac{d - a - tb}{t + 1}, \quad \lambda = \frac{t(1 - b)}{t + 1}, \quad u_{\text{adj}} = \frac{d - a - tb - 1}{t}.$$

The strict midpoint and one-sided-support inequalities give

$$(1) \quad a + c < 1, \quad a < \lambda \leq \frac{1}{2}, \quad b < \frac{1}{2}, \quad u_{\text{adj}} < 1 - a.$$

Let (A_1, B_1, C_1) be the actual reaches of the supercritical role. The center-free shared edge and radial coverage give

$$A_1 \geq 1 - b > \frac{1}{2}, \quad C_1 \geq \lambda.$$

The selected supercritical admissible cell has $C_1 \leq 1/2$. The half-square lemma

$$(x, y, z) \in \mathcal{A}, \quad x \geq \frac{1}{2}, \quad z \leq \frac{1}{2} \implies y \leq 1 - z$$

therefore gives $B_1 \leq 1 - C_1 \leq 1 - \lambda$, and hence

$$(2) \quad a + B_1 < 1.$$

If $c_1^{\text{req}} = 1 - d_1^C$ is the vertex-side beginning of the center trace on r_1 , open skeleton coverage gives

$$(3) \quad c_1^{\text{req}} < \max\{C_1, u_{\text{adj}}\} \leq \max\{1 - B_1, 1 - a\}.$$

Choose $p_2 \in (a, 1 - B_1)$ with

$$\max\{p_2, 1 - p_2\} > c_1^{\text{req}};$$

such a point exists because the supremum of the left side on that interval is $\max\{1 - B_1, 1 - a\}$. Then choose

$$a < p_1 < p_2, \quad p_1 < \frac{1}{2}, \quad 1 - p_1 > c.$$

Finally choose $\varepsilon > 0$ smaller than

$$(4) \quad p_1 - a, \quad p_2 - p_1, \quad 1 - B_1 - p_2, \quad 1 - p_1 - c, \quad \max\{p_2, 1 - p_2\} - c_1^{\text{req}}.$$

Use two distinct local charts:

$$X_0(x, y) = V_0 + x(V_5 - V_0) + y(V_1 - V_0),$$

$$X_1(x, y) = V_1 + x(V_0 - V_1) + y(V_2 - V_1).$$

For $p \leq 1/2$ put

$$\Delta_p^- = \text{conv}\{(0, 1 - p), (1, 1 - p), (0, -p)\},$$

and for $p > 1/2$ put

$$\Delta_p^+ = \text{conv}\{(p, 0), (p, 1), (p - 1, 0)\}.$$

Define

$$U'_0 = X_0(\text{int}(\Delta_{p_1}^-) + (-\varepsilon, 0))$$

and

$$U'_1 = \begin{cases} X_1(\text{int}(\Delta_{p_2}^-) + (-\varepsilon, 0)), & p_2 \leq 1/2, \\ X_1(\text{int}(\Delta_{p_2}^+) + (0, -\varepsilon)), & p_2 > 1/2. \end{cases}$$

In its own chart the shifted minus template contains the origin and has reach triple

$$(p - \varepsilon, 1 - p, 1 - p),$$

while the shifted plus template contains the origin and has reach triple

$$(p, 1 - p - \varepsilon, p).$$

Their closures stay strictly below both adjacent-arm lines $x = 1$ and $y = 1$. Thus $V_0 \in U'_0$, $V_1 \in U'_1$, both roles are Vd0, and both boundary sums equal $1 - \varepsilon < 1$.

The first replacement reaches beyond a on $e_{5,0}$ and beyond c on r_0 . On the shared edge its reach is $1 - p_1$, while the second replacement reaches at least $p_2 - \varepsilon$ from V_1 ; their sum exceeds one by (4). The second replacement reaches beyond B_1 on $e_{1,2}$ and has own-radial reach $\max\{p_2, 1 - p_2\} > c_1^{\text{req}}$ on r_1 . Hence every boundary and radial component formerly supplied by the special pair remains covered, and all other skeleton components are unchanged.

The modified roles therefore cover the full skeleton and have six nonsupercritical Vd0 vertex roles. Proposition O.2 gives the contradiction. $\square$

APPENDIX Q. AUTHORITATIVE CE2 ONE-VD PLACEMENT ASSEMBLY

The following proposition is the sole CE2 exactly-one-Vd placement assembly used by the final proof. It cites only complete placement lemmas and the explicit two-chart replacement in Appendix P.

Proposition Q.1 (Complete CE2 exactly-one-Vd1/Vd2 assembly). *Assume the center has type CE2, $N_+ = 1$, exactly one vertex role has type Vd1 or Vd2, and no T3-like role is present. Then the seven roles do not cover H .*

Proof. Normalize the unique center midpoint to M_0 . If an additional vertex role has positive adjacent-arm support, then the unique supercritical V triangle, the Vd1/Vd2 V triangle, and that additional role are three short roles; the skeleton contradiction of Theorem F.15 applies. Hence assume the no-additional-positive-support complement.

First suppose the unique supercritical V triangle is T_0 . If the Vd1/Vd2 V triangle is adjacent, it is eliminated by Lemma G.6; the proof treats both possible supported arms and its reflection. If it is nonadjacent, its index lies in $\{2, 3, 4\}$ after reflection, and Lemma G.7 gives a strict radial separation.

Next suppose the unique Vd1/Vd2 V triangle is T_0 . It must rescue the midpoint of the unique supercritical V triangle, so midpoint locality makes that V triangle adjacent. If T_0 is Vd2, the neighboring-midpoint cap Lemma F.7, combined with the center and supercritical perimeter caps, is Proposition F.10. If T_0 is Vd1, the exact Vd1 local profile and the common center-hiding theorem give Corollary G.5.

Finally suppose neither special V triangle is T_0 . Since the exact- M_0 center covers no other radial midpoint, the Vd1/Vd2 V triangle must rescue the midpoint missed by the unique supercritical V triangle. Diameter locality makes the two V triangles adjacent. A Vd2 rescue is again eliminated by the neighboring-midpoint cap. For a Vd1 rescue, the shared edge has no center trace in this placement and the no-additional-support hypotheses are exactly those of Proposition P.2. Replace the pair by two open nonsupercritical Vd0 roles while preserving every boundary and radial demand used by Proposition O.2. All other vertex roles were already nonsupercritical Vd0, so that all-Vd0 theorem gives the contradiction.

These alternatives exhaust the relative positions of the center-midpoint V triangle, the unique supercritical V triangle, and the unique $Vd1/Vd2$ V triangle. $\square$

APPENDIX R. AREA-LOSS OBSTRUCTIONS

This section proves the local inequalities and cyclic estimates used in the area-loss argument.

Let

$$A_{\Delta} = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}$$

be the area of a unit equilateral triangle. Throughout this section areas are divided by A_{Δ} . Thus a unit triangle has normalized area one and H has normalized area six.

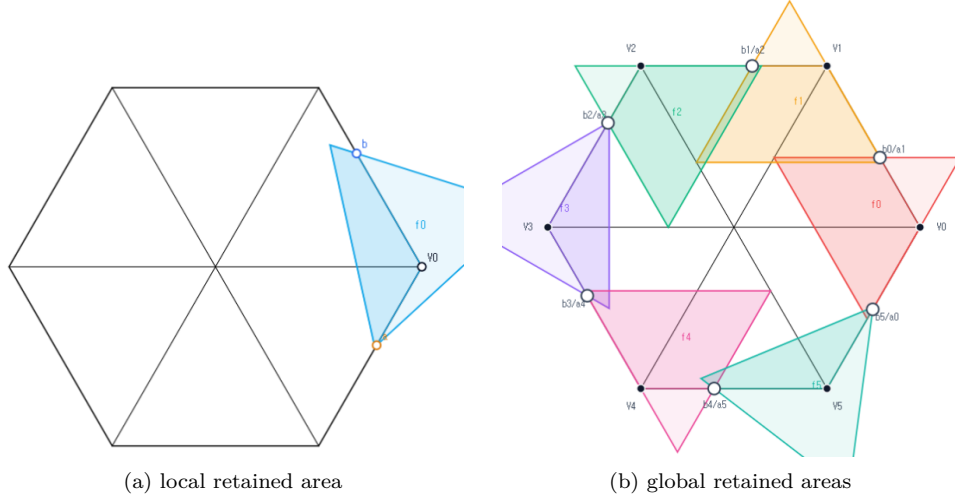


FIGURE 24. Schematic views of Strategy 3, not to scale. The local panel shows one vertex role with boundary reaches a, b , and the global panel shows the six cyclic roles. Only the darker portions represent area retained inside H ; the proof uses the inequalities below, not the picture.

R.1. The local square-loss inequalities. Fix a vertex V_i . Let P_a and P_b be the points at distances a and b from V_i on its incoming and outgoing boundary edges. For a closed unit equilateral triangle T containing V_i, P_a, P_b , put

$$\mathcal{L}(T) = \frac{\text{area}(T \setminus H)}{A_{\Delta}}.$$

Equivalently, if

$$f(a, b) = \max_T \frac{\text{area}(T \cap H)}{A_{\Delta}}, \quad \mathcal{L}(a, b) = 1 - f(a, b),$$

then $\mathcal{L}(a, b)$ is the least possible normalized loss. Reflection in the radial axis interchanges a and b , and increasing either demand can only decrease f .

Lemma R.1 (Local wedge reduction). *After rotating indices to $i = 0$, write*

$$X = V_0 + x(V_1 - V_0) + y(V_5 - V_0), \quad W = \{(x, y) : x \geq 0, y \geq 0\}.$$

If a closed unit equilateral triangle T contains V_0 , then

$$T \cap H = T \cap W.$$

Normalized Euclidean area is twice the corresponding (x, y) -coordinate area.

Proof. The two basis vectors have length one and angle 120° , so

$$\|(x, y)\|^2 = x^2 + y^2 - xy, \quad |\det(V_1 - V_0, V_5 - V_0)| = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}.$$

The hexagon is

$$H = \{0 \leq x, y \leq 2, |x - y| \leq 1\} \subset W.$$

Conversely, if $(x, y) \in T \cap W$, then the diameter-one condition gives $x^2 + y^2 - xy \leq 1$. Hence

$$|x - y|^2 \leq x^2 + y^2 - xy \leq 1, \quad \frac{3}{4}x^2 \leq x^2 + y^2 - xy,$$

and the same estimate holds for y . Thus $|x - y| \leq 1$ and $0 \leq x, y \leq 2/\sqrt{3} < 2$, proving $(x, y) \in H$. The determinant identity proves the area assertion. $\square$

Theorem R.2 (Unconditional local square loss). *For every feasible pair $0 \leq a, b \leq 1$ and every realizing closed unit equilateral triangle T ,*

$$(106) \quad \mathcal{L}(T) \geq \min(a, b)^2.$$

If $a + b > 1$, then

$$(107) \quad \mathcal{L}(T) \geq \max(a, b)^2.$$

Consequently the same inequalities hold for $\mathcal{L}(a, b) = 1 - f(a, b)$.

Proof. In the coordinates of Lemma R.1, physical rotation through 60° is $R(x, y) = (x - y, x)$. Put

$$0 \leq t \leq 1, \quad D = 1 - t + t^2, \quad z = \sqrt{D}.$$

After choosing one of the six directed sides, every orientation has one of the following two forms:

$$(108) \quad \begin{array}{c|cc} & d & Rd \\ \hline \text{I} & z^{-1}(1, t) & z^{-1}(1 - t, 1) \\ \text{II} & z^{-1}(t, -(1 - t)) & z^{-1}(1, t). \end{array}$$

Indeed these forms cover, respectively, the physical direction sectors $[120^\circ, 180^\circ]$ and $[60^\circ, 120^\circ]$; their endpoints cover the common boundary orientations.

For Type I introduce

$$U = \alpha + y - tx, \quad V = \beta + x - (1 - t)y.$$

Then T is the simplex $U, V \geq 0, U + V \leq z$. Containment of $(0, 0), (0, a), (b, 0)$ gives

$$(109) \quad \alpha \geq tb, \quad \beta \geq (1 - t)a, \quad \alpha + \beta + (1 - t)b \leq z, \quad \alpha + \beta + ta \leq z.$$

The two inequalities defining W become

$$(1 - t)U + V \geq (1 - t)\alpha + \beta, \quad U + tV \geq \alpha + t\beta.$$

For fixed t , lowering α or β therefore enlarges $T \cap W$. The outside loss is minimized at $\alpha = tb$, $\beta = (1-t)a$. At that placement the portion outside W has vertices, in the (U, V) -plane,

$$(0, 0), \quad (a + tb, 0), \quad (tb, (1-t)a), \quad (0, b + (1-t)a).$$

Since the Jacobian of $(x, y) \mapsto (U, V)$ has absolute value D ,

$$(110) \quad \mathcal{L}(T) \geq \mathcal{L}_I(a, b; t) = \frac{(1-t)a^2 + tb^2 + 2t(1-t)ab}{D}.$$

If $a \leq b$, then

$$D(\mathcal{L}_I - a^2) = t\{b^2 - a^2 + (1-t)(a^2 + 2ab)\} \geq 0;$$

the reflected factorization proves $\mathcal{L}_I \geq b^2$ when $b \leq a$. This proves (106) in Type I.

Suppose now that $a + b > 1$ and $a \leq b$. Set

$$r = \frac{a}{b}, \quad t_0 = \frac{1-r^2}{1+2r}.$$

Since $b > 1/(1+r)$, feasibility in (110) and (109) excludes $0 \leq t < t_0$: for $0 < t < t_0$,

$$\left(\frac{1+r(1-t)}{1+r}\right)^2 - D = \frac{t(1+2r)(t_0-t)}{(1+r)^2} > 0,$$

so $b + (1-t)a > z$, while $t = 0$ would give $a + b \leq 1$. Hence $t \geq t_0$, and

$$D(\mathcal{L}_I - b^2) = (1-t)b^2\{r^2 - 1 + t(2r+1)\} \geq 0.$$

If $b \leq a$, put $r = b/a$ and $t_1 = (r^2 + 2r)/(1+2r)$. The identical reflected calculation excludes $t > t_1$ and gives

$$D(\mathcal{L}_I - a^2) = ta^2\{r^2 + 2r - t(1+2r)\} \geq 0.$$

Thus (107) holds in Type I.

For Type II put

$$U = \alpha + (1-t)x + ty, \quad V = \beta + tx - y.$$

Again T is the simplex $U, V \geq 0$, $U + V \leq z$. Its exact reaches on the positive y - and x -axes are

$$(111) \quad A = \beta, \quad B = z - \alpha - \beta, \quad A + B \leq z \leq 1.$$

In particular Type II is impossible when $a + b > 1$. Its wedge intersection is the quadrilateral with vertices

$$(0, 0), \quad (B, 0), \quad \left(\frac{B + (1-t)A}{D}, \frac{A + tB}{D}\right), \quad (0, A).$$

Hence

$$(112) \quad \mathcal{L}(T) = \mathcal{L}_{II}(A, B; t) = 1 - \frac{(1-t)A^2 + tB^2 + 2AB}{D}.$$

Let $S = A + B$. If $A \leq B$, write $A = rS$, $B = (1-r)S$ with $0 \leq r \leq 1/2$. Since $S^2 \leq D$, and with

$$C = (1-t)r^2 + t(1-r)^2 + 2r(1-r),$$

we have $\mathcal{L}_{II} \geq 1 - C$. The exact factorization

$$1 - C - r^2D = (1-t)(1 - 2r + tr^2) \geq 0$$

gives $\mathcal{L}_{\text{II}} \geq r^2 D \geq A^2$. Reflection gives $\mathcal{L}_{\text{II}} \geq B^2$ when $B \leq A$. Since $A \geq a$ and $B \geq b$, this proves (106). The two orientation types are exhaustive, so the theorem follows. $\square$

R.2. The direct T3-like loss. The next theorem uses the classification data (o, n) from Section B: o counts triangle vertices outside H , and n counts adjacent radial arms met in positive length. Thus a T3-like role has $(o, n) = (2, 1)$.

Theorem R.3 (Direct T3-like loss). *Let T be a closed unit V_i -triangle of T3-like type, and let a, b be lower bounds for its adjacent boundary reaches. Then*

$$(113) \quad a + b \leq 1.$$

Moreover, for $0 \leq m \leq 1/2$,

$$(114) \quad a, b \geq m \implies \mathcal{L}(T) \geq 2m - 4m^2.$$

Proof. The first assertion is Lemma B.8. For the loss bound apply the closed-trace domination in Proposition B.6. It gives a translated Type-II triangle $\hat{T}$ of the same area with

$$T \cap H \subset \hat{T} \cap H, \quad \mathcal{L}(T) \geq \mathcal{L}(\hat{T}).$$

In the notation of that proposition, $0 < t < 1$, $D = 1 - t + t^2$, $z = \sqrt{D}$, and after reflection the translated majorant has exact reaches

$$A = \beta, \quad B = z - \beta$$

and unique wedge vertex

$$Q = \left(\frac{B + (1-t)A}{D}, \frac{A + tB}{D} \right), \quad Q_x > 1, \quad Q_y \leq 1.$$

Thus $z - tA > D$, so

$$(115) \quad A < L := \frac{z - D}{t} = \frac{z(1 - z)}{t}.$$

The exact normalized loss is

$$\mathcal{L}(\hat{T}) = \mathcal{L}(z, A) = \frac{tA^2 + (1-t)(z - A)^2}{D}.$$

This decreases for $A < L < (1-t)z$, and therefore

$$(116) \quad \mathcal{L}(T) \geq \mathcal{L}(\hat{T}) > \mathcal{L}(z, L).$$

Set $r = (1 - z)/t$. Then $0 < r < 1/2$, and eliminating t, z gives

$$t = \frac{1 - 2r}{1 - r^2}, \quad z = \frac{r^2 - r + 1}{1 - r^2},$$

$$L = A_0(r) := \frac{r(r^2 - r + 1)}{1 - r^2}, \quad z - L = B_0(r) := \frac{r^2 - r + 1}{1 + r}.$$

The limiting normalized inside area and loss are

$$F_0(r) = \frac{(r^2 - r + 1)^2}{1 - r^2}, \quad \mathcal{L}_0(r) = 1 - F_0(r).$$

Since the exact reach A is at least the required demand $a \geq m$, (115) gives $A_0(r) > m$. Direct simplification yields

$$\mathcal{L}_0(r) - \{2A_0(r) - 4A_0(r)^2\} = \frac{r^2(5r^4 - 8r^3 + 13r^2 - 8r + 2)}{(1 - r^2)^2} \geq 0,$$

because the last polynomial is at least $9r^2 - 8r + 2 \geq 2/9$ on $[0, 1/2]$. Also $A_0(r) \leq r$, and

$$\mathcal{L}_0(r) - \frac{1}{4} = \frac{(1-2r)(2r^3 - 3r^2 + 6r - 1)}{4(1-r^2)} \geq 0 \quad \text{when } A_0(r) \geq \frac{1}{4};$$

the cubic is increasing and has value $11/32$ at $r = 1/4$.

Finally $\psi(u) = 2u - 4u^2$ is increasing on $[0, 1/4]$ and never exceeds $1/4$ on $[0, 1/2]$. If $A_0(r) \leq 1/4$, then $\mathcal{L}_0(r) \geq \psi(A_0(r)) \geq \psi(m)$; if $A_0(r) \geq 1/4$, then $\mathcal{L}_0(r) \geq 1/4 \geq \psi(m)$. Together with (116), this proves (114). The reflected crossing is identical. $\square$

R.3. The cyclic area certificates. The selected handoffs of Proposition B.9 have the form

$$(a_i, b_i) = (1 - x_{i-1}, x_i), \quad 0 < x_i < 1,$$

with cyclic indices. V triangle i is selected supercritical exactly when $x_i > x_{i-1}$.

Lemma R.4 (Cyclic area-loss certificate). *Let the six actual vertex triangles realize selected handoffs*

$$(a_i, b_i) = (1 - x_{i-1}, x_i), \quad 0 < x_i < 1.$$

Their total normalized loss is strictly greater than one if either

- (1) *at least two selected V triangles are supercritical; or*
- (2) *exactly one selected V triangle is supercritical, every role is Vd0 or T3-like, and at least one role is T3-like.*

Proof. Put $m = \min_i x_i$ and $M = \max_i x_i$. The reflection $y_i = 1 - x_{i-1}$ swaps each V triangle's two coordinates and preserves both alternatives and the total loss. Hence assume $m \leq 1 - M$. Every selected V triangle coordinate is then at least m , so (106) gives loss at least m^2 for every V triangle.

In case (1), choose an ascent out of a minimum plateau, $x_{p-1} = m < x_p$. Its V triangle contains the coordinate $1 - m$ and loses at least $(1 - m)^2$ by (107). A second ascent has one coordinate strictly larger than $1/2$ and hence loses strictly more than $1/4$. The other four V triangles lose at least m^2 each, so the total loss is strictly larger than

$$4m^2 + (1 - m)^2 + \frac{1}{4} = 5 \left(m - \frac{1}{5} \right)^2 + \frac{21}{20} > 1.$$

In case (2), rotate so that the unique ascent leaves the minimum: $x_5 = m < x_0 = M$. The supercritical V triangle loses at least $(1 - m)^2$. Lemma B.8 shows that a T3-like V triangle is different from it, and Theorem R.3 gives that V triangle loss at least $2m - 4m^2$. The remaining four V triangles lose at least m^2 each. Their total loss is at least

$$(1 - m)^2 + (2m - 4m^2) + 4m^2 = 1 + m^2 > 1.$$

$\square$

Proposition R.5 (Branches closed by area). *The following branches are impossible:*

- (1) T_C is CE0, $N_+ \geq 2$, with arbitrary vertex-role types;
- (2) T_C is CE0, $N_+ = 1$, no role is Vd1 or Vd2, and at least one role is T3-like.

Proof. In the CE0 class, the center role has no positive-length boundary trace. If the six vertex roles missed a boundary point, openness of the center role would give such a trace. Hence the vertex roles cover ∂H , so Proposition B.9 applies.

If $N_+ \geq 2$, its at-least-two clause selects handoffs with at least two supercritical V triangles. Lemma R.4 makes the six vertex triangles' total normalized inside area strictly less than five. The center triangle contributes at most one, so the total is strictly less than six.

If $N_+ = 1$, the exact-one clause preserves the unique actual supercritical index for every strict selection. The exhaustive vertex-type hypothesis gives case (2) of Lemma R.4; the six vertex triangles contribute less than five normalized area, and the center triangle contributes at most one. Again the sum is strictly below the normalized area six of H . $\square$

APPENDIX S. THE DIRECT NINE-POINT OBSTRUCTION

This section supplies the exact frontier, witness, sign, and cap-overlap calculations for the direct nine-point obstruction.

This section proves a center-class-independent theorem. Its hypotheses are that all six vertex roles are Vd0, that they cover the full boundary, and that exactly one actual boundary V triangle is supercritical. The theorem will therefore apply both to the CE0 branch and to the zero-gap subcases of CE1 and CE2. Six common radial points and three asymmetric points are excluded directly from all six actual vertex roles and are therefore forced into the center role. Only the unique supercritical V triangle uses an AB -union; no nonsupercritical model core is introduced.

S.1. The finite caliper criterion. We first record the finite caliper certificate used below. It enters the proof through the exact statement and verification argument given here; neither a plot nor an unrecorded numerical convention is used.

Let R and J denote counterclockwise rotations through $2\pi/3$ and $\pi/2$, respectively. For a nonempty finite set $S \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ and a vector N , put

$$(117) \quad W_S(N) = \sum_{k=0}^2 \max_{z \in S} \langle z, R^k N \rangle.$$

Theorem S.1 (Finite caliper certificate). *If S has at least two distinct points, then S is contained in a closed unit equilateral triangle if and only if there are distinct $p, q \in S$ and $\varepsilon \in \{-1, 1\}$ for which*

$$(118) \quad W_S(\varepsilon J(q - p)) \leq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \|p - q\|.$$

If S consists of one point, it is contained in equilateral triangles of arbitrarily small positive side length.

For $S_x = \{O, A, B, x\}$, every clause of (118) is a finite polynomial clause of degree at most four in the coordinates of A, B, x ; at most $12 \cdot 4^3$ clauses are required, and repeated point labels merely delete zero-length pairs.

Proof. For a unit vector n , write

$$G_S(n) = \sum_{k=0}^2 h_S(R^k n), \quad h_S(n) = \max_{z \in S} \langle z, n \rangle.$$

The three supporting half-planes with normals n, Rn, R^2n form an equilateral triangle of side $2G_S(n)/\sqrt{3}$. Hence S fits in a closed unit equilateral triangle precisely when $\min_{\|n\|=1} G_S(n) \leq \sqrt{3}/2$.

On an open normal-direction cell on which the three support points are fixed, $G_S(\theta) = c \cos \theta + d \sin \theta$ and $G_S'' = -G_S < 0$ unless all points coincide. Thus a minimum occurs at a cell boundary, where some support line contains two distinct points p, q . After a cyclic rotation of the three normals, its normal is $\varepsilon J(q-p)/\|p-q\|$. Homogeneity yields (118). A nondegenerate segment is checked directly with its two normals.

For the polynomial expansion fix (p, q, ε) , put $N = \varepsilon J(q-p)$ and $N_k = R^k N$, and choose support labels $z_0, z_1, z_2 \in S_x$. The support cell is

$$(119) \quad \langle z_k, N_k \rangle \geq \langle z, N_k \rangle \quad (z \in S_x, \quad k = 0, 1, 2),$$

with $\|p-q\|^2 > 0$. Since $W_S(N) \geq 0$, the remaining test is

$$(120) \quad 4 \left(\sum_{k=0}^2 \langle z_k, N_k \rangle \right)^2 \leq 3\|p-q\|^2.$$

The points are affine-linear in the parameters, so (119)–(120) have degree at most four. Six unordered pairs, two signs, and 4^3 support-label triples give the asserted finite exhaustive list. $\square$

S.2. Corner-clipped AB -unions. Let e_A, e_B be unit vectors with angle 120° , put

$$O = 0, \quad A = ae_A, \quad B = be_B, \quad C = \{ue_A + ve_B : u, v \geq 0\},$$

and define

$$(121) \quad \mathcal{R}(a, b) = C \cap \bigcup \{T : T \text{ is a closed unit equilateral triangle and } O, A, B \in T\}.$$

The finite description in Theorem S.1 applies to the four-point set $\{O, A, B, x\}$ and makes membership in (121) an exact finite semialgebraic condition of degree at most four.

The strict supercritical branch admits a simpler closed form. In the next statement write $x = ue_A + ve_B$ and $\|x\|^2 = u^2 + v^2 - uv$.

Theorem S.2 (Strict supercritical AB -union). *Assume*

$$a + b > 1, \quad \rho = a^2 + ab + b^2 < 1,$$

put $h = \sqrt{3}/2$, $D = \sqrt{4\rho - 3}$, and define

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha &= \frac{h(a + 2b - aD)}{2\rho}, & \beta &= \frac{h(a - b + (a + b)D)}{2\rho}, \\ \gamma &= \frac{h(-a + b + (a + b)D)}{2\rho}, & \delta &= \frac{h(2a + b - bD)}{2\rho}. \end{aligned}$$

Then all four coefficients are positive and

$$(122) \quad \mathcal{R}(a, b) = (C \cap \mathcal{D}_A \cap \mathcal{H}_A) \cup (C \cap \mathcal{D}_B \cap \mathcal{H}_B),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{D}_A &= \{(u, v) : (u - a)^2 + v^2 - (u - a)v \leq 1\}, \\ \mathcal{D}_B &= \{(u, v) : u^2 + (v - b)^2 - u(v - b) \leq 1\}, \\ \mathcal{H}_A &= \{(u, v) : \alpha(u - a) + \beta v \leq 0\}, \\ \mathcal{H}_B &= \{(u, v) : \gamma u + \delta(v - b) \leq 0\}.\end{aligned}$$

Its non-axis frontier consists, in counterclockwise order, of the A -circle, the A -line, the B -line, and the B -circle.

Proof. The identities

$$4\rho - 3(a + b)^2 = (a - b)^2, \quad (a + b)^2 D^2 - (a - b)^2 = 4\rho((a + b)^2 - 1)$$

give $0 < D < 1$ and positivity of the four coefficients.

We apply the caliper criterion of Theorem S.1. For a point $x = (u, v)$ in the relative interior of C but outside $\triangle OAB$, the four hull vertices occur in the order O, B, x, A . The two cone-axis hull edges cannot certify a unit triangle: their support sums, divided by h , are respectively

$$\max\{a, u\} + \max\{b, v - u\}, \quad \max\{b, v\} + \max\{a, u - v\},$$

and are at least $a + b > 1$. It remains to test the Ax and Bx calipers.

For the Ax caliper put $p = u - a$ and $r^2 = p^2 + v^2 - pv$. Exact evaluation of the three supports gives

$$(123) \quad \frac{G_A}{h} = \frac{\max\{r^2, -ap + (a + b)v\} + N_A}{r}, \quad N_A = \begin{cases} 0, & p \leq 0, \\ ap, & 0 \leq p \leq v, \\ (a + b)p - bv, & p \geq v. \end{cases}$$

No support label is omitted in these three sectors. If $p \leq 0$, $G_A \leq h$ is equivalent to

$$r \leq 1, \quad -ap + (a + b)v \leq r.$$

The second inequality is the half-plane condition in (122), because

$$r^2 - (-ap + (a + b)v)^2 = \frac{(cp + dv)(c'p + d'v)}{4\rho},$$

where

$c = a + 2b - aD$, $d = a - b + (a + b)D$, $c' = a + 2b + aD$, $d' = a - b - (a + b)D$, and $c, c', d > 0 > d'$. Thus the low sector is exactly $\mathcal{D}_A \cap \mathcal{H}_A$. In the middle sector $0 < p \leq v$ one has $r \leq v$, whereas the numerator in (123) is at least $(a + b)v > r$, so no fit is possible.

In the high sector $p \geq v$, the inequalities $G_A \leq h$ imply

$$(124) \quad r^2 + (a + b)p - bv \leq r, \quad bp + av \leq r.$$

Write $x - A = ry(\theta)$, $0 \leq \theta \leq 60^\circ$, with cone coordinates

$$y(\theta) = te_A + we_B, \quad t = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \cos(\theta - 30^\circ), \quad w = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} \sin \theta.$$

Then (124) gives

$$r \leq f(\theta) = 1 - (a + b)t + bw, \quad S(\theta) = bt + aw \leq 1.$$

Let n_B be the unit vector with dual coordinates (γ, δ) . The identities

$$b\gamma + (a+b)\delta = h, \quad (a+b)\gamma + a\delta = \frac{h}{2}(1+D), \quad b\delta - a\gamma = \frac{h}{2}(1-D)$$

show that the unique angle θ_B of this normal satisfies $S(\theta_B) = 1$ and $f(\theta_B) = (1-D)/2$. The function S has at most one critical point, a maximum, so $S(\theta) \leq 1$ implies $\theta \leq \theta_B$. On the feasible part $f, f' \geq 0$; hence $f(\theta) \cos(\theta_B - \theta)$ is increasing. Consequently

$$\langle n_B, x - B \rangle \leq a\gamma - b\delta + \frac{h}{2}(1-D) = 0.$$

The diameter bound also gives $\|x - B\| \leq 1$. Thus every high sector fit belongs to $\mathcal{D}_B \cap \mathcal{H}_B$. Reflection exchanges a, u with b, v and supplies the corresponding result for the Bx caliper. This proves (122) in the cone interior; the axes follow by taking limits, since both sides are closed.

For completeness, the line-circle junctions are obtained by solving the two displayed line and circle equations. The line normals satisfy

$$\alpha^2 + \alpha\beta + \beta^2 = h^2, \quad \gamma^2 + \gamma\delta + \delta^2 = h^2,$$

and the line determinant is

$$\alpha\delta - \gamma\beta = \frac{3(1-D)(D+3)}{16\rho} > 0.$$

The successive cone slopes are

$$+\infty, \quad \frac{2}{1-D}, \quad \frac{a(1-D) + 2b}{2a + b(1-D)}, \quad \frac{1-D}{2}, \quad 0;$$

the two middle comparisons reduce to $a(4 - (1-D)^2) > 0$ and $b(4 - (1-D)^2) > 0$. This proves the asserted four-piece order. $\square$

S.3. Exact-one handoffs and common demands.

Lemma S.3 (Exact-one handoff chain). *Assume the six vertex roles cover ∂H and exactly one actual V triangle is supercritical. Rotate its index to 4. The strict handoffs supplied by Proposition B.9 satisfy*

$$x_3 < x_2 < x_1 < x_0 < x_5 < x_4.$$

With

$$a = 1 - x_3, \quad b = x_4, \quad p = 1 - b, \quad q = 1 - a,$$

one has

$$(125) \quad 0 < a, b < 1, \quad a + b > 1, \quad a^2 + ab + b^2 < 1,$$

and every selected V triangle obeys

$$a_i \geq p, \quad b_i \geq q.$$

Proof. Every selected V triangle other than 4 is strictly nonsupercritical, so $x_i < x_{i-1}$ for $i \neq 4$, which is precisely (S.3). In particular x_3 is the global minimum and x_4 the global maximum. The two anchors of V triangle 4 lie in its open role; their mutual squared distance is $a^2 + ab + b^2$, strictly below the diameter squared of the closed unit triangle. This proves (125). Finally every $x_j \in [x_3, x_4]$, so $1 - x_{i-1} \geq 1 - x_4 = p$ and $x_i \geq x_3 = q$. $\square$

S.4. Six directly forced radial points. Put $h = \sqrt{3}/2$ and

$$s = p + q, \quad m = \min(p, q), \quad M = \max(p, q), \quad \chi = s^4 - s^2 + pq.$$

The strict domain (125) gives

$$(126) \quad pq > (1-s)(2-s), \quad m > 1-s, \quad s > 1-m.$$

Let $c_* = c_{\max}(p, q)$ be the exact radial envelope of Proposition M.2. On the present subcritical domain, equation (78) becomes

$$(127) \quad c_* = \begin{cases} C_L(m), & \chi \leq 0, \\ \frac{2M}{1 + \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}}, & \chi > 0, \end{cases}$$

where $C_L(m)$ is the unique root in $[\sqrt{3}/2, 1]$ of

$$z^4 - z^2 + mz - m^2 = 0.$$

At $\chi = 0$ the two expressions agree and equal s .

Lemma S.4 (Direct radial forcing). *One has*

$$(128) \quad 0 < c_* < 1, \quad c_* > 1 - m.$$

Assume that every U_i is Vd0 and that $U_C, U_0, \dots, U_5$ cover H . Then, for every i ,

$$D_i = (1 - c_*)V_i \in U_C.$$

Consequently U_C contains the centered closed disk

$$(129) \quad \mathcal{D}_\eta = \{x : \|x\| \leq \eta\}, \quad \eta = h(1 - c_*).$$

Proof. On the C_L branch, $C_L(m) < 1$ because the defining polynomial is positive at 1; if $s < \sqrt{3}/2$, then $c_* \geq \sqrt{3}/2 > s > 1 - m$, while if $s \geq \sqrt{3}/2$ its value at s is $\chi \leq 0$, so $c_* \geq s > 1 - m$. On the other branch put $E = \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}$. The selector gives $sE > M - m$, whence $c_* < s < 1$. Moreover, with

$$A_0 = \frac{2M}{1 - m} - 1,$$

one has

$$A_0^2 - E^2 = \frac{4(1-s)\{(1-m)(1-2m) + m(2-m)(1-s)\}}{(1-m)^2} > 0.$$

Thus $A_0 > E$ and $c_* > 1 - m$. This proves (128).

Fix i . If $D_i \in U_i$, openness supplies $\varepsilon > 0$ with $c_* + \varepsilon < 1$ such that $(1 - c_* - \varepsilon)V_i \in U_i$. The same role contains its two selected handoff anchors. Since their incoming and outgoing demands dominate p and q , convexity and passage to the closure give a closed unit triangle realizing $(p, q, c_* + \varepsilon)$. This contradicts the definition of $c_* = c_{\max}(p, q)$. Hence $D_i \notin U_i$.

If D_i belonged to U_{i-1} or U_{i+1} , a small plane ball inside that open role would meet the adjacent radial arm r_i in a positive-length interval. This contradicts the Vd0 definition. For the remaining roles put $r = 1 - c_* > 0$. Directly,

$$\|rV_i - V_{i\pm 2}\|^2 = 1 + r + r^2 > 1, \quad \|rV_i - V_{i\pm 3}\| = 1 + r > 1.$$

Since $V_j \in U_j$ and two points of an open unit triangle are at distance strictly below 1, these inequalities exclude D_i from the other three vertex roles. Thus no vertex role contains D_i . The point lies in $\text{int}(H)$ by (128), so the assumed cover forces $D_i \in U_C$.

The six points D_i form a regular hexagon of circumradius $1 - c_*$. Their convex hull contains its centered incircle of radius $h(1 - c_*)$, and convexity of U_C gives (129). $\square$

We next define the three asymmetric witnesses. At V_4 use local coordinates

$$P = V_4 + u(V_5 - V_4) + v(V_3 - V_4), \quad \mathbf{q}(u, v) = u^2 + v^2 - uv.$$

The outgoing demand is b and the incoming demand is a . Accordingly, set

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha &= \frac{h(b + 2a - bD)}{2\rho}, & \beta &= \frac{h(b - a + (a + b)D)}{2\rho}, \\ \gamma &= \frac{h(-b + a + (a + b)D)}{2\rho}, & \delta &= \frac{h(2b + a - aD)}{2\rho}, \end{aligned}$$

where now $\rho = a^2 + ab + b^2$ and $D = \sqrt{4\rho - 3}$. The two line pieces of Theorem S.2 are

$$L_-(\lambda) = (b - \beta\lambda, \alpha\lambda), \quad L_+(\mu) = (\delta\mu, a - \gamma\mu).$$

They meet at $\lambda_* = \mu_* = 8h\rho/(3(D + 3))$ in

$$(130) \quad J = \left(\frac{2b + a - aD}{D + 3}, \frac{b + 2a - bD}{D + 3} \right).$$

Put

$$E_- = (1 - b, 2 - b), \quad E_+ = (2 - a, 1 - a).$$

The actual adjacent handoffs have local centers

$$C_5(t) = (1 + t, t), \quad 1 - a \leq t \leq b, \quad \text{and} \quad C_3(y) = (y, 1 + y), \quad 1 - b \leq y \leq a.$$

The restrictions of the two unit-circle equations are

$$(131) \quad \begin{aligned} g_-(\lambda) &= \frac{3}{4}\lambda^2 - 3(\alpha + b\beta)\lambda + 3b^2 - 3b + 2, \\ g_+(\mu) &= \frac{3}{4}\mu^2 - 3(\delta + a\gamma)\mu + 3a^2 - 3a + 2. \end{aligned}$$

Let λ_- and μ_+ be their first roots; explicitly,

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda_- &= 2(\alpha + b\beta) - \frac{2}{3}\sqrt{9(\alpha + b\beta)^2 - 9b^2 + 9b - 6}, \\ \mu_+ &= 2(\delta + a\gamma) - \frac{2}{3}\sqrt{9(\delta + a\gamma)^2 - 9a^2 + 9a - 6}. \end{aligned}$$

Lemma S.5 (Moving adjacent-role signs). *Throughout (125),*

$$(132) \quad \lambda_* < \lambda_- < h^{-1}, \quad \mu_* < \mu_+ < h^{-1}.$$

Moreover $J_u, J_v < 1/2$. The point $L_+(\mu_+)$ satisfies

$$(L_+(\mu_+))_u + (L_+(\mu_+))_v < 3 - 2a,$$

and the reflected bound holds for $L_-(\lambda_-)$. Writing $F(P, t) = \mathbf{q}(P - C_5(t)) - 1$, one has, for every $t \in [1 - a, b]$,

$$(133) \quad F(L_+(\mu_+), t) \geq 0, \quad F(J, t) > 0, \quad F(L_-(\lambda_-), t) > 0.$$

Under the reflection $(u, v, a, b) \leftrightarrow (v, u, b, a)$, the analogous signs hold for every $y \in [1 - b, a]$: the first-root point $L_-(\lambda_-)$ has nonnegative sign against $C_3(y)$, and the other two witnesses have strictly positive sign.

Proof. Put

$$U = a + b - 1, \quad z = a - b, \quad D^2 = z^2 + 6U + 3U^2.$$

Then $0 < U < 1/6$ and $z^2 < \Omega := 1 - 6U - 3U^2$. We give the fixed-line calculation for the circle centered at $E_+ = (2 - a, 1 - a)$; reflection gives the calculation for E_- . Put

$$F(P, t) = \mathbf{q}(P - (1 + t, t)) - 1, \quad t_0 = 1 - a,$$

so this circle is $F(P, t_0) = 0$. At the junction, exact expansion gives

$$(D + 3)^2 F(J, t_0) = 3D(z^2 + Uz + 1 - 3U) + P_J,$$

where

$$P_J = z^4 + 5z^2 + 6Uz^2 + 3U^2z^2 + 9Uz + 3U + 15U^2 > 0;$$

indeed $z^2 + Uz + 1 - 3U \geq 1 - 3U - U^2/4 > 0$, and $5z^2 + 9Uz + 15U^2$ is positive definite. Thus $F(J, t_0) > 0$. Also

$$J_u + J_v = \frac{(1 + U)(3 - D)}{3 + D} < 1.$$

Indeed this inequality is $3U < D(2 + U)$, which follows from $D^2 \geq 3U(2 + U)$ and $(2 + U)^3 > 3U$. Since

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial t}(P, t) = 1 + 2t - P_u - P_v,$$

$F(J, t)$ is strictly increasing for $t \geq 0$, and therefore is positive throughout $[1 - a, b]$.

On the opposite line L_- , the derivative at the junction, after multiplication by a positive factor, has at $t = 1 - a$ the numerator

$$N_0 = D(9 + 3z^2 + 6Uz - 9U^2) + P_0,$$

where

$$P_0 = 18U^3 + 6U^2z^2 + 63U^2 + 18Uz^2 + 18Uz + 54U \\ + 2z^4 + 9z^2 + 9.$$

The coefficient of D is at least $9 - 6U - 9U^2 > 0$, while $P_0 \geq 9 + 54U - 18U > 0$. Hence $N_0 > 0$. At the other endpoint $t = b$, the corresponding numerator is

$$N_1 = D(9 + 3z^2 + 6U - 3U^2) + P_1,$$

where

$$P_1 = 9U^4 - 3U^3z + 45U^3 + 9U^2z^2 - 6U^2z + 72U^2 \\ - Uz^3 + 21Uz^2 + 9Uz + 45U + 2z^4 + 9z^2 + 9.$$

Its D -coefficient is positive and, using $|z| < 1$,

$$P_1 \geq 9 + 45U - 9U - U - 6U^2 - 3U^3 > 0.$$

The junction derivative is affine in t , so it is positive throughout $[1 - a, b]$. Since the restriction of F to L_- is a convex quadratic, is positive at the junction, and is increasing there, it has no intersection on the opposite line side for any actual adjacent handoff.

On the correct line L_+ , the value at its outer endpoint h^{-1} has, after multiplication by a positive factor, numerator

$$A_0 = P_2 - 4DU(1 + U + z),$$

where

$$P_2 = 3U^4 + 6U^3z + 6U^3 + 4U^2z^2 + 12U^2z + 12U^2 \\ + 2Uz^3 + 6Uz^2 + 2Uz + 6U + z^4 + 2z^2 - 3.$$

For fixed U , replace the odd powers of z by $x = |z|$. The resulting polynomial $P_2^+(U, x)$ satisfies

$$\partial_x P_2^+ = 2(3U^3 + 4U^2x + 6U^2 + 3Ux^2 + 6Ux + U + 2x^3 + 2x) > 0,$$

and therefore its supremum for $z^2 < \Omega$ occurs at $x = \sqrt{\Omega}$. There

$$P_2^+(U, \sqrt{\Omega}) = 4U(U + \sqrt{\Omega} - 3) < 0.$$

As $1 + U + z = 2a > 0$, this gives $A_0 < 0$. The positive junction value and negative endpoint value force the first root strictly between them, proving the L_+ half of (132); reflection proves the other half.

For the coordinate bounds, the exact identities

$$D^2 - (3U - z)^2 = 6U(1 + z - U), \quad D^2 - (3U + z)^2 = 6U(1 - z - U)$$

give $J_u, J_v < 1/2$. It remains to control the coordinate sum along L_+ . For $E = L_+(h^{-1})$, the sign of $3 - 2a - E_u - E_v$ is the sign of

$$D(6U + 2z + 6) + B(U, z),$$

where

$$B(U, z) = -9U^3 - 9U^2z - 9U^2 - 3Uz^2 - 18Uz + 3U \\ - 3z^3 + 3z^2 - 3z + 3.$$

Here

$$B_z = -3(3z^2 + 2Uz + 6U - 2z + 3U^2 + 1) < 0,$$

because the quadratic in parentheses has discriminant $-32U^2 - 80U - 8 < 0$. Hence its minimum on $z^2 < \Omega$ is at $z = \sqrt{\Omega}$, where $B(U, \sqrt{\Omega}) = 6(1 - 3U - \sqrt{\Omega}) > 0$ because $(1 - 3U)^2 - \Omega = 12U^2$. Thus $E_u + E_v < 3 - 2a$. Also $J_u + J_v < 1 < 3 - 2a$, and the coordinate sum is affine on the line segment, so the same strict bound holds at the first root. Now

$$\frac{\partial F}{\partial t}(P, t) = 1 + 2t - P_u - P_v.$$

Since $F(L_+(\mu_+), 1 - a) = 0$, the coordinate-sum bound makes its t -derivative strictly positive for $t \geq 1 - a$. Together with the no-opposite-line result, this proves (133). Reflection gives both the bound on L_- and the complete $C_3(y)$ statement. $\square$

Define the local and global witnesses by

$$(134) \quad Q_-^{\text{loc}} = L_-(\lambda_-), \quad Q_0^{\text{loc}} = J, \quad Q_+^{\text{loc}} = L_+(\mu_+),$$

and by the displayed conversion from (u, v) to the plane.

Lemma S.6 (Direct asymmetric forcing). *Assume that $U_C, U_0, \dots, U_5$ cover H . Then*

$$Q_-, Q_0, Q_+ \in \text{int}(H) \setminus \bigcup_{i=0}^5 U_i,$$

and consequently all three witnesses belong to U_C .

Proof. The root order and positivity of the line coordinates give $0 < u, v < 1$ for all three points. Each belongs to $\mathcal{R}(b, a)$ and hence lies in a closed unit triangle containing V_4 , so $\mathbf{q}(u, v) \leq 1$; hence $|u - v| < 1$ and all three points lie in $\text{int}(H)$.

The closure of U_4 is one of the triangles represented by $\mathcal{R}(b, a)$, since it contains V_4, X_3, X_4 . All three witnesses lie on its exact non-axis frontier. If one belonged to the open triangle U_4 , a sufficiently small plane ball about it would lie both in U_4 and in the interior of the corner cone, making the witness an interior point of $\mathcal{R}(b, a)$. This contradiction excludes U_4 .

For the roles U_0, U_1, U_2 , their contained vertices have local coordinates

$$\begin{array}{c|ccc} i & 0 & 1 & 2 \\ \hline V_i & (2, 1) & (2, 2) & (1, 2). \end{array}$$

For $P = (u, v)$,

$$\|P - (2, 1)\|^2 - 1 = \mathbf{q}(u, v) + 2 - 3u, \quad \|P - (1, 2)\|^2 - 1 = \mathbf{q}(u, v) + 2 - 3v.$$

The inequalities $J_u, J_v < 1/2$ and the line order give distance greater than one from V_0 for Q_-, Q_0 and from V_2 for Q_0, Q_+ . For the remaining pair, the first-root circle and the sum bound in Lemma S.5 give

$$\|Q_+ - V_0\|^2 - 1 = a(3 - a - (Q_+)_u - (Q_+)_v) > a^2,$$

and, by reflection, $\|Q_- - V_2\|^2 - 1 > b^2$. All three points are farther than one from $V_1 = (2, 2)$, because writing $u = 1 - \xi$, $v = 1 - \eta$ gives

$$\|P - V_1\|^2 = 1 + \xi + \eta + \xi^2 + \eta^2 - \xi\eta > 1.$$

Since two points in one open unit equilateral triangle have distance strictly less than one, these inequalities exclude U_0, U_1, U_2 .

The actual handoff $X_5 = C_5(x_5)$ belongs to U_5 , and $1 - a < x_5 < b$ by (S.3). The three signs in (133) therefore put every witness at distance at least one from X_5 , excluding U_5 . Similarly, if $y = 1 - x_2$, then $1 - b < y < a$, $X_2 = C_3(y) \in U_3$, and the reflected signs exclude U_3 . Thus no vertex role contains any witness. The assumed cover now forces all three interior witnesses into U_C . $\square$

The nine directly forced points are $D_0, \dots, D_5, Q_-, Q_0, Q_+$. Under a putative cover, Lemmas S.4 and S.6 therefore force the compact set

$$(135) \quad K_{\text{wit}}(a, b) = \mathcal{D}_\eta \cup \{Q_-, Q_0, Q_+\} \subset U_C.$$

S.5. Tangent reduction and exact mixed overlaps. For the nontrivial regime $c_* > 2/3$, we first remove the square radicals in the first-root witnesses. Normalize $\bar{\alpha} = \alpha/h$, and similarly for the other three coefficients, and put

$$\xi = \lambda/h, \quad \zeta = \mu/h, \quad \xi_* = \zeta_* = \frac{8\rho}{3(D+3)}.$$

Let g_-, g_+ be the rescaled forms of (131), and take one Newton step at the junction:

$$\widehat{\xi}_- = \xi_* - \frac{g_-(\xi_*)}{g'_-(\xi_*)}, \quad \widehat{\zeta}_+ = \zeta_* - \frac{g_+(\zeta_*)}{g'_+(\zeta_*)}.$$

Define, in local coordinates,

$$\begin{aligned} A &= \left(b - \frac{3}{4}\widehat{\beta\xi}_-, \frac{3}{4}\widehat{\alpha\xi}_- \right), \\ B &= J, \\ C &= \left(\frac{3}{4}\widehat{\delta\zeta}_+, a - \frac{3}{4}\widehat{\gamma\zeta}_+ \right), \end{aligned}$$

and convert them to global vectors.

Lemma S.7 (Newton inner reduction). *The points above have coordinates rational in a, b, D and satisfy*

$$A \in (Q_0, Q_-), \quad C \in (Q_0, Q_+).$$

Consequently

$$\widehat{K} = \text{conv}(\mathcal{D}_\eta \cup \{A, B, C\}),$$

obeys $\widehat{K} \subseteq \text{conv}(K_{\text{wit}})$.

Proof. Each quadratic g_-, g_+ is strictly convex, positive, and decreasing at the junction. Its tangent zero therefore lies strictly between the junction and its first root. This gives the two open-segment inclusions. All displayed coefficients and Newton quotients are rational in a, b, D , and convexity gives the asserted containment. $\square$

Put $W = C + RA$. For a disk $\mathbb{D}(X, r)$ let

$$I(X, r) = \{n : \|n\| = 1, \langle X, n \rangle + r \geq h\}.$$

S.6. Ray order and four overlaps.

Proposition S.8 (Technical four-overlap verification). *Assume (125) and $c_* > 2/3$. Then*

$$\|A\|, \|C\| > \eta,$$

the rays A, B, C, W, RA occur in that cyclic order, and the four consecutive cap pairs

$$I(A, 2\eta) \leftrightarrow I(B, 2\eta) \leftrightarrow I(C, 2\eta) \leftrightarrow I(W, \eta) \leftrightarrow I(RA, 2\eta)$$

overlap across their intervening short sectors.

Proof. Put $\tau = h - 2\eta = h(2c_* - 1)$. The rays of

$$(136) \quad A, B, C, W, RA$$

occur in this cyclic order from A to RA . Indeed the two line distances give

$$\frac{\text{cross}(A, B)}{\|B - A\|} = \alpha(1 - b) + \beta > 0, \quad \frac{\text{cross}(B, C)}{\|C - B\|} = \gamma + \delta(1 - a) > 0.$$

If $A = (-X, -Y)$ and $C = (-P, -Q)$ in the centered cone basis, then $0 < X, Y, P, Q < 1$, $X, Q > 1/2$, and

$$\frac{\text{cross}(C, RA)}{h} = PX + (Q - P)Y > 0.$$

The last sign is immediate unless $Q < P$ and $X < Y$, in which case it is larger than $Q - P/2 > 0$. The ray of $W = C + RA$ lies between those of C and RA . The same coordinates give

$$(137) \quad \|A\|, \|C\| > h/2 > \eta.$$

For the two equal-radius overlaps it is enough to prove

$$(138) \quad \frac{\text{cross}(A, B)}{\|B - A\|} \geq \tau, \quad \frac{\text{cross}(B, C)}{\|C - B\|} \geq \tau.$$

We record the exact analytic verification. By reflection take $a \leq b$ and set $m = 1 - b$, $M = 1 - a$, $U = a + b - 1$, $s = m + M$, and $w = M - m$. The smaller of the two normalized left sides in (138) is

$$(139) \quad d = \frac{\mathcal{A} + U(2m - 1) + D(\mathcal{A} + U)}{2\rho}, \quad \mathcal{A} = 1 - m + m^2.$$

On the C_L sheet, write $F_L(z) = z^4 - z^2 + mz - m^2$. This defining polynomial evaluated at $r = 1 - m/2 + m^2/2$ is

$$F_L(r) = \frac{m^2(m-1)}{16}(m^5 - 3m^4 + 11m^3 - 17m^2 + 28m - 12) > 0.$$

Indeed the polynomial in parentheses is increasing on $(0, 1/2)$ and has value $-33/32$ at $1/2$; its derivative is $28 - 34m + m^2(5m^2 - 12m + 33) > 0$. Since $F_L(h) = -(m - h/2)^2 \leq 0$ and the selected root is unique, $2c_* - 1 \leq \mathcal{A}$. Put

$$X_0 = \mathcal{A} + U, \quad Y_0 = 2\rho\mathcal{A} - \mathcal{A} - U(2m - 1).$$

Then

$$d - \mathcal{A} = \frac{D(\mathcal{A} + U) - Y_0}{2\rho},$$

and exact expansion gives

$$\begin{aligned} Y_0 &= 2(m^2 - m + 1)U^2 + (2m^3 - 2m + 3)U \\ &\quad + (m^2 - m + 1)(2m^2 - 2m + 1) > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Furthermore

$$D^2X_0^2 - Y_0^2 = 4m\rho\Phi(U, m),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \Phi(U, m) &= (1 - m)(m^2 - m + 2)U^2 \\ &\quad + (2 - m^2)(m^2 - m + 1)U \\ &\quad - m(1 - m)^2(m^2 - m + 1). \end{aligned}$$

In these variables

$$\chi = U^4 - 4U^3 + 5U^2 - (m + 2)U + m(1 - m).$$

Since $U^2(U^2 - 4U + 5) > 0$, the selector $\chi \leq 0$ implies $U > m(1 - m)/(m + 2)$; Φ is increasing in U and at that lower endpoint is

$$\frac{m^2(1 - m)(m^4 - 2m^3 + 6m^2 - 6m + 4)}{(m + 2)^2} > 0.$$

The last quartic equals $(m^2 - m)^2 + 5m^2 - 6m + 4 > 0$. Thus $d > \mathcal{A} \geq 2c_* - 1$.

On the other radial sheet let $E = \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}$. Then $0 \leq w < sE$ and $c_* = (s + w)/(1 + E)$. At fixed U , differentiation of (139) can be checked without an implicit estimate. Namely,

$$d = \frac{1 + D}{2} - UB(D, w), \quad B(D, w) = \frac{(1 + U)(3 + D) + w(1 - D)}{D^2 + 3}.$$

Here $D^2 = w^2 + 6U + 3U^2$, so $0 \leq D' = w/D \leq 1$, and

$$B_w = \frac{1 - D}{D^2 + 3} \geq 0.$$

Writing $N = (1 + U)(3 + D) + w(1 - D)$, direct differentiation gives

$$B_D = \frac{(1 + U - w)(D^2 + 3) - 2DN}{(D^2 + 3)^2} > -\frac{34}{27}.$$

Indeed the first term in the numerator is positive, while $1 + U - w = 2a > 0$, $N < (7/6)4 + 1 = 17/3$, $D < 1$, and $D^2 + 3 \geq 3$. If $B_D < 0$, then $B_D D' \geq B_D$; otherwise $B_D D' \geq 0$. Hence $B' = B_w + B_D D' > -34/27$, and $U < 1/6$ yields

$$d' < \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{6} \frac{34}{27} = \frac{115}{162} < 1,$$

whereas $(2c_* - 1)' = 2/(1 + E) \geq 1$. Hence their difference decreases with w . At the boundary $w = sE$, where $\chi = 0$ and $c_* = s$, the preceding sheet applies: this is an admissible point because $h < s < 1$ and $D^2 = 4s^4 - 12s + 9 < 1$. Indeed $s^4 - 3s + 2 = (s - 1)(s^3 + s^2 + s - 2) < 0$ on this interval; the second factor is increasing and already equals $(7h - 5)/4 > 0$ at $s = h$. The preceding sheet gives $d \geq 2s - 1$. Therefore (138) holds on both sheets, and reflection supplies the other line.

It remains to check the two mixed overlaps. The exact rational envelopes, Gram reductions, and global positive-basis identities are recorded once in Appendix T. Theorem T.3 gives precisely the overlaps for $\mathbb{D}(C, 2\eta)$ with $\mathbb{D}(W, \eta)$ and for $\mathbb{D}(W, \eta)$ with $\mathbb{D}(RA, 2\eta)$.

Thus the four consecutive pairs of caps centered on the rays (136) overlap. $\square$

APPENDIX T. EXACT COMPUTER-ASSISTED CERTIFICATE FOR THE MIXED CAP OVERLAPS

The two mixed cap overlaps in Strategy 4 are certified by exact symbolic arithmetic. This section states the complete mathematical reduction, explains the verification algorithms, and formally incorporates the code and sparse integer data listed below as an electronic proof supplement. No floating-point arithmetic, interval arithmetic, adaptive subdivision, branch-and-bound, or unrecorded numerical tolerance is used.

T.1. Certificate manifest. All paths below are relative to the Strategy 4 computation directory. The machine-readable provenance manifest stores the full Git blob identities; the paper prints compact identifiers and twelve-character prefixes.

certificate object	blob prefix
core_data_00	359b219f9ded
core_data_01	bfc807f90635
core_data_02	92887696ef94
core_data_03	c2791a8a6add
core_data_04	7eeabecbbd17
core_data_05	d676114292e7
core_polynomials	07f57b178cf7
derivation verifier	0a55211ae37f
positivity verifier	821f9a6dc750

The six data shards decode to one canonical sparse-polynomial transcript with SHA-256 digest

dc46aaf263655d5159ecd3a81db72ee82477951d06172f4743b248df37209485

The first verifier independently derives the transcript from the witness formulas and compares every coefficient with the authenticated object. The second verifier derives all Bernstein coefficients from that same object and checks their signs exactly.

T.2. Rational radial upper envelopes. Retain the notation of Section S. Thus

$$p = 1 - b, \quad q = 1 - a, \quad s = p + q, \quad m = \min\{p, q\}, \quad M = \max\{p, q\},$$

$$\chi = s^4 - s^2 + mM, \quad h = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, \quad c_* = c_{\max}(p, q).$$

The strict witness domain gives

$$(140) \quad mM > (1 - s)(2 - s), \quad m > 1 - s, \quad s > \frac{2}{3}.$$

Put

$$F_m(x) = x^4 - x^2 + mx - m^2, \quad \kappa = F'_m(s) = 4s^3 - 2s + m.$$

Then

$$\kappa > 4s^3 - 3s + 1 = (s + 1)(2s - 1)^2 > 0.$$

Define

$$(141) \quad \bar{c}_L = s - \frac{\chi}{\kappa} \quad (\chi \leq 0), \quad \bar{c}_T = s - \frac{\chi}{1 - m} \quad (\chi \geq 0).$$

Lemma T.1 (Branchwise radial upper bounds). *On the corresponding radial cells,*

$$c_* \leq \bar{c}_L < 1, \quad c_* \leq \bar{c}_T < 1.$$

At $\chi = 0$ both upper bounds equal $s = c_*$.

Proof. On the L cell, $F_m(s) = \chi \leq 0$ and $F_m(c_*) = 0$. For $x \geq s > 2/3$, $F''_m(x) > 0$, so convexity gives

$$0 \geq F_m(s) + F'_m(s)(c_* - s),$$

and hence $c_* \leq \bar{c}_L$. If $U = 1 - s$, then

$$\chi + U\kappa > U\{m + 1 - 4U + 8U^2 - 3U^3\} > 0$$

by (140); therefore $\bar{c}_L < 1$.

On the T cell put

$$E = \sqrt{4s^2 - 3}, \quad m_0 = \frac{s(1 - E)}{2}, \quad M_0 = \frac{s(1 + E)}{2}.$$

Then

$$\chi = (m - m_0)(M_0 - m), \quad s - c_* = \frac{2(m - m_0)}{1 + E}.$$

Consequently

$$\frac{\chi}{s - c_*} = \frac{1 + E}{2}(M_0 - m) \leq 1 - m,$$

which gives $c_* \leq \bar{c}_T$. The strict inequality $\chi > 0$ gives $\bar{c}_T < s < 1$. $\square$

Reflect so that $z = a - b \geq 0$ and put $U = a + b - 1$. Then

$$s = 1 - U, \quad m = \frac{1 - U - z}{2}, \quad D^2 = z^2 + 6U + 3U^2 =: K(U, z),$$

and

$$\Xi(U, z) = 4\chi = 1 - 10U + 21U^2 - 16U^3 + 4U^4 - z^2,$$

$$G(U, z) = 2\kappa = 5 - 21U + 24U^2 - 8U^3 - z.$$

Thus

$$(142) \quad \bar{c}_L = 1 - U - \frac{\Xi(U, z)}{2G(U, z)}, \quad \bar{c}_T = 1 - U - \frac{\Xi(U, z)}{2(1 + U + z)}.$$

T.3. Gram reduction and the geometric implication. On the active cell let $\bar{c}$ denote the corresponding expression in (142), and put

$$\bar{\eta} = h(1 - \bar{c}), \quad e = 1 - \bar{c}, \quad t = 2\bar{c} - 1.$$

Lemma T.1 gives $0 < \bar{\eta} \leq \eta = h(1 - c_*)$. It therefore suffices to prove the mixed intersections for the smaller disks with radii $2\bar{\eta}, \bar{\eta}, 2\bar{\eta}$.

Represent a global vector as (x, hy) and put $C' = R^{-1}C$. Define

$$N_A = \|A\|^2, \quad N_C = \|C'\|^2, \quad \nu = \langle A, C' \rangle, \\ \Delta_0 = x_A y_{C'} - y_A x_{C'} > 0.$$

Thus the Euclidean cross product is $h\Delta_0$, and the Gram identity is

$$(143) \quad h^2 \Delta_0^2 = N_A N_C - \nu^2.$$

Define

$$(144) \quad Q_A = \Delta_0^2 - \|tA - eC'\|^2, \quad Q_C = \Delta_0^2 - \|tC' - eA\|^2.$$

Lemma T.2 (Residual signs imply the mixed cap intersections). *If $Q_A, Q_C \geq 0$, then*

$$I(C, 2\bar{\eta}) \cap I(C + RA, \bar{\eta}) \neq \emptyset,$$

and

$$I(C + RA, \bar{\eta}) \cap I(RA, 2\bar{\eta}) \neq \emptyset.$$

Consequently the same intersections hold with η in place of $\bar{\eta}$.

Proof. Rotate the first pair by R^{-1} . Its centers become C' and $A + C'$, so their difference is A . An outer common tangent normal n_A is chosen with

$$\langle A, n_A \rangle = \bar{\eta}.$$

Since $\|A\| > \bar{\eta}$ and $\Delta_0 > 0$, choose the tangent side for which

$$\langle C', n_A \rangle = \frac{\bar{\eta}\nu + \sqrt{N_A - \bar{\eta}^2} h\Delta_0}{N_A}.$$

The common support of the two disks is therefore

$$2\bar{\eta} + \frac{\bar{\eta}\nu + \sqrt{N_A - \bar{\eta}^2} h\Delta_0}{N_A}.$$

Let $\bar{\tau} = h - 2\bar{\eta} = ht$. Expanding (144) and using (143) gives

$$(145) \quad \bar{P}_A := (N_A - \bar{\eta}^2)h^2\Delta_0^2 - (\bar{\tau}N_A - \bar{\eta}\nu)^2 = h^2N_AQ_A.$$

Thus $Q_A \geq 0$ implies

$$\sqrt{N_A - \bar{\eta}^2} h\Delta_0 \geq \bar{\tau}N_A - \bar{\eta}\nu,$$

and the common support is at least $2\bar{\eta} + \bar{\tau} = h$. Hence the two level- h caps intersect. The same calculation with A and C' exchanged gives

$$(146) \quad \bar{P}_C := (N_C - \bar{\eta}^2)h^2\Delta_0^2 - (\bar{\tau}N_C - \bar{\eta}\nu)^2 = h^2N_CQ_C,$$

and proves the second intersection. Enlarging the disk radii from $\bar{\eta}$ to η only enlarges the caps. $\square$

T.4. Eight exact integer-polynomial signs. The Newton witnesses A, C are rational functions of U, z, D . Substituting (142) into (144), clearing denominators, and reducing by

$$D^2 - K(U, z) = 0$$

gives, for $B \in \{L, T\}$ and $X \in \{A, C\}$,

$$(147) \quad \text{num}(Q_{B,X}) = 32(K+3)^2 \{A_{B,X}(U, z) + DB_{B,X}(U, z)\},$$

where all eight core polynomials lie in $\mathbb{Z}[U, z]$. Every omitted denominator is strictly positive on the strict domain: its factors are positive constants, $(D+3)^4$, $G(U, z)^2$ or $(1+U+z)^2$, and squares of the two Newton-derivative numerators. Here $G = 2\kappa > 0$, and the fixed-line sign theorem proves both Newton derivatives strictly negative.

The derivation verifier constructs A, C , both rational envelopes, and all four residuals directly in the exact field $\mathbb{Q}(U, z, D)$. It performs the reduction modulo $D^2 - K$, removes the common positive factor, primitive-normalizes the eight integer polynomials, and compares their sparse term lists coefficient by coefficient with the authenticated transcript. Thus the data are checked against the geometric formulas rather than trusted as an independent precomputation.

T.5. Three global positive-basis certificates. Set

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{G}(U) &= 1 - 6U - 3U^2, & H(U) &= 1 - 10U + 21U^2 - 16U^3 + 4U^4, \\ U_H &= 1 - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, & U_{\max} &= \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} - 1. \end{aligned}$$

The complete reflected domain is the union of the three closed cells

$$\begin{aligned} T : & \quad 0 \leq U \leq U_H, \quad 0 \leq z^2 \leq H(U), \\ L_0 : & \quad 0 \leq U \leq U_H, \quad H(U) \leq z^2 \leq \mathcal{G}(U), \\ L_1 : & \quad U_H \leq U \leq U_{\max}, \quad 0 \leq z^2 \leq \mathcal{G}(U). \end{aligned}$$

For the T cell use

$$U = \frac{(x-1)(3-x)}{4x}, \quad z = y \frac{9-x^4}{8x^2}, \quad 1 \leq x \leq \sqrt{3}, \quad 0 \leq y \leq 1,$$

and then $x = 1 + (\sqrt{3} - 1)r$. This maps $[0, 1]^2$ onto the complete cell. After multiplication by positive powers of 2 and x , the four transformed core polynomials have global tensor Bernstein expansions with data

	bidegree	coefficient count	zero count
$A_{T,A}$	(88, 22)	2047	2
$B_{T,A}$	(80, 20)	1701	0
$A_{T,C}$	(88, 22)	2047	2
$B_{T,C}$	(80, 20)	1701	0.

Every nonzero coefficient is strictly positive.

For an L -cell polynomial write

$$F(U, z) = E_F(U, w) + zO_F(U, w), \quad w = z^2,$$

and

$$R_F(U, w) = E_F(U, w)^2 - wO_F(U, w)^2.$$

The implications $E_F \geq 0$ and $R_F \geq 0$ give $E_F \geq \sqrt{w}|O_F|$, hence $F \geq 0$ for $z \geq 0$. Use the exact charts

$$U = U_H r, \quad w = H(U) + s\{\mathcal{G}(U) - H(U)\}$$

for L_0 , and

$$U = U_H + (U_{\max} - U_H)r, \quad w = s\mathcal{G}(U)$$

for L_1 . The positivity verifier forms one global Bernstein expansion for each of E_F, R_F on each square. The resulting sixteen expansions have the bidegrees and coefficient counts recorded in the certificate tables below; every coefficient is strictly positive.

The verifier implements polynomial addition, multiplication, substitution, and power-to-Bernstein conversion over exact integers. Coefficients in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ are represented as rational pairs and signed by exact rational comparisons. If $P(r, s) = \sum a_{ij}r^i s^j$ has bidegree (m, n) , its exact tensor Bernstein coefficients are

$$b_{k\ell} = \sum_{i \leq k} \sum_{j \leq \ell} a_{ij} \frac{\binom{k}{i}}{\binom{m}{i}} \frac{\binom{\ell}{j}}{\binom{n}{j}}.$$

This is precisely the conversion implemented by the verifier.

Theorem T.3 (Exact mixed-overlap certificate). *On the complete strict witness domain with $c_* > 2/3$, all eight polynomials in (147) are nonnegative. Hence $Q_A, Q_C \geq 0$, and the two mixed cap intersections required by Proposition S.8 hold.*

Proof. The T chart proves the four T -cell core signs by nonnegative Bernstein coefficients. On each L chart the positive Bernstein certificates for E_F and R_F prove the four L -cell signs. Since $D \geq 0$, (147) gives $Q_A, Q_C \geq 0$ for $z \geq 0$; reflection supplies $z \leq 0$. Lemma T.2 then gives the two cap intersections. $\square$

Remark T.4 (Reproduction status). The files above constitute the exact certificate used by the proof. A reproduction run should execute

```
verify_mixed_overlap_core_derivation.py
verify_global_core_positivity.py
```

from their package directory. This manuscript revision does not claim that those commands were rerun during the present source-only edit; the certificate is incorporated by its exact repository objects and authenticated transcript.

APPENDIX U. NONSTANDARD SYMBOLS

Standard geometric notation is defined at first use. The following symbols recur across proof mechanisms.

symbol	meaning
CE0, CE1, CE2	The three exhaustive center-role boundary-trace classes.
Vd0, Vd1, Vd2, T3-like	The four exhaustive vertex-role classes.
$A(T), B(T), C(T)$	Functions returning the actual maximal incoming-boundary, outgoing-boundary, and own-radial reaches of a tagged V triangle; (A_i, B_i, C_i) are the indexed aliases.
(a_i, b_i, c_i)	Selected lower-bound demands; these do not define N_+ .
d_i^C, c_i^C	The center exit measured from O and its complementary vertex-side radial demand $c_i^C = 1 - d_i^C$.
m_3	The local CE1 affine-slot scalar $m_3 = d_3^C$; it is distinct from the paper-wide role count m .

continued on the next page

symbol	meaning
N_+, m, q	The number of actual supercritical V triangles, non-Vd0 roles, and short roles; in CE1/CE2 one has $q = N_+ + m$.
gr	The active-gap rank; bare g is reserved for transfer maps.
$\Lambda(K)$	The least side length of a closed equilateral triangle containing K .
$\omega(x), \sigma(x)$	The radical $\sqrt{1-x+x^2}$ and its deficit $1 - \sqrt{1-x+x^2}$.
$\mathcal{A}$	The exact local admissible set of boundary–radial demand triples.
$g_c(x)$	The historical raw defect map $\max\{y : (1-x, y, c) \in \mathcal{A}\}$.
$\widehat{g}_c(x)$	The nonsupercritical cap $\min\{g_c(x), x\}$.
$f^\vee(a)$	The complement dual $1 - f(1-a)$; in particular $\widehat{g}_c^\vee$ is the extensive incoming-reach transfer.
$\mathcal{R}_J(p)$	The far-side residual demand after an initial trace and center interval J .
$g_{c,J}^\vee, \widehat{g}_{c,J}^\vee$	The raw and capped center-assisted reach transfers.
g_c^{sc}	The free strict-supercritical outgoing envelope $\sup_{\{x: g_c(x) > x\}} g_c(x)$.
$\widehat{g}_{1-d}^{\vee, \lambda}$	A certified affine selected- T_+ lower relaxation.
$\widehat{g}_{1-d}^{\vee, \text{th}}$	The low-root threshold lower relaxation.
$[\Phi_1 \mid \cdots \mid \Phi_r]$	The composition $\Phi_r \circ \cdots \circ \Phi_1$, with maps listed in geometric V-triangle order.
B_c, F_c, G_c	Technical verification aliases: $B_c(a) = g_c(1-a)$, $F_c(a) = \widehat{g}_c(1-a)$, and $G_c(a) = \widehat{g}_c^\vee(a)$.
$F(c, x), T(c, x)$	The pure Strategy 2 capped-output function and complementary update $T(c, x) = 1 - F(c, x)$.
$\mathcal{D}_{C1}, \mathcal{D}_{C2}$	The full signed CE1 and CE2 real cells.
$\mathcal{D}_1, \mathcal{D}_2$	The oriented CE1 one-gap cell and the CE2 cell used by the all-Vd0 problems.
$\Psi_{E1}, \Psi_{E2}, \Psi_{R1}, \Psi_{R2}$	The four all-Vd0 Strategy 2 objective functions.
$\Omega_{T3}, \Omega_{\text{SC}}, \Omega_{\text{VD}}$	The finite real-variable T3 endpoint, adjacent-rescuer, and Vd radial domains.
$E(L, U; x), R(L, U; x)$	The explicit initial-component endpoint and complementary residual; these replace interval-component suprema in the Vd problems.
$e(d)$	The high-radial low-root threshold for deficit d in the geometric and verification notation.
$R, W, E, \alpha, \delta, \Delta_R, \Delta_L$	The common signed CE1/CE2 center variables and trace surpluses.
$f(a, b), \mathcal{L}(a, b)$	Normalized maximal retained area and the corresponding local area loss.
$c_*, \mathcal{D}_\eta, Q_-, Q_0, Q_+$	The radial envelope, forced disk, and exact asymmetric witnesses in Strategy 4.
$A, B, C, \widehat{K}, K_{\text{wit}}$	The Newton inner points, inner witness hull, and exact forced witness set.
$I(X, r)$	The level- $\sqrt{3}/2$ support cap associated with the disk $\mathbb{D}(X, r)$.